Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual

Version 3.2

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Issued by the Human Resources Development Department, Head Office, for internal circulation to all Branches, Regional Offices, Zonal Offices, and Administrative Departments. This Manual supersedes all previous circulars, instructions, and memoranda on the subject of employee leave issued prior to the Effective Date stated above, except where expressly saved by a specific provision of this Manual.

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Chapter 1 — Preliminary

Section 1.1 — Short Title and Commencement

This Manual shall be called the 'Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual' and shall come into force with effect from 01 April 2026. It applies to all confirmed, probationary, and part-time employees of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited, across all Branches, Regional Offices, Zonal Offices, and Administrative Departments, howsoever situated, save where a specific provision states otherwise.

Section 1.2 — Definitions

- **Bank** means Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited and includes all its Branches, Regional Offices, Zonal Offices, and Administrative Departments.
- **Competent Authority** means the officer designated under the relevant Chapter of this Manual as authorised to sanction the leave in question.
- **Calendar Year** means the period from 1 January to 31 December.
- **Continuous Service** means service which has not been interrupted by resignation, dismissal, removal, or unauthorised absence of a duration exceeding the limit prescribed under the Bank's Service Regulations.
- **HRMS** means the Human Resource Management System maintained by the Bank for, among other things, the recording, sanctioning, and reconciliation of employee leave.
- **Reporting Officer** means the immediate superior officer to whom an employee directly reports for the purposes of day-to-day supervision.
- **Cadre** means the category of service to which an employee belongs, as specified in Chapter 1 read with the Bank's Recruitment and Promotion Regulations.
- **Leave Account** means the record maintained in the HRMS reflecting the accrual, availment, and balance of each type of leave for every employee.

Section 1.3 — Applicability

Save as otherwise expressly provided, the provisions of this Manual apply uniformly to employees across all cadres of the Bank. Where a specific Chapter prescribes cadre-specific entitlements, those provisions shall prevail over any general statement of entitlement elsewhere in this Manual. Nothing in this Manual shall be construed to override any statutory entitlement to leave to which an employee is entitled under applicable central or state legislation; where a statutory entitlement exceeds the entitlement prescribed in this Manual, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess.

Chapter 2 — General Leave Rules Applicable Across Leave Types

Section 2.1 — Leave Year

The Leave Year for the purposes of this Manual shall ordinarily coincide with the Calendar Year, save for Earned Leave / Privilege Leave, for which the Leave Year shall run from 1 April to 31 March, in alignment with the Bank's financial year, unless a specific Chapter provides otherwise.

Section 2.2 — Leave Account and Reconciliation

Every employee's Leave Account shall be maintained electronically in the HRMS. The HRMS shall generate a quarterly leave statement, which shall be deemed final and binding unless an employee raises a discrepancy in writing within thirty days of the statement being made available. The Branch HR Coordinator shall be responsible for reconciling any discrepancy so raised within fifteen working days.

Section 2.3 — Combination of Leave

Except where expressly restricted under a specific Chapter, an employee may combine different types of leave, provided that the total combined period does not result in an absence exceeding one hundred and eighty days without specific Head Office approval, and provided further that Casual Leave shall not ordinarily be combined with Earned Leave save in circumstances recorded in writing by the Competent Authority.

Section 2.4 — Recall from Leave

The Bank reserves the right to recall an employee from any sanctioned leave in circumstances of genuine operational exigency. An employee so recalled shall be entitled to have the unavailed balance of that spell of leave restored to their Leave Account, and to claim reasonable travel expenses actually and necessarily incurred in returning to duty, subject to production of supporting bills.

Section 2.5 — Leave During Notice Period

An employee who has tendered resignation and is serving the notice period prescribed under the Bank's Service Regulations shall not ordinarily be granted leave during such notice period, save for Sick Leave supported by medical certification, or in circumstances of genuine emergency at the discretion of the Competent Authority.

Section 2.6 — Leave and Transfer

Where an employee is transferred from one Branch, Region, or Zone to another, the employee's Leave Account shall be transferred along with the employee's service record, and any leave already sanctioned but not availed shall remain valid, subject to fresh confirmation by the Competent Authority at the transferred location, as more particularly set out in the specific Chapters of this Manual.

Section 2.7 — False Statements and Misuse

Any employee found to have obtained leave under this Manual on the basis of a false statement, forged document, or material misrepresentation shall be liable to disciplinary proceedings under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of any wages, allowances, or benefits paid in respect of the period of leave so obtained.

Section 2.8 — Interpretation and Residual Powers

Any question of interpretation arising under this Manual, not expressly covered by a specific provision, shall be referred to the Head Office HRD Department, whose decision thereon shall be final and binding on all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices, subject to the overriding authority of the Board of Directors.

Chapter 3 — Casual Leave (CL)

Clause 3.1 — Overview and Objective. Casual Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘CL’ in this Manual) is a short-duration leave granted for unforeseen personal exigencies of a routine nature. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Casual Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to CL. The objective of CL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of casual leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 3.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 3.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 3.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 3.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 3.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 5 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 3.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 3.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 3.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for CL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	8	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	6	22	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	15	19	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	5	8	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	18	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	7	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	9	3 working day(s)

Clause 3.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to CL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of CL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of CL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 3.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 3.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for CL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on CL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 3.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of CL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 3.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

3.5.1 CL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

3.5.2 CL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

3.5.3 An employee proceeding on CL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

3.5.4 CL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 3.6.

3.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for CL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

3.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned CL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

3.5.7 Requests for CL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

3.5.8 CL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 3.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

CL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 3.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine CL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 3.4. Combination of CL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of CL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 3.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q3.7.1. Can CL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 3.6, CL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q3.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing CL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 3.2 for each cadre.

Q3.7.3. What happens to unavailed CL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed CL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q3.7.4. Can CL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for CL.

Q3.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction CL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 3.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q3.7.6. Can CL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, CL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q3.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for CL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 3.2 of this Chapter.

Q3.7.8. Does CL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q3.7.9. Can an employee encash CL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily CL is not encashable in service.

Q3.7.10. What is the maximum CL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 3.2; balances of approximately 6 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q3.7.11. Can CL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of CL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q3.7.12. Is CL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to CL linked to the term of the contract.

Q3.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for CL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 3.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q3.7.14. Does CL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q3.7.15. Can CL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q3.7.16. What proof is required for emergency CL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 3.2.

Q3.7.17. Can CL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 3.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q3.7.18. Is CL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

CL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q3.7.19. Who maintains the official record of CL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 3.9 of this Chapter.

Q3.7.20. Can CL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 3.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q3.7.21. Does CL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q3.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for CL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 3.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q3.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for CL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q3.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of CL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of CL is not separately debited to the CL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q3.7.25. Can CL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction CL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q3.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of CL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 3.15.

Q3.7.27. Can CL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with CL for the same day.

Q3.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for CL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q3.7.29. Does CL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; CL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q3.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied CL?

No; as clarified in Clause 3.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer CL.

Q3.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for CL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 3.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q3.7.32. Can I be denied CL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 3.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of CL on this ground.

Q3.7.33. Will my CL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 3.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 3.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 3.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for CL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 3.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 3.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for CL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 3.4.

Case 3.8.3. An employee proceeding on CL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 3.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 3.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 3.3.

Case 3.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine CL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 3.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for CL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 3.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 3.8.7. An employee's CL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 3.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where CL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 3.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 3.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought CL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 3.11.7, that the debit to the CL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 3.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile CL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 3.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 3.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of CL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 3.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 3.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for CL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 3.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 3.5.

Case 3.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for CL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 3.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 3.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's CL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 3.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 3.8.15. An employee's CL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 3.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 3.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for CL under Clause 3.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 3.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 3.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are

required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 3.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 3.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 3.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so

that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 3.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 3.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any

further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 3.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 3.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch

Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 3.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is

available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 3.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to CL set out in Section 3.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 3.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of CL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 3.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for CL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 3.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 3.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 3.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

3.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for CL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

3.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to CL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's CL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

3.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of CL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to CL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

3.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of CL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 3.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

3.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for CL under Section 3.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

3.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue CL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for CL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

3.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of CL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

3.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for CL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while CL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 3.5.8 shall apply.

3.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued CL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

3.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for CL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

3.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of CL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of CL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD

Department.

3.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for CL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

3.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for CL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of CL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent CL is encashable.

3.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of CL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

3.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 3.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction CL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

3.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing CL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

3.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of CL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

3.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned CL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

3.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of CL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

3.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned CL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

3.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any CL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

3.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for CL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

3.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for CL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

3.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue CL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

3.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to CL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

3.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of CL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing CL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

3.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for CL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

3.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of CL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

3.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of CL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

3.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise CL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the CL account.

3.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile CL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

3.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail CL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

3.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for CL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of CL exceeding five consecutive days.

3.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for CL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

3.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to CL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 3.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

3.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for CL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 3.2 having regard to the circumstances.

3.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with CL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and CL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

3.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue CL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

3.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of CL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 3.15.

3.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for CL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring CL.

3.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for CL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

3.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of CL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for CL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

3.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for CL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

3.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for CL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

3.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for CL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

3.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to CL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 3.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 3.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 3.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 3.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 3.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 3.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee A avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee B avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee C avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee D avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee E avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee F avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee G avails of CL in excess of this

pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 4.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee H avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee I avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee J avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee K avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee L avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee M avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year.

Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee N avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 2.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee O avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee P avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee Q avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee R avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee S avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee T avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee U avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 3.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee V avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee W avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee X avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 3.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 3.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 3.3. Where Employee Y avails of CL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 3.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — CL

Ref: RSB/HRD/CL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Casual Leave (CL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 3.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Casual Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited

accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 3.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

3.15.1 Sanctioning of CL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

3.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for CL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

3.15.3 CL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 3.4.

3.15.4 Carry-forward of CL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 3.2 without a recorded justification.

3.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for CL.

3.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for CL.

3.15.7 CL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 3.6.

3.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's CL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

3.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where CL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

3.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for CL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

3.15.11 Sanction of CL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 3.12.

3.15.12 Physical-format applications for CL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 3.12.

3.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to CL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 3.11.

3.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of CL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 3.12.

3.15.15 Leave Account for CL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 3.12.

3.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of CL, contrary to Clause 3.12.

3.15.17 CL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 3.12.

3.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for CL, contrary to Clause 3.12.

3.15.19 Sanction order for CL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 3.12.

3.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 3.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 3.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to CL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to CL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to CL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 5-day annual entitlement to CL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to CL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to CL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for CL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 3.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to CL that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 3.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 3.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for CL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 3.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 3.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 3.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for CL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 3.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my CL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 3.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 3.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 5 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 3.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 1 and 5 days against the prescribed entitlement of 5 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CL to which they are entitled under Section 3.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 3.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current CL balance?

Ticket HD-3101: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

My CL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-3102: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

I made an error in my CL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-3103: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Will my CL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-3104: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my CL application?

Ticket HD-3105: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Why was my CL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-3106: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-3107: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I apply for CL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-3108: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

My CL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-3109: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for CL?

Ticket HD-3110: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

CL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned CL after it has started?

Ticket HD-3111: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

How far in advance can I apply for CL?

Ticket HD-3112: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-3113: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I see my CL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-3114: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Who approves CL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-3115: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Does CL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-3116: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I split a single CL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-3117: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

What if my CL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-3118: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I apply for CL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-3119: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Is there a separate process for CL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-3120: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for CL?

Ticket HD-3121: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

How do I download a certificate of CL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-3122: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my CL application?

Ticket HD-3123: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I apply for CL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-3124: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my CL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-3125: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I apply for CL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-3126: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

What happens to my pending CL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-3127: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

CL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my CL application?

Ticket HD-3128: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Is there a helpline number for CL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-3129: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can my CL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-3130: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for CL?

Ticket HD-3131: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my CL application?

Ticket HD-3132: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Is CL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-3133: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Who do I contact if my CL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-3134: Please refer to Section 3.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 3.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CL.

Section 3.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 3.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for CL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 3.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 3.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 3.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 3.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 3.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **CL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to CL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 3.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction CL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to CL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 3.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed CL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which CL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned CL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of CL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 3.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for CL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which CL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 3.12 in connection with sanction of CL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of CL, as described in Clause 3.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction CL under Section 3.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 3.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning CL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent CL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to CL, as illustrated in Section 3.20.

Section 3.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing CL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/CL/2013/100	04-Jan-2013	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CL/2014/107	09-Mar-2014	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CL/2015/114	05-Sep-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CL/2016/121	22-Sep-2016	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CL/2017/128	03-Aug-2017	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CL/2018/135	02-Jan-2018	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CL/2019/142	07-Mar-2019	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CL/2020/149	20-Jan-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CL/2021/156	07-Sep-2021	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CL/2022/163	23-Aug-2022	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CL/2023/170	08-Jun-2023	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CL/2024/177	09-Nov-2024	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CL/2025/184	01-Nov-2025	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CL/2026/191	06-Sep-2026	Clarification on documentation requirements

Section 3.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Marriage Leave (MGL); Chapter on Special Casual Leave (SCL); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 4 — Sick Leave (SL)

Clause 4.1 — Overview and Objective. Sick Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘SL’ in this Manual) is leave granted on account of illness or medical incapacity, supported by valid medical certification where required. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Sick Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to SL. The objective of SL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of sick leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 4.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 4.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 4.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 4.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 4.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 13 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 4.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 4.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 4.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for SL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	12	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	9	22	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	18	19	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	8	13	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	17	18	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	19	7	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	8	9	3 working day(s)

Clause 4.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to SL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of SL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of SL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 4.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 4.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for SL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on SL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 4.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of SL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 4.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

4.5.1 SL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

4.5.2 SL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

4.5.3 An employee proceeding on SL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

4.5.4 SL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 4.6.

4.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for SL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

4.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned SL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

4.5.7 Requests for SL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

4.5.8 SL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 4.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

SL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 4.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine SL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 4.4. Combination of SL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of SL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 4.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q4.7.1. Can SL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 4.6, SL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q4.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing SL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 4.2 for each cadre.

Q4.7.3. What happens to unavailed SL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed SL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q4.7.4. Can SL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for SL.

Q4.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction SL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 4.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q4.7.6. Can SL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, SL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q4.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for SL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 4.2 of this Chapter.

Q4.7.8. Does SL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q4.7.9. Can an employee encash SL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily SL is not encashable in service.

Q4.7.10. What is the maximum SL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 4.2; balances of approximately 9 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q4.7.11. Can SL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of SL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q4.7.12. Is SL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to SL linked to the term of the contract.

Q4.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for SL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 4.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q4.7.14. Does SL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q4.7.15. Can SL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q4.7.16. What proof is required for emergency SL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 4.2.

Q4.7.17. Can SL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 4.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q4.7.18. Is SL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

SL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q4.7.19. Who maintains the official record of SL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 4.9 of this Chapter.

Q4.7.20. Can SL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 4.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q4.7.21. Does SL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q4.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for SL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 4.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q4.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for SL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q4.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SL is not separately debited to the SL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q4.7.25. Can SL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction SL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q4.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of SL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 4.15.

Q4.7.27. Can SL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with SL for the same day.

Q4.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for SL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q4.7.29. Does SL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; SL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q4.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied SL?

No; as clarified in Clause 4.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer SL.

Q4.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for SL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 4.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q4.7.32. Can I be denied SL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 4.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of SL on this ground.

Q4.7.33. Will my SL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 4.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 4.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 4.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for SL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 4.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 4.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for SL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 4.4.

Case 4.8.3. An employee proceeding on SL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 4.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 4.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 4.3.

Case 4.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine SL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 4.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for SL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 4.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 4.8.7. An employee's SL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 4.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where SL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 4.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 4.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought SL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 4.11.7, that the debit to the SL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 4.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile SL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 4.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 4.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of SL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 4.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 4.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for SL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 4.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 4.5.

Case 4.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for SL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 4.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 4.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's SL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 4.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 4.8.15. An employee's SL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 4.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 4.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for SL under Clause 4.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 4.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 4.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are

required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 4.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 4.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 4.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so

that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 4.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 4.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any

further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 4.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 4.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch

Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 4.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is

available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 4.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to SL set out in Section 4.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 4.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of SL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 4.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for SL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 4.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 4.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 4.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

4.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for SL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

4.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to SL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's SL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

4.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of SL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to SL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

4.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of SL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 4.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

4.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for SL under Section 4.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

4.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue SL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for SL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

4.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of SL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

4.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for SL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while SL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 4.5.8 shall apply.

4.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued SL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

4.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for SL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

4.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of SL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of SL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD

Department.

4.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for SL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

4.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for SL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of SL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent SL is encashable.

4.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of SL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

4.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 4.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction SL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

4.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing SL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

4.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of SL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

4.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned SL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

4.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of SL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

4.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned SL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

4.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any SL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

4.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for SL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

4.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for SL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

4.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue SL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

4.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to SL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

4.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of SL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing SL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

4.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for SL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

4.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of SL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

4.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of SL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

4.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise SL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the SL account.

4.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile SL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

4.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail SL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

4.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for SL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of SL exceeding five consecutive days.

4.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for SL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

4.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to SL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 4.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

4.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for SL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 4.2 having regard to the circumstances.

4.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with SL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and SL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

4.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue SL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

4.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of SL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 4.15.

4.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for SL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring SL.

4.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for SL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

4.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of SL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for SL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

4.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for SL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

4.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for SL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

4.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for SL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

4.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to SL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 4.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 4.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 4.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 4.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 4.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee A avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee B avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee C avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee D avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee E avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee F avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee G avails of SL in excess of this

pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee H avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee I avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee J avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee K avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee L avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee M avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year.

Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee N avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee O avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee P avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee Q avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee R avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee S avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee T avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee U avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee V avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee W avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee X avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 4.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 4.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 4.3. Where Employee Y avails of SL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 4.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — SL

Ref: RSB/HRD/SL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Sick Leave (SL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 4.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Sick Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited

accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 4.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

4.15.1 Sanctioning of SL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

4.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for SL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

4.15.3 SL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 4.4.

4.15.4 Carry-forward of SL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 4.2 without a recorded justification.

4.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for SL.

4.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for SL.

4.15.7 SL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 4.6.

4.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's SL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

4.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where SL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

4.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for SL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

4.15.11 Sanction of SL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 4.12.

4.15.12 Physical-format applications for SL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 4.12.

4.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to SL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 4.11.

4.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of SL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 4.12.

4.15.15 Leave Account for SL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 4.12.

4.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of SL, contrary to Clause 4.12.

4.15.17 SL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 4.12.

4.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for SL, contrary to Clause 4.12.

4.15.19 Sanction order for SL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 4.12.

4.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 4.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 4.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to SL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to SL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to SL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to SL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to SL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to SL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for SL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 4.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to SL that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 4.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 4.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for SL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 4.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 4.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 4.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for SL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 4.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my SL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 4.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 4.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 4.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 10 and 13 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SL to which they are entitled under Section 4.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 4.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current SL balance?

Ticket HD-4101: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

My SL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-4102: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

I made an error in my SL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-4103: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Will my SL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-4104: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my SL application?

Ticket HD-4105: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Why was my SL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-4106: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-4107: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I apply for SL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-4108: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

My SL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-4109: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for SL?

Ticket HD-4110: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned SL after it has started?

Ticket HD-4111: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

How far in advance can I apply for SL?

Ticket HD-4112: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-4113: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I see my SL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-4114: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Who approves SL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-4115: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Does SL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-4116: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I split a single SL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-4117: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

What if my SL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-4118: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I apply for SL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-4119: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Is there a separate process for SL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-4120: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for SL?

Ticket HD-4121: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

How do I download a certificate of SL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-4122: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my SL application?

Ticket HD-4123: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I apply for SL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-4124: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my SL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-4125: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I apply for SL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-4126: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

What happens to my pending SL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-4127: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my SL application?

Ticket HD-4128: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Is there a helpline number for SL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-4129: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can my SL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-4130: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for SL?

Ticket HD-4131: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my SL application?

Ticket HD-4132: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Is SL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-4133: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Who do I contact if my SL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-4134: Please refer to Section 4.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 4.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SL.

Section 4.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 4.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for SL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 4.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 4.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 4.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 4.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 4.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **SL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to SL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 4.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction SL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to SL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 4.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed SL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which SL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned SL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of SL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 4.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for SL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which SL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 4.12 in connection with sanction of SL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of SL, as described in Clause 4.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction SL under Section 4.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 4.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning SL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent SL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to SL, as illustrated in Section 4.20.

Section 4.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing SL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SL/2013/100	07-Nov-2013	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SL/2014/107	04-Jan-2014	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SL/2015/114	04-Apr-2015	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SL/2016/121	12-Aug-2016	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SL/2017/128	26-Jan-2017	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SL/2018/135	15-Aug-2018	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2019/142	13-Jan-2019	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SL/2020/149	10-Nov-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SL/2021/156	20-Nov-2021	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2022/163	19-Mar-2022	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SL/2023/170	03-Jan-2023	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2024/177	08-Nov-2024	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2025/184	03-Nov-2025	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SL/2026/191	28-Jan-2026	Clarification on combination with other leave types

Section 4.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Bereavement / Compassionate Leave (BCL); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 5 — Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (EL/PL)

Clause 5.1 — Overview and Objective. Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘EL/PL’ in this Manual) is leave that accrues to an employee on the basis of actual service rendered, and which may be accumulated and encashed subject to ceilings. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Earned Leave / Privilege Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to EL/PL. The objective of EL/PL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of earned leave / privilege leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 5.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 5.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 5.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 5.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 20 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the

application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 5.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 5.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 5.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 16 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.33 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 20 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 5.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for EL/PL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 5 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EL/PL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	21	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	6	10	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	11	20	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	17	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	11	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	16	20	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	5	3 working day(s)

Clause 5.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to EL/PL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of EL/PL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of EL/PL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 5.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 5.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for EL/PL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on EL/PL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 5.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of EL/PL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 5.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

5.5.1 EL/PL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

5.5.2 EL/PL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

5.5.3 An employee proceeding on EL/PL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

5.5.4 EL/PL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 5.6.

5.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for EL/PL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

5.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned EL/PL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

5.5.7 Requests for EL/PL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

5.5.8 EL/PL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 5.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

EL/PL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 5.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine EL/PL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 5.4. Combination of EL/PL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of EL/PL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 5.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q5.7.1. Can EL/PL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 5.6, EL/PL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q5.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing EL/PL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 5.2 for each cadre.

Q5.7.3. What happens to unavailed EL/PL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed EL/PL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q5.7.4. Can EL/PL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for EL/PL.

Q5.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction EL/PL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 5.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q5.7.6. Can EL/PL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, EL/PL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q5.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for EL/PL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 5.2 of this Chapter.

Q5.7.8. Does EL/PL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q5.7.9. Can an employee encash EL/PL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily EL/PL is not encashable in service.

Q5.7.10. What is the maximum EL/PL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 5.2; balances of approximately 6 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q5.7.11. Can EL/PL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of EL/PL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q5.7.12. Is EL/PL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL linked to the term of the contract.

Q5.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for EL/PL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 5.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q5.7.14. Does EL/PL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q5.7.15. Can EL/PL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q5.7.16. What proof is required for emergency EL/PL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 5.2.

Q5.7.17. Can EL/PL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 5.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q5.7.18. Is EL/PL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

EL/PL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q5.7.19. Who maintains the official record of EL/PL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 5.9 of this Chapter.

Q5.7.20. Can EL/PL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 5.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q5.7.21. Does EL/PL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q5.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for EL/PL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 5.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q5.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for EL/PL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q5.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of EL/PL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of EL/PL is not separately debited to the EL/PL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q5.7.25. Can EL/PL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction EL/PL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q5.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of EL/PL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 5.15.

Q5.7.27. Can EL/PL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with EL/PL for the same day.

Q5.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for EL/PL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q5.7.29. Does EL/PL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; EL/PL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q5.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied EL/PL?

No; as clarified in Clause 5.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer EL/PL.

Q5.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for EL/PL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 5.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q5.7.32. Can I be denied EL/PL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 5.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of EL/PL on this ground.

Q5.7.33. Will my EL/PL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 5.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 5.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 5.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for EL/PL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 5.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 5.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for EL/PL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 5.4.

Case 5.8.3. An employee proceeding on EL/PL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 5.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 5.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 5.3.

Case 5.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine EL/PL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 5.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for EL/PL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 5.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 5.8.7. An employee's EL/PL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 5.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where EL/PL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 5.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 5.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought EL/PL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 5.11.7, that the debit to the EL/PL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 5.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile EL/PL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 5.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 5.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of EL/PL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 5.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 5.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for EL/PL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 5.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 5.5.

Case 5.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for EL/PL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 5.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 5.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's EL/PL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 5.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 5.8.15. An employee's EL/PL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 5.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 5.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for EL/PL under Clause 5.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 5.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 5.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 5.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 5.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 5.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 5.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 5.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation

shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 5.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 5.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 5.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 5.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to EL/PL set out in Section 5.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 5.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of EL/PL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 5.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EL/PL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for EL/PL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 5.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 5.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EL/PL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EL/PL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 5.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

5.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for EL/PL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

5.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to EL/PL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's EL/PL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

5.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of EL/PL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to EL/PL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

5.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of EL/PL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 5.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

5.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for EL/PL under Section 5.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

5.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue EL/PL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for EL/PL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

5.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of EL/PL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

5.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for EL/PL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while EL/PL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 5.5.8 shall apply.

5.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued EL/PL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

5.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for EL/PL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

5.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of EL/PL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of EL/PL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

5.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for EL/PL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

5.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for EL/PL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of EL/PL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent EL/PL is encashable.

5.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of EL/PL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

5.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 5.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction EL/PL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

5.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing EL/PL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

5.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of EL/PL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

5.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned EL/PL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

5.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of EL/PL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

5.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned EL/PL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

5.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any EL/PL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

5.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for EL/PL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

5.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for EL/PL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

5.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue EL/PL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

5.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to EL/PL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

5.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of EL/PL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing EL/PL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

5.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for EL/PL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

5.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of EL/PL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

5.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of EL/PL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

5.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise EL/PL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the EL/PL account.

5.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile EL/PL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

5.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail EL/PL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

5.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for EL/PL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of EL/PL exceeding five consecutive days.

5.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for EL/PL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

5.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to EL/PL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 5.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

5.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for EL/PL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 5.2 having regard to the circumstances.

5.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with EL/PL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and EL/PL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

5.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue EL/PL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

5.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of EL/PL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 5.15.

5.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for EL/PL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring EL/PL.

5.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for EL/PL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

5.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of EL/PL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for EL/PL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

5.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for EL/PL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

5.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for EL/PL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

5.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for EL/PL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

5.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to EL/PL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 5.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 5.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 5.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD

Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 5.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 5.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee A avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee B avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee C avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee D avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee E avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee F avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee G avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee H avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee I avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee J avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee K avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee L avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee M avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee N avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee O avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee P avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee Q avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee R avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee S avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee T

avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee U avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee V avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee W avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee X avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 5.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 5.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EL/PL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 5.3. Where Employee Y avails of EL/PL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 5.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — EL/PL

Ref: RSB/HRD/EL-PL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (EL/PL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module,

the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 5.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 5.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

5.15.1 Sanctioning of EL/PL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

5.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for EL/PL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

5.15.3 EL/PL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 5.4.

5.15.4 Carry-forward of EL/PL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 5.2 without a recorded justification.

5.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for EL/PL.

5.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for EL/PL.

5.15.7 EL/PL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 5.6.

5.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's EL/PL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

5.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where EL/PL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

5.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for EL/PL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

5.15.11 Sanction of EL/PL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 5.12.

5.15.12 Physical-format applications for EL/PL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 5.12.

5.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to EL/PL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 5.11.

5.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of EL/PL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 5.12.

5.15.15 Leave Account for EL/PL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 5.12.

5.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of EL/PL, contrary to Clause 5.12.

5.15.17 EL/PL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 5.12.

5.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for EL/PL, contrary to Clause 5.12.

5.15.19 Sanction order for EL/PL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 5.12.

5.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 5.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 5.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 16-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for EL/PL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 5.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the

EL/PL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to EL/PL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 5.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 5.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for EL/PL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 5.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 5.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 5.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for EL/PL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 5.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my EL/PL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 5.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 5.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 16 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of

the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EL/PL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 5.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 17 and 20 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 12 and 16 days against the prescribed entitlement of 16 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 17 and 20 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 2 and 5 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EL/PL to which they are entitled under Section 5.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 5.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current EL/PL balance?

Ticket HD-5101: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

My EL/PL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-5102: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

I made an error in my EL/PL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-5103: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Will my EL/PL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-5104: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my EL/PL application?

Ticket HD-5105: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Why was my EL/PL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-5106: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-5107: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I apply for EL/PL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-5108: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

My EL/PL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-5109: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for EL/PL?

Ticket HD-5110: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

EL/PL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned EL/PL after it has started?

Ticket HD-5111: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

How far in advance can I apply for EL/PL?

Ticket HD-5112: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-5113: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I see my EL/PL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-5114: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Who approves EL/PL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-5115: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Does EL/PL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-5116: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I split a single EL/PL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-5117: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

What if my EL/PL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-5118: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I apply for EL/PL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-5119: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Is there a separate process for EL/PL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-5120: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for EL/PL?

Ticket HD-5121: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

How do I download a certificate of EL/PL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-5122: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my EL/PL application?

Ticket HD-5123: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I apply for EL/PL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-5124: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my EL/PL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-5125: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I apply for EL/PL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-5126: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

What happens to my pending EL/PL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-5127: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

EL/PL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my EL/PL application?

Ticket HD-5128: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Is there a helpline number for EL/PL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-5129: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can my EL/PL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-5130: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for EL/PL?

Ticket HD-5131: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my EL/PL application?

Ticket HD-5132: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Is EL/PL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-5133: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Who do I contact if my EL/PL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-5134: Please refer to Section 5.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 5.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EL/PL.

Section 5.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 5.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for EL/PL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 5.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 5.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 5.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 5.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 5.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **EL/PL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to EL/PL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 5.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction EL/PL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to EL/PL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 5.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed EL/PL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which EL/PL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned EL/PL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of EL/PL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 5.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for EL/PL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which EL/PL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 5.12 in connection with sanction of EL/PL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of EL/PL, as described in Clause 5.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction EL/PL under Section 5.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 5.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning EL/PL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent EL/PL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to EL/PL, as illustrated in Section 5.20.

Section 5.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing EL/PL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2013/100	27-Apr-2013	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2014/107	12-Apr-2014	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2015/114	22-Apr-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2016/121	22-Sep-2016	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2017/128	20-Sep-2017	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2018/135	18-Sep-2018	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2019/142	06-Jun-2019	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2020/149	09-Sep-2020	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2021/156	18-Mar-2021	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2022/163	11-Nov-2022	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2023/170	25-Jan-2023	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2024/177	27-Jan-2024	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2025/184	11-Jun-2025	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2026/191	03-Mar-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 5.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Election Duty Leave (EDL); Chapter on Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (LTC); Chapter on Special Casual Leave (SCL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 6 — Maternity Leave (ML)

Clause 6.1 — Overview and Objective. Maternity Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘ML’ in this Manual) is leave granted to women employees in connection with childbirth, in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act and internal regulations. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Maternity Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to ML. The objective of ML is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of maternity leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 6.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 6.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 15 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 6.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 6.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 14 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 6.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 6.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 5 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 6.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 14 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 6.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for ML up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 24 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for ML by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	22	15	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	9	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	21	14	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	23	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	12	5	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	17	14	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	6	24	3 working day(s)

Clause 6.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to ML for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of ML for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of ML of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 6.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 6.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for ML shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on ML without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 6.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of ML, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 6.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

6.5.1 ML shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

6.5.2 ML availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

6.5.3 An employee proceeding on ML while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

6.5.4 ML may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 6.6.

6.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for ML, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

6.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned ML, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

6.5.7 Requests for ML during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

6.5.8 ML sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 6.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

ML may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 6.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine ML with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 6.4. Combination of ML with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of ML, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 6.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q6.7.1. Can ML be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 6.6, ML may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q6.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing ML?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 6.2 for each cadre.

Q6.7.3. What happens to unavailed ML at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed ML balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q6.7.4. Can ML be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for ML.

Q6.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction ML for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 6.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q6.7.6. Can ML be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, ML may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q6.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for ML?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 6.2 of this Chapter.

Q6.7.8. Does ML accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q6.7.9. Can an employee encash ML while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily ML is not encashable in service.

Q6.7.10. What is the maximum ML balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 6.2; balances of approximately 7 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q6.7.11. Can ML be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of ML is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q6.7.12. Is ML available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to ML linked to the term of the contract.

Q6.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for ML?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 6.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q6.7.14. Does ML lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q6.7.15. Can ML be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q6.7.16. What proof is required for emergency ML availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 6.2.

Q6.7.17. Can ML entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 6.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q6.7.18. Is ML counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

ML availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q6.7.19. Who maintains the official record of ML for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 6.9 of this Chapter.

Q6.7.20. Can ML be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 6.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q6.7.21. Does ML entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q6.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for ML exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 6.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q6.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for ML after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q6.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of ML?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of ML is not separately debited to the ML account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q6.7.25. Can ML be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction ML to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q6.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of ML?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 6.15.

Q6.7.27. Can ML be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with ML for the same day.

Q6.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for ML within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q6.7.29. Does ML availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; ML availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q6.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied ML?

No; as clarified in Clause 6.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer ML.

Q6.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for ML if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 6.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q6.7.32. Can I be denied ML because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 6.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of ML on this ground.

Q6.7.33. Will my ML application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 6.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 6.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 6.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for ML for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 6.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 6.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for ML was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 6.4.

Case 6.8.3. An employee proceeding on ML was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 6.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 6.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 6.3.

Case 6.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine ML with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 6.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for ML was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 6.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 6.8.7. An employee's ML was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 6.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where ML had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 6.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 6.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought ML spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 6.11.7, that the debit to the ML account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 6.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile ML balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 6.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 6.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of ML was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 6.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 6.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for ML coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 6.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 6.5.

Case 6.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for ML through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 6.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 6.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's ML application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 6.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 6.8.15. An employee's ML entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 6.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 6.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for ML under Clause 6.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 6.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 6.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are

required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 6.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 6.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 6.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so

that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 6.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 6.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any

further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 6.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 6.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch

Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 6.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is

available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 6.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to ML set out in Section 6.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 6.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of ML sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 6.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to ML arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for ML utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 6.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 6.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of ML to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for ML from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 6.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

6.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for ML exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

6.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to ML under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's ML account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

6.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of ML sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to ML for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

6.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of ML may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 6.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

6.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for ML under Section 6.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

6.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue ML against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for ML during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

6.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of ML within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

6.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for ML shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while ML stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 6.5.8 shall apply.

6.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued ML balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

6.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for ML, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

6.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of ML availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of ML entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD

Department.

6.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for ML, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

6.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for ML on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of ML remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent ML is encashable.

6.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of ML shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

6.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 6.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction ML to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

6.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing ML shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

6.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of ML shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

6.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned ML, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

6.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of ML, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

6.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned ML spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

6.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any ML balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

6.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for ML may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

6.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for ML on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

6.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue ML in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

6.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to ML, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

6.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of ML shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing ML that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

6.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for ML shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

6.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of ML shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

6.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of ML, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

6.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise ML for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the ML account.

6.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile ML availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

6.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail ML in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

6.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for ML that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of ML exceeding five consecutive days.

6.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for ML, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

6.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to ML recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 6.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

6.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for ML to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 6.2 having regard to the circumstances.

6.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with ML coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and ML under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

6.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue ML under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

6.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of ML shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 6.15.

6.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for ML on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring ML.

6.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for ML spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

6.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of ML or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for ML shall be liable to action under that Policy.

6.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for ML during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

6.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for ML on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

6.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for ML, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

6.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to ML not resolved through the FAQ in Section 6.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 6.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 6.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 6.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 6.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee A avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee B avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee C avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee D avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee E avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee F avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee G avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee H avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee I avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee J avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee K avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee L avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee M avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee N avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee O avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee P avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee Q avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee R avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee S avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee T avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee U avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee V avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee W avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee X avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 6.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 6.3, the pro-rata entitlement to ML for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 6.3. Where Employee Y avails of ML in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 6.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — ML

Ref: RSB/HRD/ML/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Maternity Leave (ML) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 6.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Maternity Leave for [Number]

day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 6.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

6.15.1 Sanctioning of ML recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

6.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for ML exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

6.15.3 ML sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 6.4.

6.15.4 Carry-forward of ML balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 6.2 without a recorded justification.

6.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for ML.

6.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for ML.

6.15.7 ML combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 6.6.

6.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's ML account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

6.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where ML was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

6.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for ML beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

6.15.11 Sanction of ML recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 6.12.

6.15.12 Physical-format applications for ML, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 6.12.

6.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to ML inconsistent with the provisions of Section 6.11.

6.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of ML within entitlement, contrary to Clause 6.12.

6.15.15 Leave Account for ML not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 6.12.

6.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of ML, contrary to Clause 6.12.

6.15.17 ML entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 6.12.

6.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for ML, contrary to Clause 6.12.

6.15.19 Sanction order for ML issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 6.12.

6.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 6.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 6.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to ML that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to ML that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to ML that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to ML that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to ML that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to ML that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for ML are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 6.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the ML is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to ML that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 6.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 6.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for ML dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 6.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 6.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 6.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for ML is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 6.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my ML balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 6.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 6.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of ML utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 6.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 12 and 15 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 11 and 14 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 2 and 5 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 11 and 14 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 21 and 24 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for ML to which they are entitled under Section 6.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 6.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current ML balance?

Ticket HD-6101: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

My ML application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-6102: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

I made an error in my ML application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-6103: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Will my ML be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-6104: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I attach a document after submitting my ML application?

Ticket HD-6105: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Why was my ML auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-6106: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-6107: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I apply for ML on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-6108: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

My ML balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-6109: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Is there a mobile app to apply for ML?

Ticket HD-6110: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

ML.

Can I cancel a sanctioned ML after it has started?

Ticket HD-6111: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

How far in advance can I apply for ML?

Ticket HD-6112: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-6113: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I see my ML history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-6114: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Who approves ML if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-6115: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Does ML availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-6116: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I split a single ML application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-6117: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

What if my ML balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-6118: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I apply for ML for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-6119: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Is there a separate process for ML during my notice period?

Ticket HD-6120: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for ML?

Ticket HD-6121: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

How do I download a certificate of ML availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-6122: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my ML application?

Ticket HD-6123: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I apply for ML if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-6124: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my ML balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-6125: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I apply for ML using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-6126: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

What happens to my pending ML application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-6127: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

ML.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my ML application?

Ticket HD-6128: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Is there a helpline number for ML queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-6129: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can my ML application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-6130: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for ML?

Ticket HD-6131: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my ML application?

Ticket HD-6132: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Is ML entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-6133: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Who do I contact if my ML application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-6134: Please refer to Section 6.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 6.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code ML.

Section 6.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 6.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for ML from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 6.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 6.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 6.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 6.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 6.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **ML Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to ML accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 6.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction ML for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to ML computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 6.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed ML balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which ML availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned ML is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of ML records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 6.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for ML to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which ML entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 6.12 in connection with sanction of ML.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of ML, as described in Clause 6.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction ML under Section 6.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 6.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning ML.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent ML balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to ML, as illustrated in Section 6.20.

Section 6.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing ML since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/ML/2013/100	21-Jun-2013	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2014/107	21-Jun-2014	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/ML/2015/114	09-Mar-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2016/121	24-Aug-2016	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2017/128	09-Sep-2017	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/ML/2018/135	14-Aug-2018	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/ML/2019/142	12-Mar-2019	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/ML/2020/149	17-Jun-2020	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2021/156	25-Jan-2021	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/ML/2022/163	04-Mar-2022	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/ML/2023/170	06-Nov-2023	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/ML/2024/177	14-Aug-2024	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/ML/2025/184	13-Jun-2025	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/ML/2026/191	15-Aug-2026	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction

Section 6.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); Chapter on Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA); Chapter on Casual Leave (CL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 7 — Paternity Leave (PTL)

Clause 7.1 — Overview and Objective. Paternity Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘PTL’ in this Manual) is leave granted to male employees on the birth of a child, to enable them to support their spouse and newborn. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Paternity Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to PTL. The objective of PTL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of paternity leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 7.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 7.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 16 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.33 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 7.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 14 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 7.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 7.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 5 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 7.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 7.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 24 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 7.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for PTL up to a maximum of 5 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PTL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	16	9	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	21	14	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	15	11	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	20	5	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	10	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	24	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	5	21	3 working day(s)

Clause 7.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to PTL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of PTL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of PTL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 7.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 7.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for PTL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on PTL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 7.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of PTL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 7.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

7.5.1 PTL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

7.5.2 PTL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

7.5.3 An employee proceeding on PTL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

7.5.4 PTL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 7.6.

7.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for PTL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

7.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned PTL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

7.5.7 Requests for PTL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

7.5.8 PTL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 7.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

PTL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 7.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine PTL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 7.4. Combination of PTL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of PTL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 7.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q7.7.1. Can PTL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 7.6, PTL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q7.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing PTL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 7.2 for each cadre.

Q7.7.3. What happens to unavailed PTL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed PTL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q7.7.4. Can PTL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for PTL.

Q7.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction PTL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 7.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q7.7.6. Can PTL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, PTL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q7.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for PTL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 7.2 of this Chapter.

Q7.7.8. Does PTL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q7.7.9. Can an employee encash PTL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily PTL is not encashable in service.

Q7.7.10. What is the maximum PTL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 7.2; balances of approximately 21 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q7.7.11. Can PTL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of PTL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q7.7.12. Is PTL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to PTL linked to the term of the contract.

Q7.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for PTL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 7.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q7.7.14. Does PTL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q7.7.15. Can PTL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q7.7.16. What proof is required for emergency PTL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 7.2.

Q7.7.17. Can PTL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 7.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q7.7.18. Is PTL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

PTL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q7.7.19. Who maintains the official record of PTL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 7.9 of this Chapter.

Q7.7.20. Can PTL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 7.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q7.7.21. Does PTL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q7.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for PTL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 7.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q7.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for PTL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q7.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of PTL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of PTL is not separately debited to the PTL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q7.7.25. Can PTL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction PTL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q7.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of PTL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 7.15.

Q7.7.27. Can PTL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with PTL for the same day.

Q7.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for PTL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q7.7.29. Does PTL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; PTL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q7.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied PTL?

No; as clarified in Clause 7.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer PTL.

Q7.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for PTL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 7.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q7.7.32. Can I be denied PTL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 7.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of PTL on this ground.

Q7.7.33. Will my PTL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 7.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 7.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 7.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for PTL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 7.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 7.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for PTL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 7.4.

Case 7.8.3. An employee proceeding on PTL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 7.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 7.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 7.3.

Case 7.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine PTL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 7.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for PTL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 7.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 7.8.7. An employee's PTL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 7.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where PTL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 7.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 7.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought PTL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 7.11.7, that the debit to the PTL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 7.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile PTL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 7.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 7.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of PTL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 7.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 7.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for PTL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 7.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 7.5.

Case 7.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for PTL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 7.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 7.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's PTL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 7.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 7.8.15. An employee's PTL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 7.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 7.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for PTL under Clause 7.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 7.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 7.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 7.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 7.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 7.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 7.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 7.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation

shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 7.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 7.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 7.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 7.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to PTL set out in Section 7.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 7.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of PTL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 7.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PTL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for PTL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 7.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 7.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PTL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PTL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 7.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

7.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for PTL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

7.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to PTL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's PTL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

7.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of PTL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to PTL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

7.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of PTL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 7.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

7.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for PTL under Section 7.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

7.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue PTL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for PTL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

7.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of PTL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

7.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for PTL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while PTL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 7.5.8 shall apply.

7.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued PTL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

7.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for PTL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

7.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of PTL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of PTL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD

Department.

7.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for PTL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

7.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for PTL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of PTL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent PTL is encashable.

7.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of PTL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

7.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 7.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction PTL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

7.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing PTL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

7.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of PTL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

7.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned PTL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

7.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of PTL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

7.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned PTL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

7.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any PTL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

7.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for PTL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

7.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for PTL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

7.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue PTL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

7.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to PTL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

7.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of PTL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing PTL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

7.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for PTL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

7.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of PTL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

7.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of PTL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

7.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise PTL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the PTL account.

7.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile PTL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

7.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail PTL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

7.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for PTL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of PTL exceeding five consecutive days.

7.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for PTL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

7.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to PTL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 7.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

7.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for PTL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 7.2 having regard to the circumstances.

7.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with PTL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and PTL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

7.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue PTL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

7.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of PTL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 7.15.

7.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for PTL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring PTL.

7.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for PTL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

7.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of PTL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for PTL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

7.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for PTL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

7.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for PTL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

7.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for PTL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

7.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to PTL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 7.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 7.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 7.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 7.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 7.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee A avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 4.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee B avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee C avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee D avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee E avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee F avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee G avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee H avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 2.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee I avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee J avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee K avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee L avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee M avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee N avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee O avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 3.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee P avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee Q avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee R avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee S avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee T avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee U avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee V avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 4.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee W avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee X avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 7.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 7.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PTL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 7.3. Where Employee Y avails of PTL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 7.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — PTL

Ref: RSB/HRD/PTL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Paternity Leave (PTL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 7.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Paternity Leave for [Number]

day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 7.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

7.15.1 Sanctioning of PTL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

7.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for PTL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

7.15.3 PTL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 7.4.

7.15.4 Carry-forward of PTL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 7.2 without a recorded justification.

7.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for PTL.

7.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for PTL.

7.15.7 PTL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 7.6.

7.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's PTL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

7.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where PTL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

7.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for PTL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

7.15.11 Sanction of PTL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 7.12.

7.15.12 Physical-format applications for PTL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 7.12.

7.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to PTL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 7.11.

7.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of PTL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 7.12.

7.15.15 Leave Account for PTL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 7.12.

7.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of PTL, contrary to Clause 7.12.

7.15.17 PTL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 7.12.

7.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for PTL, contrary to Clause 7.12.

7.15.19 Sanction order for PTL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 7.12.

7.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 7.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 7.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 16-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for PTL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 7.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PTL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 5-day annual entitlement to PTL that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 7.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 7.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for PTL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 7.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 7.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 7.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for PTL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 7.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my PTL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 7.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 7.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 16 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PTL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 5 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 7.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 12 and 16 days against the prescribed entitlement of 16 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 11 and 14 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 2 and 5 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 21 and 24 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 1 and 5 days against the prescribed entitlement of 5 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PTL to which they are entitled under Section 7.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 7.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current PTL balance?

Ticket HD-7101: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

My PTL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-7102: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

I made an error in my PTL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-7103: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Will my PTL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-7104: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my PTL application?

Ticket HD-7105: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Why was my PTL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-7106: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-7107: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I apply for PTL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-7108: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

My PTL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-7109: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for PTL?

Ticket HD-7110: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

PTL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned PTL after it has started?

Ticket HD-7111: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

How far in advance can I apply for PTL?

Ticket HD-7112: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-7113: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I see my PTL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-7114: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Who approves PTL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-7115: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Does PTL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-7116: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I split a single PTL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-7117: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

What if my PTL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-7118: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I apply for PTL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-7119: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Is there a separate process for PTL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-7120: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for PTL?

Ticket HD-7121: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

How do I download a certificate of PTL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-7122: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my PTL application?

Ticket HD-7123: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I apply for PTL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-7124: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my PTL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-7125: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I apply for PTL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-7126: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

What happens to my pending PTL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-7127: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

PTL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my PTL application?

Ticket HD-7128: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Is there a helpline number for PTL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-7129: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can my PTL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-7130: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for PTL?

Ticket HD-7131: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my PTL application?

Ticket HD-7132: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Is PTL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-7133: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Who do I contact if my PTL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-7134: Please refer to Section 7.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 7.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PTL.

Section 7.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 7.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for PTL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 7.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 7.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 7.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 7.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 7.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **PTL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to PTL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 7.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction PTL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to PTL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 7.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed PTL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which PTL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned PTL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of PTL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 7.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for PTL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which PTL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 7.12 in connection with sanction of PTL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of PTL, as described in Clause 7.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction PTL under Section 7.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 7.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning PTL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent PTL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to PTL, as illustrated in Section 7.20.

Section 7.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing PTL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/PTL/2013/100	24-Jan-2013	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PTL/2014/107	18-Nov-2014	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PTL/2015/114	25-Sep-2015	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PTL/2016/121	04-Apr-2016	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PTL/2017/128	06-Jun-2017	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/PTL/2018/135	24-Sep-2018	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/PTL/2019/142	17-Nov-2019	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PTL/2020/149	17-Jan-2020	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PTL/2021/156	21-Apr-2021	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PTL/2022/163	21-Aug-2022	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PTL/2023/170	07-Mar-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PTL/2024/177	25-Mar-2024	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PTL/2025/184	25-Aug-2025	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PTL/2026/191	20-Apr-2026	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres

Section 7.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Quarantine Leave (QL); Chapter on Casual Leave (CL); Chapter on Maternity Leave (ML); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 8 — Adoption Leave (AL)

Clause 8.1 — Overview and Objective. Adoption Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘AL’ in this Manual) is leave granted to an employee who legally adopts a child below a prescribed age. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Adoption Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to AL. The objective of AL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of adoption leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 8.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 8.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 8.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 8.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 5 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 8.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 8.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 8.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 24 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 8.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for AL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for AL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	14	17	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	8	23	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	5	8	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	15	22	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	24	7	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	9	24	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	15	18	3 working day(s)

Clause 8.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to AL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of AL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of AL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 8.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 8.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for AL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on AL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 8.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of AL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 8.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

8.5.1 AL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

8.5.2 AL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

8.5.3 An employee proceeding on AL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

8.5.4 AL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 8.6.

8.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for AL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

8.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned AL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

8.5.7 Requests for AL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

8.5.8 AL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 8.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

AL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 8.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine AL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 8.4. Combination of AL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of AL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 8.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q8.7.1. Can AL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 8.6, AL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q8.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing AL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 8.2 for each cadre.

Q8.7.3. What happens to unavailed AL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed AL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q8.7.4. Can AL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for AL.

Q8.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction AL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 8.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q8.7.6. Can AL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, AL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q8.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for AL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 8.2 of this Chapter.

Q8.7.8. Does AL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q8.7.9. Can an employee encash AL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily AL is not encashable in service.

Q8.7.10. What is the maximum AL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 8.2; balances of approximately 8 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q8.7.11. Can AL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of AL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q8.7.12. Is AL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to AL linked to the term of the contract.

Q8.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for AL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 8.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q8.7.14. Does AL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q8.7.15. Can AL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q8.7.16. What proof is required for emergency AL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 8.2.

Q8.7.17. Can AL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 8.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q8.7.18. Is AL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

AL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q8.7.19. Who maintains the official record of AL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 8.9 of this Chapter.

Q8.7.20. Can AL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 8.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q8.7.21. Does AL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q8.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for AL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 8.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q8.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for AL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q8.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of AL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of AL is not separately debited to the AL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q8.7.25. Can AL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction AL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q8.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of AL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 8.15.

Q8.7.27. Can AL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with AL for the same day.

Q8.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for AL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q8.7.29. Does AL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; AL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q8.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied AL?

No; as clarified in Clause 8.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer AL.

Q8.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for AL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 8.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q8.7.32. Can I be denied AL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 8.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of AL on this ground.

Q8.7.33. Will my AL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 8.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 8.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 8.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for AL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 8.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 8.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for AL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 8.4.

Case 8.8.3. An employee proceeding on AL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 8.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 8.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 8.3.

Case 8.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine AL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 8.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for AL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 8.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 8.8.7. An employee's AL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 8.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where AL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 8.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 8.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought AL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 8.11.7, that the debit to the AL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 8.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile AL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 8.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 8.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of AL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 8.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 8.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for AL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 8.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 8.5.

Case 8.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for AL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 8.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 8.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's AL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 8.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 8.8.15. An employee's AL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 8.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 8.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for AL under Clause 8.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 8.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 8.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are

required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 8.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 8.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 8.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so

that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 8.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 8.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any

further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 8.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 8.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch

Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 8.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is

available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 8.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to AL set out in Section 8.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 8.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of AL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 8.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to AL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for AL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 8.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 8.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of AL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for AL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 8.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

8.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for AL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

8.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to AL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's AL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

8.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of AL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to AL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

8.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of AL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 8.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

8.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for AL under Section 8.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

8.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue AL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for AL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

8.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of AL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

8.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for AL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while AL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 8.5.8 shall apply.

8.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued AL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

8.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for AL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

8.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of AL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of AL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD

Department.

8.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for AL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

8.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for AL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of AL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent AL is encashable.

8.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of AL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

8.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 8.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction AL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

8.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing AL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

8.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of AL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

8.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned AL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

8.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of AL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

8.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned AL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

8.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any AL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

8.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for AL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

8.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for AL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

8.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue AL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

8.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to AL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

8.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of AL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing AL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

8.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for AL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

8.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of AL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

8.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of AL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

8.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise AL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the AL account.

8.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile AL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

8.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail AL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

8.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for AL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of AL exceeding five consecutive days.

8.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for AL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

8.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to AL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 8.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

8.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for AL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 8.2 having regard to the circumstances.

8.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with AL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and AL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

8.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue AL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

8.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of AL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 8.15.

8.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for AL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring AL.

8.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for AL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

8.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of AL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for AL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

8.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for AL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

8.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for AL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

8.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for AL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

8.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to AL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 8.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 8.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 8.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 8.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 8.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee A avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee B avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 2.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee C avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee D avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee E avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee F avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee G avails of AL in excess of this

pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee H avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee I avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 3.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee J avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee K avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee L avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee M avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year.

Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee N avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee O avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee P avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 4.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee Q avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee R avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee S avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee T avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee U avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee V avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee W avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 2.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee X avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 8.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 8.3, the pro-rata entitlement to AL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 8.3. Where Employee Y avails of AL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 8.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — AL

Ref: RSB/HRD/AL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Adoption Leave (AL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 8.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Adoption Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been

debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 8.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

8.15.1 Sanctioning of AL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

8.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for AL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

8.15.3 AL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 8.4.

8.15.4 Carry-forward of AL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 8.2 without a recorded justification.

8.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for AL.

8.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for AL.

8.15.7 AL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 8.6.

8.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's AL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

8.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where AL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

8.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for AL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

8.15.11 Sanction of AL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 8.12.

8.15.12 Physical-format applications for AL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 8.12.

8.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to AL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 8.11.

8.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of AL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 8.12.

8.15.15 Leave Account for AL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 8.12.

8.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of AL, contrary to Clause 8.12.

8.15.17 AL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 8.12.

8.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for AL, contrary to Clause 8.12.

8.15.19 Sanction order for AL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 8.12.

8.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 8.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 8.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to AL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to AL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 5-day annual entitlement to AL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to AL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to AL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to AL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for AL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 8.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the AL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to AL that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 8.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 8.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for AL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 8.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 8.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 8.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for AL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 8.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my AL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 8.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 8.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 5 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of AL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 8.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 1 and 5 days against the prescribed entitlement of 5 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 21 and 24 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for AL to which they are entitled under Section 8.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 8.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current AL balance?

Ticket HD-8101: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

My AL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-8102: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

I made an error in my AL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-8103: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Will my AL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-8104: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my AL application?

Ticket HD-8105: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Why was my AL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-8106: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-8107: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I apply for AL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-8108: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

My AL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-8109: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for AL?

Ticket HD-8110: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

AL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned AL after it has started?

Ticket HD-8111: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

How far in advance can I apply for AL?

Ticket HD-8112: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-8113: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I see my AL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-8114: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Who approves AL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-8115: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Does AL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-8116: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I split a single AL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-8117: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

What if my AL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-8118: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I apply for AL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-8119: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Is there a separate process for AL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-8120: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for AL?

Ticket HD-8121: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

How do I download a certificate of AL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-8122: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my AL application?

Ticket HD-8123: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I apply for AL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-8124: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my AL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-8125: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I apply for AL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-8126: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

What happens to my pending AL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-8127: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

AL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my AL application?

Ticket HD-8128: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Is there a helpline number for AL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-8129: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can my AL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-8130: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for AL?

Ticket HD-8131: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my AL application?

Ticket HD-8132: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Is AL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-8133: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Who do I contact if my AL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-8134: Please refer to Section 8.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 8.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code AL.

Section 8.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 8.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for AL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 8.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 8.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 8.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 8.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 8.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **AL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to AL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 8.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction AL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to AL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 8.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed AL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which AL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned AL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of AL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 8.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for AL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which AL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 8.12 in connection with sanction of AL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of AL, as described in Clause 8.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction AL under Section 8.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 8.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning AL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent AL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to AL, as illustrated in Section 8.20.

Section 8.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing AL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/AL/2013/100	27-Nov-2013	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/AL/2014/107	08-Jan-2014	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/AL/2015/114	19-Jan-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/AL/2016/121	24-Jun-2016	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/AL/2017/128	03-Nov-2017	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/AL/2018/135	25-Mar-2018	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/AL/2019/142	22-Jun-2019	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/AL/2020/149	06-Apr-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/AL/2021/156	28-Aug-2021	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/AL/2022/163	07-Aug-2022	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/AL/2023/170	24-Sep-2023	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/AL/2024/177	23-Apr-2024	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/AL/2025/184	22-Sep-2025	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/AL/2026/191	15-Aug-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 8.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); Chapter on Maternity Leave (ML); Chapter on Sabbatical Leave (SBL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 9 — Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (SDE)

Clause 9.1 — Overview and Objective. Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘SDE’ in this Manual) is additional leave granted to employees certified as persons with benchmark disabilities. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to SDE. The objective of SDE is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of special leave for differently-abled employees without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 9.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 9.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 9.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 9.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance

through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 9.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 23 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 16 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 9.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 9.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 9.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for SDE up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SDE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in

cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	19	12	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	24	17	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	9	11	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	23	16	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	20	22	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	14	7	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	19	21	3 working day(s)

Clause 9.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to SDE for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of SDE for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of SDE of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 9.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 9.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for SDE shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on SDE without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 9.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of SDE, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 9.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

9.5.1 SDE shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

9.5.2 SDE availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

9.5.3 An employee proceeding on SDE while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

9.5.4 SDE may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 9.6.

9.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for SDE, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

9.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned SDE, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

9.5.7 Requests for SDE during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

9.5.8 SDE sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 9.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

SDE may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 9.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine SDE with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 9.4. Combination of SDE with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of SDE, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 9.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q9.7.1. Can SDE be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 9.6, SDE may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q9.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing SDE?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 9.2 for each cadre.

Q9.7.3. What happens to unavailed SDE at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed SDE balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q9.7.4. Can SDE be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for SDE.

Q9.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction SDE for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 9.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q9.7.6. Can SDE be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, SDE may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q9.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for SDE?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 9.2 of this Chapter.

Q9.7.8. Does SDE accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q9.7.9. Can an employee encash SDE while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily SDE is not encashable in service.

Q9.7.10. What is the maximum SDE balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 9.2; balances of approximately 24 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q9.7.11. Can SDE be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of SDE is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q9.7.12. Is SDE available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to SDE linked to the term of the contract.

Q9.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for SDE?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 9.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q9.7.14. Does SDE lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q9.7.15. Can SDE be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q9.7.16. What proof is required for emergency SDE availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 9.2.

Q9.7.17. Can SDE entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 9.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q9.7.18. Is SDE counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

SDE availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q9.7.19. Who maintains the official record of SDE for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 9.9 of this Chapter.

Q9.7.20. Can SDE be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 9.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q9.7.21. Does SDE entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q9.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for SDE exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 9.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q9.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for SDE after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q9.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SDE?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SDE is not separately debited to the SDE account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q9.7.25. Can SDE be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction SDE to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q9.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of SDE?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 9.15.

Q9.7.27. Can SDE be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with SDE for the same day.

Q9.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for SDE within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q9.7.29. Does SDE availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; SDE availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q9.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied SDE?

No; as clarified in Clause 9.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer SDE.

Q9.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for SDE if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 9.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q9.7.32. Can I be denied SDE because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 9.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of SDE on this ground.

Q9.7.33. Will my SDE application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 9.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 9.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 9.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for SDE for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 9.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 9.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for SDE was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 9.4.

Case 9.8.3. An employee proceeding on SDE was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 9.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 9.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 9.3.

Case 9.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine SDE with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 9.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for SDE was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 9.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 9.8.7. An employee's SDE was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 9.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where SDE had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 9.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 9.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought SDE spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 9.11.7, that the debit to the SDE account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 9.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile SDE balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 9.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 9.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of SDE was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 9.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 9.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for SDE coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 9.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 9.5.

Case 9.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for SDE through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 9.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 9.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's SDE application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 9.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 9.8.15. An employee's SDE entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 9.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 9.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for SDE under Clause 9.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 9.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 9.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SDE

set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 9.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of

reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 9.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 9.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 9.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 9.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 9.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 9.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save

that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 9.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager

responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 9.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to SDE set out in Section 9.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 9.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of SDE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 9.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SDE arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for SDE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 9.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 9.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SDE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SDE from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 9.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

9.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for SDE exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

9.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to SDE under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent

of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's SDE account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

9.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of SDE sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to SDE for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

9.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of SDE may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 9.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

9.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for SDE under Section 9.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

9.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue SDE against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for SDE during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

9.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of SDE within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

9.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for SDE shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while SDE stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 9.5.8 shall apply.

9.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued SDE balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

9.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for SDE, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

9.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of SDE availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of SDE entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

9.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for SDE, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

9.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for SDE on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of SDE remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent SDE is encashable.

9.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of SDE shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

9.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 9.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction SDE to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

9.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing SDE shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

9.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of SDE shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

9.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned SDE, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

9.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of SDE, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly

Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

9.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned SDE spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

9.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any SDE balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

9.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for SDE may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

9.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for SDE on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

9.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue SDE in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

9.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to SDE, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

9.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of SDE shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing SDE that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

9.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for SDE shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

9.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of SDE shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

9.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of SDE, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

9.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise SDE for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the SDE account.

9.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile SDE availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

9.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail SDE in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

9.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for SDE that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of SDE exceeding five consecutive days.

9.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for SDE, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

9.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to SDE recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 9.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

9.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for SDE to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 9.2 having regard to the circumstances.

9.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with SDE coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and SDE under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

9.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue SDE under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

9.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of SDE shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 9.15.

9.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for SDE on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring SDE.

9.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for SDE spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

9.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of SDE or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for SDE shall be liable to action under that Policy.

9.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for SDE during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

9.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for SDE on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

9.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for SDE, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

9.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to SDE not resolved through the FAQ in Section 9.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 9.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 9.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 9.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 9.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee A avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee B avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee C avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee D avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee E avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee F avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be

treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee G avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 19.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee H avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee I avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee J avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee K avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee L avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee M works out

to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee M avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee N avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee O avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee P avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee Q avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee R avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee S avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee T avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee U avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee V avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee W avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee X avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 9.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 9.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SDE for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 9.3. Where Employee Y avails of SDE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 9.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — SDE

Ref: RSB/HRD/SDE/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (SDE) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 9.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 9.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

9.15.1 Sanctioning of SDE recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

9.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for SDE exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

9.15.3 SDE sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 9.4.

9.15.4 Carry-forward of SDE balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 9.2 without a recorded justification.

9.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for SDE.

9.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for SDE.

9.15.7 SDE combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 9.6.

9.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's SDE account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

9.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where SDE was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

9.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for SDE beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

9.15.11 Sanction of SDE recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 9.12.

9.15.12 Physical-format applications for SDE, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 9.12.

9.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to SDE inconsistent with the provisions of Section 9.11.

9.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of SDE within entitlement, contrary to Clause 9.12.

9.15.15 Leave Account for SDE not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 9.12.

9.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of SDE, contrary to Clause 9.12.

9.15.17 SDE entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 9.12.

9.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for SDE, contrary to Clause 9.12.

9.15.19 Sanction order for SDE issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 9.12.

9.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 9.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 9.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall

additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 23-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for SDE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 9.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SDE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to SDE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 9.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 9.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for SDE dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 9.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 9.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 9.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for SDE is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 9.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my SDE balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 9.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 9.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to

the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 23 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SDE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 9.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment

trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 19 and 23 days against the prescribed entitlement of 23 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 13 and 16 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SDE to which they are entitled under Section 9.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 9.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current SDE balance?

Ticket HD-9101: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

My SDE application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-9102: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

I made an error in my SDE application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-9103: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Will my SDE be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-9104: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I attach a document after submitting my SDE application?

Ticket HD-9105: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Why was my SDE auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-9106: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-9107: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I apply for SDE on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-9108: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

My SDE balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-9109: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the

Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Is there a mobile app to apply for SDE?

Ticket HD-9110: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I cancel a sanctioned SDE after it has started?

Ticket HD-9111: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

How far in advance can I apply for SDE?

Ticket HD-9112: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-9113: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I see my SDE history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-9114: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Who approves SDE if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-9115: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Does SDE availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-9116: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I split a single SDE application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-9117: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

What if my SDE balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-9118: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I apply for SDE for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-9119: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Is there a separate process for SDE during my notice period?

Ticket HD-9120: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for SDE?

Ticket HD-9121: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

How do I download a certificate of SDE availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-9122: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my SDE application?

Ticket HD-9123: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I apply for SDE if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-9124: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my SDE balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-9125: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I apply for SDE using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-9126: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SDE.

What happens to my pending SDE application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-9127: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my SDE application?

Ticket HD-9128: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Is there a helpline number for SDE queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-9129: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can my SDE application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-9130: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for SDE?

Ticket HD-9131: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my SDE application?

Ticket HD-9132: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Is SDE entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-9133: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Who do I contact if my SDE application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-9134: Please refer to Section 9.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 9.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SDE.

Section 9.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 9.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for SDE from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 9.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 9.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 9.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 9.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 9.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **SDE Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to SDE accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 9.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction SDE for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to SDE computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 9.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed SDE balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which SDE availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned SDE is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of SDE records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 9.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for SDE to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which SDE entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 9.12 in connection with sanction of SDE.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of SDE, as described in Clause 9.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction SDE under Section 9.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 9.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning SDE.

- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent SDE balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to SDE, as illustrated in Section 9.20.

Section 9.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing SDE since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SDE/2013/100	03-Apr-2013	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SDE/2014/107	19-Aug-2014	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SDE/2015/114	19-Mar-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SDE/2016/121	03-Sep-2016	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SDE/2017/128	02-Mar-2017	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SDE/2018/135	02-Nov-2018	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SDE/2019/142	03-Aug-2019	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SDE/2020/149	09-Sep-2020	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SDE/2021/156	07-Aug-2021	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SDE/2022/163	24-Aug-2022	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SDE/2023/170	16-Mar-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SDE/2024/177	16-Nov-2024	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SDE/2025/184	07-Jan-2025	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SDE/2026/191	22-Jun-2026	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres

Section 9.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD); Chapter on Marriage Leave (MGL); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 10 — Study Leave (STL)

Clause 10.1 — Overview and Objective. Study Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘STL’ in this Manual) is leave granted to pursue higher education, research, or professional qualification relevant to the employee's cadre. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Study Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to STL. The objective of STL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of study leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 10.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 10.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 10.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 16 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 10.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 10.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 10.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 5 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 10.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 10.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for STL up to a maximum of 16 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.33 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for STL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	19	11	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	9	16	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	6	22	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	20	7	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	5	21	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	19	6	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	16	23	3 working day(s)

Clause 10.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to STL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of STL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of STL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 10.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 10.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for STL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on STL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 10.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of STL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 10.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

10.5.1 STL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

10.5.2 STL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

10.5.3 An employee proceeding on STL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

10.5.4 STL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 10.6.

10.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for STL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

10.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned STL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

10.5.7 Requests for STL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

10.5.8 STL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 10.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

STL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 10.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine STL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 10.4. Combination of STL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of STL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 10.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q10.7.1. Can STL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 10.6, STL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q10.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing STL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 10.2 for each cadre.

Q10.7.3. What happens to unavailed STL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed STL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q10.7.4. Can STL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for STL.

Q10.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction STL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 10.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q10.7.6. Can STL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, STL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q10.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for STL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 10.2 of this Chapter.

Q10.7.8. Does STL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q10.7.9. Can an employee encash STL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily STL is not encashable in service.

Q10.7.10. What is the maximum STL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 10.2; balances of approximately 9 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q10.7.11. Can STL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of STL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q10.7.12. Is STL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to STL linked to the term of the contract.

Q10.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for STL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 10.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q10.7.14. Does STL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q10.7.15. Can STL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q10.7.16. What proof is required for emergency STL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 10.2.

Q10.7.17. Can STL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 10.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q10.7.18. Is STL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

STL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q10.7.19. Who maintains the official record of STL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 10.9 of this Chapter.

Q10.7.20. Can STL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 10.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q10.7.21. Does STL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q10.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for STL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 10.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q10.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for STL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q10.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of STL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of STL is not separately debited to the STL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q10.7.25. Can STL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction STL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q10.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of STL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 10.15.

Q10.7.27. Can STL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with STL for the same day.

Q10.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for STL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q10.7.29. Does STL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; STL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q10.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied STL?

No; as clarified in Clause 10.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer STL.

Q10.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for STL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 10.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q10.7.32. Can I be denied STL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 10.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of STL on this ground.

Q10.7.33. Will my STL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 10.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 10.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 10.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for STL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 10.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 10.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for STL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 10.4.

Case 10.8.3. An employee proceeding on STL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 10.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 10.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 10.3.

Case 10.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine STL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 10.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for STL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 10.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 10.8.7. An employee's STL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 10.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where STL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 10.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 10.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought STL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 10.11.7, that the debit to the STL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 10.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile STL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 10.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 10.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of STL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 10.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 10.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for STL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 10.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 10.5.

Case 10.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for STL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 10.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 10.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's STL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 10.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 10.8.15. An employee's STL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 10.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 10.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for STL under Clause 10.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 10.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 10.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 10.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 10.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 10.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 10.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 10.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 10.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 10.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 10.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 10.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to STL set out in Section 10.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 10.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of STL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 10.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to STL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for STL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 10.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 10.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of STL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for STL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 10.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

10.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for STL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

10.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to STL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's STL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

10.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of STL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to STL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

10.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of STL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 10.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

10.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for STL under Section 10.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

10.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue STL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for STL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

10.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of STL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

10.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for STL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while STL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 10.5.8 shall apply.

10.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued STL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

10.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for STL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

10.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of STL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of STL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

10.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for STL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

10.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for STL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of STL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent STL is encashable.

10.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of STL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

10.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 10.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction STL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

10.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing STL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

10.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of STL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

10.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned STL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

10.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of STL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

10.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned STL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

10.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any STL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

10.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for STL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

10.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for STL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

10.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue STL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

10.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to STL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

10.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of STL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing STL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

10.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for STL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

10.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of STL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

10.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of STL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

10.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise STL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the STL account.

10.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile STL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

10.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail STL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

10.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for STL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of STL exceeding five consecutive days.

10.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for STL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

10.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to STL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 10.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

10.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for STL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 10.2 having regard to the circumstances.

10.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with STL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and STL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

10.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue STL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

10.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of STL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 10.15.

10.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for STL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring STL.

10.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for STL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

10.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of STL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for STL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

10.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for STL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

10.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for STL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

10.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for STL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

10.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to STL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 10.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 10.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 10.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 10.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 10.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee A avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee B avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee C avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee D avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee E avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 2.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee F avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee G avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee H avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee I avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee J avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee K avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee L avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 3.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee M avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee N avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee O avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee P avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee Q avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee R avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee S avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 4.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee T avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee U avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee V avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee W avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee X avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 10.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 10.3, the pro-rata entitlement to STL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 10.3. Where Employee Y avails of STL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 10.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — STL

Ref: RSB/HRD/STL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Study Leave (STL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 10.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Study Leave for

[Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 10.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

10.15.1 Sanctioning of STL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

10.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for STL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

10.15.3 STL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 10.4.

10.15.4 Carry-forward of STL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 10.2 without a recorded justification.

10.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for STL.

10.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for STL.

10.15.7 STL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 10.6.

10.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's STL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

10.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where STL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

10.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for STL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

10.15.11 Sanction of STL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 10.12.

10.15.12 Physical-format applications for STL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 10.12.

10.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to STL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 10.11.

10.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of STL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 10.12.

10.15.15 Leave Account for STL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 10.12.

10.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of STL, contrary to Clause 10.12.

10.15.17 STL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 10.12.

10.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for STL, contrary to Clause 10.12.

10.15.19 Sanction order for STL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 10.12.

10.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 10.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 10.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to STL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to STL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to STL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to STL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 5-day annual entitlement to STL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to STL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for STL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 10.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the STL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 16-day annual entitlement to STL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 10.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 10.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for STL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 10.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 10.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 10.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for STL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 10.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my STL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 10.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 10.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 5 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of STL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 16 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 10.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 13 and 16 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 1 and 5 days against the prescribed entitlement of 5 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 12 and 16 days against the prescribed entitlement of 16 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for STL to which they are entitled under Section 10.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 10.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current STL balance?

Ticket HD-10101: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

My STL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-10102: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

I made an error in my STL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-10103: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Will my STL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-10104: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my STL application?

Ticket HD-10105: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Why was my STL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-10106: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-10107: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I apply for STL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-10108: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

My STL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-10109: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for STL?

Ticket HD-10110: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

STL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned STL after it has started?

Ticket HD-10111: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

How far in advance can I apply for STL?

Ticket HD-10112: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-10113: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I see my STL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-10114: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Who approves STL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-10115: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Does STL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-10116: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I split a single STL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-10117: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

What if my STL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-10118: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I apply for STL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-10119: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Is there a separate process for STL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-10120: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for STL?

Ticket HD-10121: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

How do I download a certificate of STL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-10122: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my STL application?

Ticket HD-10123: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I apply for STL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-10124: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my STL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-10125: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I apply for STL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-10126: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

What happens to my pending STL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-10127: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

STL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my STL application?

Ticket HD-10128: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Is there a helpline number for STL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-10129: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can my STL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-10130: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for STL?

Ticket HD-10131: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my STL application?

Ticket HD-10132: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Is STL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-10133: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Who do I contact if my STL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-10134: Please refer to Section 10.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 10.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code STL.

Section 10.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 10.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for STL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 10.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 10.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 10.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 10.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 10.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **STL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to STL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 10.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction STL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to STL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 10.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed STL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which STL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned STL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of STL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 10.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for STL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which STL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 10.12 in connection with sanction of STL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of STL, as described in Clause 10.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction STL under Section 10.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 10.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning STL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent STL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to STL, as illustrated in Section 10.20.

Section 10.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing STL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/STL/2013/100	24-Jan-2013	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2014/107	21-Sep-2014	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/STL/2015/114	02-Jun-2015	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/STL/2016/121	11-Nov-2016	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/STL/2017/128	04-Mar-2017	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2018/135	07-Aug-2018	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/STL/2019/142	05-Jun-2019	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/STL/2020/149	09-Jun-2020	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/STL/2021/156	28-Jan-2021	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/STL/2022/163	26-Nov-2022	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/STL/2023/170	18-Jan-2023	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2024/177	21-Aug-2024	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/STL/2025/184	01-Jan-2025	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2026/191	28-Mar-2026	Clarification on documentation requirements

Section 10.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Adoption Leave (AL); Chapter on Marriage Leave (MGL); Chapter on Quarantine Leave (QL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 11 — Sabbatical Leave (SBL)

Clause 11.1 — Overview and Objective. Sabbatical Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘SBL’ in this Manual) is extended leave granted to senior employees for approved academic, research, or public-interest engagements. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Sabbatical Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to SBL. The objective of SBL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of sabbatical leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 11.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 11.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 11.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 11.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 11.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 11.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 11.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 11.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for SBL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SBL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	19	6	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	13	11	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	18	8	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	15	22	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	9	7	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	14	21	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	8	18	3 working day(s)

Clause 11.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to SBL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of SBL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of SBL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 11.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 11.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for SBL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on SBL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 11.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of SBL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 11.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

11.5.1 SBL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

11.5.2 SBL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

11.5.3 An employee proceeding on SBL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

11.5.4 SBL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 11.6.

11.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for SBL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

11.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned SBL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

11.5.7 Requests for SBL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

11.5.8 SBL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 11.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

SBL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 11.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine SBL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 11.4. Combination of SBL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of SBL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 11.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q11.7.1. Can SBL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 11.6, SBL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q11.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing SBL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 11.2 for each cadre.

Q11.7.3. What happens to unavailed SBL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed SBL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q11.7.4. Can SBL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for SBL.

Q11.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction SBL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 11.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q11.7.6. Can SBL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, SBL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q11.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for SBL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 11.2 of this Chapter.

Q11.7.8. Does SBL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q11.7.9. Can an employee encash SBL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily SBL is not encashable in service.

Q11.7.10. What is the maximum SBL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 11.2; balances of approximately 13 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q11.7.11. Can SBL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of SBL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q11.7.12. Is SBL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to SBL linked to the term of the contract.

Q11.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for SBL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 11.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q11.7.14. Does SBL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q11.7.15. Can SBL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q11.7.16. What proof is required for emergency SBL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 11.2.

Q11.7.17. Can SBL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 11.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q11.7.18. Is SBL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

SBL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q11.7.19. Who maintains the official record of SBL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 11.9 of this Chapter.

Q11.7.20. Can SBL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 11.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q11.7.21. Does SBL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q11.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for SBL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 11.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q11.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for SBL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q11.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SBL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SBL is not separately debited to the SBL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q11.7.25. Can SBL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction SBL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q11.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of SBL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 11.15.

Q11.7.27. Can SBL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with SBL for the same day.

Q11.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for SBL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q11.7.29. Does SBL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; SBL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q11.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied SBL?

No; as clarified in Clause 11.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer SBL.

Q11.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for SBL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 11.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q11.7.32. Can I be denied SBL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 11.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of SBL on this ground.

Q11.7.33. Will my SBL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 11.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 11.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 11.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for SBL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 11.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 11.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for SBL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 11.4.

Case 11.8.3. An employee proceeding on SBL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 11.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 11.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 11.3.

Case 11.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine SBL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 11.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for SBL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 11.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 11.8.7. An employee's SBL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 11.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where SBL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 11.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 11.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought SBL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 11.11.7, that the debit to the SBL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 11.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile SBL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 11.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 11.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of SBL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 11.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 11.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for SBL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 11.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 11.5.

Case 11.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for SBL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 11.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 11.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's SBL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 11.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 11.8.15. An employee's SBL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 11.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 11.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for SBL under Clause 11.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 11.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 11.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 11.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 11.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 11.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 11.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 11.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 11.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 11.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 11.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 11.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to SBL set out in Section 11.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 11.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of SBL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 11.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SBL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for SBL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 11.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 11.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SBL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SBL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 11.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

11.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for SBL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

11.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to SBL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's SBL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

11.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of SBL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to SBL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

11.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of SBL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 11.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

11.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for SBL under Section 11.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

11.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue SBL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for SBL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

11.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of SBL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

11.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for SBL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while SBL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 11.5.8 shall apply.

11.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued SBL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

11.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for SBL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

11.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of SBL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of SBL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

11.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for SBL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

11.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for SBL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of SBL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent SBL is encashable.

11.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of SBL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

11.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 11.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction SBL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

11.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing SBL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

11.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of SBL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

11.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned SBL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

11.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of SBL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

11.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned SBL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

11.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any SBL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

11.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for SBL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

11.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for SBL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

11.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue SBL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

11.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to SBL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

11.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of SBL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing SBL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

11.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for SBL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

11.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of SBL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

11.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of SBL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

11.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise SBL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the SBL account.

11.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile SBL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

11.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail SBL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

11.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for SBL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of SBL exceeding five consecutive days.

11.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for SBL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

11.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to SBL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 11.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

11.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for SBL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 11.2 having regard to the circumstances.

11.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with SBL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and SBL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

11.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue SBL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

11.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of SBL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 11.15.

11.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for SBL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring SBL.

11.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for SBL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

11.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of SBL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for SBL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

11.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for SBL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

11.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for SBL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

11.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for SBL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

11.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to SBL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 11.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 11.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 11.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 11.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 11.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee A avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee B avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee C avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee D avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee E avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee F avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee G avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee H avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee I avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee J avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee K avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee L avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee M avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee N avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee O avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee P avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee Q avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee R avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee S avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee T avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee U avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee V avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee W avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee X avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 11.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 11.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SBL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 11.3. Where Employee Y avails of SBL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 11.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — SBL

Ref: RSB/HRD/SBL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Sabbatical Leave (SBL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 11.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Sabbatical Leave for

[Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 11.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

11.15.1 Sanctioning of SBL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

11.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for SBL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

11.15.3 SBL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 11.4.

11.15.4 Carry-forward of SBL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 11.2 without a recorded justification.

11.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for SBL.

11.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for SBL.

11.15.7 SBL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 11.6.

11.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's SBL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

11.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where SBL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

11.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for SBL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

11.15.11 Sanction of SBL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 11.12.

11.15.12 Physical-format applications for SBL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 11.12.

11.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to SBL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 11.11.

11.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of SBL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 11.12.

11.15.15 Leave Account for SBL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 11.12.

11.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of SBL, contrary to Clause 11.12.

11.15.17 SBL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 11.12.

11.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for SBL, contrary to Clause 11.12.

11.15.19 Sanction order for SBL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 11.12.

11.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 11.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 11.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for SBL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 11.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SBL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to SBL that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 11.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 11.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for SBL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 11.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 11.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 11.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for SBL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 11.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my SBL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 11.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 11.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SBL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 11.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SBL to which they are entitled under Section 11.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 11.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current SBL balance?

Ticket HD-11101: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

My SBL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-11102: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

I made an error in my SBL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-11103: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Will my SBL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-11104: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my SBL application?

Ticket HD-11105: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Why was my SBL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-11106: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-11107: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I apply for SBL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-11108: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

My SBL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-11109: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for SBL?

Ticket HD-11110: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SBL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned SBL after it has started?

Ticket HD-11111: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

How far in advance can I apply for SBL?

Ticket HD-11112: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-11113: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I see my SBL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-11114: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Who approves SBL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-11115: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Does SBL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-11116: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I split a single SBL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-11117: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

What if my SBL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-11118: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I apply for SBL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-11119: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Is there a separate process for SBL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-11120: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for SBL?

Ticket HD-11121: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

How do I download a certificate of SBL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-11122: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my SBL application?

Ticket HD-11123: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I apply for SBL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-11124: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my SBL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-11125: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I apply for SBL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-11126: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

What happens to my pending SBL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-11127: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SBL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my SBL application?

Ticket HD-11128: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Is there a helpline number for SBL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-11129: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can my SBL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-11130: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for SBL?

Ticket HD-11131: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my SBL application?

Ticket HD-11132: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Is SBL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-11133: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Who do I contact if my SBL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-11134: Please refer to Section 11.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 11.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SBL.

Section 11.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 11.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for SBL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 11.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 11.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 11.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 11.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 11.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **SBL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to SBL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 11.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction SBL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to SBL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 11.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed SBL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which SBL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned SBL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of SBL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 11.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for SBL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which SBL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 11.12 in connection with sanction of SBL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of SBL, as described in Clause 11.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction SBL under Section 11.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 11.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning SBL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent SBL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to SBL, as illustrated in Section 11.20.

Section 11.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing SBL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SBL/2013/100	07-Nov-2013	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2014/107	02-Mar-2014	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2015/114	01-Jun-2015	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2016/121	26-Nov-2016	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SBL/2017/128	10-Jun-2017	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2018/135	24-Nov-2018	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SBL/2019/142	22-Sep-2019	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SBL/2020/149	05-Mar-2020	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2021/156	07-Jan-2021	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SBL/2022/163	24-Aug-2022	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SBL/2023/170	24-Apr-2023	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SBL/2024/177	02-Aug-2024	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SBL/2025/184	17-Nov-2025	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2026/191	06-Jan-2026	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction

Section 11.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (NCL); Chapter on Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (EL/PL); Chapter on Adoption Leave (AL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 12 — Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL)

Clause 12.1 — Overview and Objective. Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘LWP/EOL’ in this Manual) is leave granted without any salary or allowance, sanctioned only when all other leave balances stand exhausted. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to LWP/EOL. The objective of LWP/EOL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of leave without pay / extraordinary leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 12.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 12.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 12.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 12.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An

application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 12.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 13 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 12.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 23 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 12.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 12.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for LWP/EOL up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LWP/EOL by an employee in this cadre shall

ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	13	17	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	22	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	24	8	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	13	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	23	22	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	8	12	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	14	9	3 working day(s)

Clause 12.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to LWP/EOL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of LWP/EOL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of LWP/EOL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 12.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 12.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for LWP/EOL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on LWP/EOL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 12.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of LWP/EOL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 12.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

12.5.1 LWP/EOL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

12.5.2 LWP/EOL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

12.5.3 An employee proceeding on LWP/EOL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

12.5.4 LWP/EOL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 12.6.

12.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for LWP/EOL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

12.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned LWP/EOL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

12.5.7 Requests for LWP/EOL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

12.5.8 LWP/EOL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 12.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

LWP/EOL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 12.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine LWP/EOL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 12.4. Combination of LWP/EOL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of LWP/EOL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 12.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q12.7.1. Can LWP/EOL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 12.6, LWP/EOL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q12.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing LWP/EOL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 12.2 for each cadre.

Q12.7.3. What happens to unavailed LWP/EOL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed LWP/EOL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q12.7.4. Can LWP/EOL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for LWP/EOL.

Q12.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction LWP/EOL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 12.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q12.7.6. Can LWP/EOL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, LWP/EOL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q12.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for LWP/EOL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 12.2 of this Chapter.

Q12.7.8. Does LWP/EOL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q12.7.9. Can an employee encash LWP/EOL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily LWP/EOL is not encashable in service.

Q12.7.10. What is the maximum LWP/EOL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 12.2; balances of approximately 7 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q12.7.11. Can LWP/EOL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of LWP/EOL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q12.7.12. Is LWP/EOL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL linked to the term of the contract.

Q12.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for LWP/EOL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 12.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q12.7.14. Does LWP/EOL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q12.7.15. Can LWP/EOL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q12.7.16. What proof is required for emergency LWP/EOL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 12.2.

Q12.7.17. Can LWP/EOL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 12.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q12.7.18. Is LWP/EOL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

LWP/EOL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q12.7.19. Who maintains the official record of LWP/EOL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 12.9 of this Chapter.

Q12.7.20. Can LWP/EOL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 12.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q12.7.21. Does LWP/EOL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q12.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for LWP/EOL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 12.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q12.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for LWP/EOL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q12.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of LWP/EOL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of LWP/EOL is not separately debited to the LWP/EOL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q12.7.25. Can LWP/EOL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction LWP/EOL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q12.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of LWP/EOL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 12.15.

Q12.7.27. Can LWP/EOL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with LWP/EOL for the same day.

Q12.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for LWP/EOL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q12.7.29. Does LWP/EOL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; LWP/EOL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q12.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied LWP/EOL?

No; as clarified in Clause 12.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer LWP/EOL.

Q12.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for LWP/EOL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 12.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q12.7.32. Can I be denied LWP/EOL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 12.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of LWP/EOL on this ground.

Q12.7.33. Will my LWP/EOL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 12.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 12.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 12.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for LWP/EOL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 12.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 12.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for LWP/EOL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 12.4.

Case 12.8.3. An employee proceeding on LWP/EOL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 12.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 12.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 12.3.

Case 12.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine LWP/EOL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 12.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for LWP/EOL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 12.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 12.8.7. An employee's LWP/EOL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 12.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where LWP/EOL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 12.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 12.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought LWP/EOL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 12.11.7, that the debit to the LWP/EOL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 12.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile LWP/EOL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 12.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 12.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of LWP/EOL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 12.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 12.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for LWP/EOL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 12.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 12.5.

Case 12.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for LWP/EOL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 12.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 12.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's LWP/EOL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 12.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 12.8.15. An employee's LWP/EOL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 12.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 12.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for LWP/EOL under Clause 12.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 12.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 12.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 12.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 12.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 12.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 12.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 12.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning

timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 12.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at

least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 12.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 12.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 12.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to LWP/EOL set out in Section 12.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 12.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of LWP/EOL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 12.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LWP/EOL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for LWP/EOL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 12.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 12.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LWP/EOL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LWP/EOL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 12.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

12.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for LWP/EOL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

12.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to LWP/EOL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's LWP/EOL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

12.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of LWP/EOL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to LWP/EOL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

12.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of LWP/EOL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 12.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

12.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for LWP/EOL under Section 12.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

12.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue LWP/EOL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for LWP/EOL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

12.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of LWP/EOL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

12.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for LWP/EOL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while LWP/EOL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 12.5.8 shall apply.

12.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued LWP/EOL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

12.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for LWP/EOL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

12.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of LWP/EOL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of LWP/EOL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

12.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for LWP/EOL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

12.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for LWP/EOL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of LWP/EOL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent LWP/EOL is encashable.

12.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of LWP/EOL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

12.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 12.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction LWP/EOL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

12.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing LWP/EOL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

12.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of LWP/EOL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

12.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned LWP/EOL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

12.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of LWP/EOL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

12.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned LWP/EOL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

12.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any LWP/EOL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

12.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for LWP/EOL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

12.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for LWP/EOL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

12.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue LWP/EOL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

12.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to LWP/EOL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

12.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of LWP/EOL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing LWP/EOL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

12.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for LWP/EOL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

12.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of LWP/EOL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

12.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of LWP/EOL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

12.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise LWP/EOL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the LWP/EOL account.

12.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile LWP/EOL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

12.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail LWP/EOL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

12.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for LWP/EOL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of LWP/EOL exceeding five consecutive days.

12.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for LWP/EOL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated

absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

12.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to LWP/EOL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 12.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

12.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for LWP/EOL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 12.2 having regard to the circumstances.

12.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with LWP/EOL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and LWP/EOL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

12.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue LWP/EOL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

12.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of LWP/EOL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 12.15.

12.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for LWP/EOL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring LWP/EOL.

12.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for LWP/EOL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

12.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of LWP/EOL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for LWP/EOL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

12.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for LWP/EOL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

12.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for LWP/EOL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

12.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for LWP/EOL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

12.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to LWP/EOL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 12.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 12.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 12.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 12.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 12.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee A avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee B avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee C avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee D avails of

LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee E avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee F avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee G avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee H avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee I avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee J avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in

that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee K avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee L avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee M avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee N avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee O avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee P avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee Q avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee R avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee S avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 19.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee T avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee U avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee V avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee W avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee X avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently

regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 12.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 12.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LWP/EOL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 12.3. Where Employee Y avails of LWP/EOL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 12.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — LWP/EOL

Ref: RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 12.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 12.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

12.15.1 Sanctioning of LWP/EOL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

12.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for LWP/EOL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

12.15.3 LWP/EOL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 12.4.

12.15.4 Carry-forward of LWP/EOL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 12.2 without a recorded justification.

12.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for LWP/EOL.

12.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for LWP/EOL.

12.15.7 LWP/EOL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 12.6.

12.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's LWP/EOL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

12.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where LWP/EOL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

12.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for LWP/EOL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

12.15.11 Sanction of LWP/EOL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 12.12.

12.15.12 Physical-format applications for LWP/EOL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 12.12.

12.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to LWP/EOL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 12.11.

12.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of LWP/EOL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 12.12.

12.15.15 Leave Account for LWP/EOL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 12.12.

12.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of LWP/EOL, contrary to Clause 12.12.

12.15.17 LWP/EOL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 12.12.

12.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for LWP/EOL, contrary to Clause 12.12.

12.15.19 Sanction order for LWP/EOL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 12.12.

12.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 12.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 12.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to

routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 23-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for LWP/EOL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 12.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LWP/EOL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to LWP/EOL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 12.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 12.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for LWP/EOL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 12.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 12.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 12.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for LWP/EOL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 12.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my LWP/EOL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 12.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 12.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of

the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 23 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LWP/EOL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 12.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's stated

policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 10 and 13 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 19 and 23 days against the prescribed entitlement of 23 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's

stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LWP/EOL to which they are entitled under Section 12.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 12.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current LWP/EOL balance?

Ticket HD-12101: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

My LWP/EOL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-12102: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

I made an error in my LWP/EOL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-12103: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Will my LWP/EOL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-12104: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my LWP/EOL application?

Ticket HD-12105: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Why was my LWP/EOL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-12106: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-12107: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I apply for LWP/EOL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-12108: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

My LWP/EOL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-12109: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for LWP/EOL?

Ticket HD-12110: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned LWP/EOL after it has started?

Ticket HD-12111: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

How far in advance can I apply for LWP/EOL?

Ticket HD-12112: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-12113: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I see my LWP/EOL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-12114: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Who approves LWP/EOL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-12115: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the

Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Does LWP/EOL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-12116: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I split a single LWP/EOL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-12117: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

What if my LWP/EOL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-12118: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I apply for LWP/EOL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-12119: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Is there a separate process for LWP/EOL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-12120: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for LWP/EOL?

Ticket HD-12121: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

How do I download a certificate of LWP/EOL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-12122: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my LWP/EOL application?

Ticket HD-12123: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I apply for LWP/EOL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-12124: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my LWP/EOL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-12125: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I apply for LWP/EOL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-12126: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

What happens to my pending LWP/EOL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-12127: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my LWP/EOL application?

Ticket HD-12128: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Is there a helpline number for LWP/EOL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-12129: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can my LWP/EOL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-12130: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for LWP/EOL?

Ticket HD-12131: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my LWP/EOL application?

Ticket HD-12132: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

LWP/EOL.

Is LWP/EOL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-12133: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Who do I contact if my LWP/EOL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-12134: Please refer to Section 12.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 12.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LWP/EOL.

Section 12.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 12.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for LWP/EOL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 12.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 12.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 12.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 12.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 12.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **LWP/EOL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to LWP/EOL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 12.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction LWP/EOL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to LWP/EOL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 12.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed LWP/EOL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which LWP/EOL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned LWP/EOL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.

- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of LWP/EOL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 12.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for LWP/EOL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which LWP/EOL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 12.12 in connection with sanction of LWP/EOL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of LWP/EOL, as described in Clause 12.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction LWP/EOL under Section 12.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 12.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning LWP/EOL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent LWP/EOL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to LWP/EOL, as illustrated in Section 12.20.

Section 12.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing LWP/EOL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2013/100	20-Jan-2013	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2014/107	28-Mar-2014	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2015/114	04-Aug-2015	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2016/121	19-Aug-2016	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2017/128	20-Jan-2017	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2018/135	22-Aug-2018	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2019/142	17-Apr-2019	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2020/149	07-Sep-2020	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2021/156	11-Mar-2021	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2022/163	13-Mar-2022	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2023/170	21-Apr-2023	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2024/177	11-Nov-2024	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2025/184	01-Jun-2025	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2026/191	19-Jan-2026	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction

Section 12.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (EL/PL); Chapter on Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA); Chapter on Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (SDE); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 13 — Compensatory Off (CO)

Clause 13.1 — Overview and Objective. Compensatory Off (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘CO’ in this Manual) is leave granted in lieu of duty performed on a weekly-off, holiday, or beyond prescribed working hours. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Compensatory Off across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to CO. The objective of CO is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of compensatory off without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 13.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 13.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 5 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 13.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 13.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 24 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 13.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 13.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 15 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 13.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 20 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 13.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for CO up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 14 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CO by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	21	5	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	18	10	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	7	24	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	21	21	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	6	15	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	8	20	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	17	14	3 working day(s)

Clause 13.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to CO for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of CO for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of CO of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 13.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 13.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for CO shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on CO without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 13.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of CO, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 13.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

13.5.1 CO shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

13.5.2 CO availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

13.5.3 An employee proceeding on CO while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

13.5.4 CO may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 13.6.

13.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for CO, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

13.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned CO, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

13.5.7 Requests for CO during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

13.5.8 CO sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 13.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

CO may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 13.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine CO with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 13.4. Combination of CO with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of CO, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 13.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q13.7.1. Can CO be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 13.6, CO may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q13.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing CO?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 13.2 for each cadre.

Q13.7.3. What happens to unavailed CO at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed CO balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q13.7.4. Can CO be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for CO.

Q13.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction CO for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 13.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q13.7.6. Can CO be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, CO may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q13.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for CO?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 13.2 of this Chapter.

Q13.7.8. Does CO accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q13.7.9. Can an employee encash CO while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily CO is not encashable in service.

Q13.7.10. What is the maximum CO balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 13.2; balances of approximately 18 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q13.7.11. Can CO be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of CO is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q13.7.12. Is CO available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to CO linked to the term of the contract.

Q13.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for CO?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 13.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q13.7.14. Does CO lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q13.7.15. Can CO be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q13.7.16. What proof is required for emergency CO availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 13.2.

Q13.7.17. Can CO entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 13.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q13.7.18. Is CO counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

CO availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q13.7.19. Who maintains the official record of CO for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 13.9 of this Chapter.

Q13.7.20. Can CO be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 13.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q13.7.21. Does CO entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q13.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for CO exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 13.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q13.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for CO after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q13.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of CO?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of CO is not separately debited to the CO account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q13.7.25. Can CO be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction CO to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q13.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of CO?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 13.15.

Q13.7.27. Can CO be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with CO for the same day.

Q13.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for CO within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q13.7.29. Does CO availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; CO availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q13.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied CO?

No; as clarified in Clause 13.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer CO.

Q13.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for CO if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 13.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q13.7.32. Can I be denied CO because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 13.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of CO on this ground.

Q13.7.33. Will my CO application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 13.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 13.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 13.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for CO for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 13.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 13.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for CO was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 13.4.

Case 13.8.3. An employee proceeding on CO was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 13.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 13.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 13.3.

Case 13.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine CO with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 13.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for CO was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 13.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 13.8.7. An employee's CO was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 13.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where CO had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 13.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 13.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought CO spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 13.11.7, that the debit to the CO account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 13.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile CO balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 13.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 13.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of CO was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 13.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 13.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for CO coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 13.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 13.5.

Case 13.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for CO through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 13.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 13.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's CO application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 13.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 13.8.15. An employee's CO entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 13.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 13.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for CO under Clause 13.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 13.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 13.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 13.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 13.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 13.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 13.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 13.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 13.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 13.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 13.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 13.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to CO set out in Section 13.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 13.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of CO sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 13.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CO arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for CO utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 13.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 13.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CO to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CO from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 13.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

13.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for CO exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

13.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to CO under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's CO account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

13.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of CO sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to CO for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

13.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of CO may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 13.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

13.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for CO under Section 13.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

13.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue CO against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for CO during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

13.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of CO within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

13.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for CO shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while CO stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 13.5.8 shall apply.

13.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued CO balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

13.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for CO, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

13.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of CO availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of CO

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

13.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for CO, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

13.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for CO on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of CO remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent CO is encashable.

13.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of CO shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

13.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 13.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction CO to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

13.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing CO shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

13.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of CO shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

13.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned CO, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

13.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of CO, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

13.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned CO spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

13.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any CO balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

13.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for CO may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

13.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for CO on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

13.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue CO in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

13.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to CO, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

13.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of CO shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing CO that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

13.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for CO shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

13.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of CO shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

13.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of CO, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

13.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise CO for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the CO account.

13.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile CO availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

13.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail CO in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

13.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for CO that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of CO exceeding five consecutive days.

13.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for CO, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

13.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to CO recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 13.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

13.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for CO to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 13.2 having regard to the circumstances.

13.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with CO coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and CO under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

13.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue CO under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

13.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of CO shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 13.15.

13.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for CO on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring CO.

13.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for CO spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

13.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of CO or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for CO shall be liable to action under that Policy.

13.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for CO during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

13.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for CO on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

13.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for CO, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

13.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to CO not resolved through the FAQ in Section 13.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 13.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 13.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 13.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 13.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee A avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee B avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee C avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee D avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee E avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee F avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee G avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee H avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee I avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee J avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee K avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee L avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee M avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee N avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee O avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee P avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee Q avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee R avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee S avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee T avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee U avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee V avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee W avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee X avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 13.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 13.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CO for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 13.3. Where Employee Y avails of CO in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 13.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — CO

Ref: RSB/HRD/CO/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Compensatory Off (CO) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 13.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Compensatory Off for

[Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 13.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

13.15.1 Sanctioning of CO recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

13.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for CO exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

13.15.3 CO sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 13.4.

13.15.4 Carry-forward of CO balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 13.2 without a recorded justification.

13.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for CO.

13.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for CO.

13.15.7 CO combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 13.6.

13.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's CO account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

13.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where CO was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

13.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for CO beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

13.15.11 Sanction of CO recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 13.12.

13.15.12 Physical-format applications for CO, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 13.12.

13.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to CO inconsistent with the provisions of Section 13.11.

13.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of CO within entitlement, contrary to Clause 13.12.

13.15.15 Leave Account for CO not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 13.12.

13.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of CO, contrary to Clause 13.12.

13.15.17 CO entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 13.12.

13.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for CO, contrary to Clause 13.12.

13.15.19 Sanction order for CO issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 13.12.

13.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 13.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 13.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to CO that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to CO that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to CO that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to CO that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to CO that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to CO that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for CO are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 13.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CO is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to CO that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 13.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 13.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for CO dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 13.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 13.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 13.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for CO is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 13.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my CO balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 13.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 13.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CO utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 13.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 2 and 5 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 21 and 24 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 12 and 15 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 17 and 20 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 11 and 14 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CO to which they are entitled under Section 13.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 13.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current CO balance?

Ticket HD-13101: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

My CO application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-13102: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

I made an error in my CO application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-13103: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Will my CO be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-13104: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I attach a document after submitting my CO application?

Ticket HD-13105: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Why was my CO auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-13106: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-13107: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I apply for CO on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-13108: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

My CO balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-13109: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Is there a mobile app to apply for CO?

Ticket HD-13110: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

CO.

Can I cancel a sanctioned CO after it has started?

Ticket HD-13111: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

How far in advance can I apply for CO?

Ticket HD-13112: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-13113: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I see my CO history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-13114: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Who approves CO if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-13115: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Does CO availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-13116: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I split a single CO application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-13117: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

What if my CO balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-13118: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I apply for CO for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-13119: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Is there a separate process for CO during my notice period?

Ticket HD-13120: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for CO?

Ticket HD-13121: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

How do I download a certificate of CO availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-13122: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my CO application?

Ticket HD-13123: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I apply for CO if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-13124: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my CO balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-13125: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I apply for CO using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-13126: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

What happens to my pending CO application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-13127: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

CO.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my CO application?

Ticket HD-13128: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Is there a helpline number for CO queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-13129: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can my CO application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-13130: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for CO?

Ticket HD-13131: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my CO application?

Ticket HD-13132: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Is CO entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-13133: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Who do I contact if my CO application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-13134: Please refer to Section 13.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 13.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CO.

Section 13.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 13.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for CO from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 13.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 13.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 13.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 13.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 13.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **CO Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to CO accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 13.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction CO for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to CO computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 13.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed CO balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which CO availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned CO is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of CO records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 13.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for CO to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which CO entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 13.12 in connection with sanction of CO.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of CO, as described in Clause 13.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction CO under Section 13.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 13.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning CO.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent CO balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to CO, as illustrated in Section 13.20.

Section 13.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing CO since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/CO/2013/100	09-Mar-2013	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CO/2014/107	03-Mar-2014	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2015/114	10-Mar-2015	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2016/121	27-Aug-2016	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CO/2017/128	10-Aug-2017	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CO/2018/135	21-Aug-2018	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CO/2019/142	22-Nov-2019	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CO/2020/149	10-Sep-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CO/2021/156	05-Apr-2021	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CO/2022/163	04-Sep-2022	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CO/2023/170	05-Apr-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CO/2024/177	20-Mar-2024	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2025/184	11-Mar-2025	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CO/2026/191	21-Nov-2026	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Section 13.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Sabbatical Leave (SBL); Chapter on National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (NCL); Chapter on Quarantine Leave (QL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 14 — Special Casual Leave (SCL)

Clause 14.1 — Overview and Objective. Special Casual Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘SCL’ in this Manual) is leave granted for specified categories of public duty, sporting, or institutional engagements, not debited to the regular casual leave account. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Special Casual Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to SCL. The objective of SCL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of special casual leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 14.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 14.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 14.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 14.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 14.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 14.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 14.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 16 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.33 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 14.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for SCL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	21	8	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	6	18	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	20	19	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	17	9	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	7	18	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	16	23	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	17	3 working day(s)

Clause 14.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to SCL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of SCL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of SCL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 14.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 14.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for SCL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on SCL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 14.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of SCL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 14.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

14.5.1 SCL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

14.5.2 SCL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

14.5.3 An employee proceeding on SCL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

14.5.4 SCL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 14.6.

14.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for SCL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

14.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned SCL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

14.5.7 Requests for SCL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

14.5.8 SCL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 14.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

SCL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 14.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine SCL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 14.4. Combination of SCL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of SCL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 14.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q14.7.1. Can SCL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 14.6, SCL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q14.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing SCL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 14.2 for each cadre.

Q14.7.3. What happens to unavailed SCL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed SCL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q14.7.4. Can SCL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for SCL.

Q14.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction SCL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 14.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q14.7.6. Can SCL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, SCL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q14.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for SCL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 14.2 of this Chapter.

Q14.7.8. Does SCL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q14.7.9. Can an employee encash SCL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily SCL is not encashable in service.

Q14.7.10. What is the maximum SCL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 14.2; balances of approximately 6 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q14.7.11. Can SCL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of SCL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q14.7.12. Is SCL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to SCL linked to the term of the contract.

Q14.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for SCL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 14.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q14.7.14. Does SCL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q14.7.15. Can SCL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q14.7.16. What proof is required for emergency SCL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 14.2.

Q14.7.17. Can SCL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 14.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q14.7.18. Is SCL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

SCL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q14.7.19. Who maintains the official record of SCL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 14.9 of this Chapter.

Q14.7.20. Can SCL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 14.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q14.7.21. Does SCL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q14.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for SCL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 14.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q14.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for SCL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q14.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SCL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SCL is not separately debited to the SCL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q14.7.25. Can SCL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction SCL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q14.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of SCL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 14.15.

Q14.7.27. Can SCL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with SCL for the same day.

Q14.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for SCL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q14.7.29. Does SCL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; SCL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q14.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied SCL?

No; as clarified in Clause 14.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer SCL.

Q14.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for SCL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 14.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q14.7.32. Can I be denied SCL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 14.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of SCL on this ground.

Q14.7.33. Will my SCL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 14.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 14.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 14.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for SCL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 14.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 14.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for SCL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 14.4.

Case 14.8.3. An employee proceeding on SCL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 14.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 14.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 14.3.

Case 14.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine SCL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 14.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for SCL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 14.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 14.8.7. An employee's SCL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 14.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where SCL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 14.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 14.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought SCL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 14.11.7, that the debit to the SCL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 14.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile SCL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 14.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 14.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of SCL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 14.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 14.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for SCL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 14.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 14.5.

Case 14.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for SCL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 14.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 14.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's SCL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 14.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 14.8.15. An employee's SCL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 14.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 14.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for SCL under Clause 14.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 14.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 14.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 14.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 14.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 14.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 14.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 14.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 14.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 14.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 14.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 14.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to SCL set out in Section 14.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 14.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of SCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 14.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for SCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 14.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 14.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 14.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

14.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for SCL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

14.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to SCL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's SCL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

14.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of SCL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to SCL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

14.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of SCL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 14.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

14.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for SCL under Section 14.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

14.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue SCL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for SCL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

14.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of SCL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

14.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for SCL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while SCL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 14.5.8 shall apply.

14.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued SCL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

14.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for SCL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

14.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of SCL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of SCL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

14.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for SCL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

14.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for SCL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of SCL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent SCL is encashable.

14.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of SCL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

14.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 14.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction SCL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

14.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing SCL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

14.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of SCL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

14.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned SCL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

14.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of SCL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

14.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned SCL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

14.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any SCL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

14.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for SCL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

14.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for SCL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

14.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue SCL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

14.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to SCL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

14.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of SCL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing SCL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

14.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for SCL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

14.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of SCL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

14.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of SCL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

14.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise SCL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the SCL account.

14.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile SCL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

14.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail SCL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

14.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for SCL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of SCL exceeding five consecutive days.

14.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for SCL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

14.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to SCL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 14.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

14.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for SCL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 14.2 having regard to the circumstances.

14.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with SCL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and SCL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

14.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue SCL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

14.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of SCL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 14.15.

14.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for SCL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring SCL.

14.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for SCL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

14.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of SCL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for SCL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

14.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for SCL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

14.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for SCL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

14.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for SCL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

14.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to SCL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 14.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 14.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 14.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 14.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 14.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee A avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee B avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee C avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee D avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee E avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee F avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee G avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee H avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee I avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee J avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee K avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee L avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee M avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee N avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee O avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee P avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee Q avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee R avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee S avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee T avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee U avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee V avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee W avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee X avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 14.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 14.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 14.3. Where Employee Y avails of SCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 14.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — SCL

Ref: RSB/HRD/SCL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Special Casual Leave (SCL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 14.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Special Casual Leave

for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 14.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

14.15.1 Sanctioning of SCL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

14.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for SCL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

14.15.3 SCL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 14.4.

14.15.4 Carry-forward of SCL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 14.2 without a recorded justification.

14.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for SCL.

14.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for SCL.

14.15.7 SCL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 14.6.

14.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's SCL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

14.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where SCL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

14.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for SCL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

14.15.11 Sanction of SCL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 14.12.

14.15.12 Physical-format applications for SCL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 14.12.

14.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to SCL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 14.11.

14.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of SCL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 14.12.

14.15.15 Leave Account for SCL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 14.12.

14.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of SCL, contrary to Clause 14.12.

14.15.17 SCL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 14.12.

14.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for SCL, contrary to Clause 14.12.

14.15.19 Sanction order for SCL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 14.12.

14.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 14.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 14.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to SCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to SCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to SCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to SCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to SCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 16-day annual entitlement to SCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for SCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 14.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to SCL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 14.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 14.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for SCL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 14.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 14.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 14.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for SCL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 14.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my SCL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 14.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 14.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 16 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 14.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 12 and 16 days against the prescribed entitlement of 16 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCL to which they are entitled under Section 14.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 14.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current SCL balance?

Ticket HD-14101: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

My SCL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-14102: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

I made an error in my SCL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-14103: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Will my SCL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-14104: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my SCL application?

Ticket HD-14105: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Why was my SCL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-14106: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-14107: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I apply for SCL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-14108: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

My SCL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-14109: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for SCL?

Ticket HD-14110: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SCL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned SCL after it has started?

Ticket HD-14111: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

How far in advance can I apply for SCL?

Ticket HD-14112: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-14113: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I see my SCL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-14114: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Who approves SCL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-14115: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Does SCL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-14116: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I split a single SCL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-14117: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

What if my SCL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-14118: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I apply for SCL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-14119: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Is there a separate process for SCL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-14120: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for SCL?

Ticket HD-14121: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

How do I download a certificate of SCL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-14122: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my SCL application?

Ticket HD-14123: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I apply for SCL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-14124: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my SCL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-14125: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I apply for SCL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-14126: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

What happens to my pending SCL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-14127: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SCL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my SCL application?

Ticket HD-14128: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Is there a helpline number for SCL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-14129: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can my SCL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-14130: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for SCL?

Ticket HD-14131: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my SCL application?

Ticket HD-14132: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Is SCL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-14133: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Who do I contact if my SCL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-14134: Please refer to Section 14.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 14.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCL.

Section 14.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 14.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for SCL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 14.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 14.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 14.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 14.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 14.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **SCL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to SCL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 14.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction SCL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to SCL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 14.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed SCL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which SCL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned SCL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of SCL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 14.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for SCL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which SCL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 14.12 in connection with sanction of SCL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of SCL, as described in Clause 14.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction SCL under Section 14.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 14.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning SCL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent SCL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to SCL, as illustrated in Section 14.20.

Section 14.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing SCL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SCL/2013/100	28-Jan-2013	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCL/2014/107	21-Jun-2014	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCL/2015/114	09-Jan-2015	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SCL/2016/121	11-Nov-2016	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCL/2017/128	21-Apr-2017	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SCL/2018/135	24-Jun-2018	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SCL/2019/142	23-Jun-2019	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SCL/2020/149	01-Jan-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SCL/2021/156	23-Mar-2021	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCL/2022/163	02-Nov-2022	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SCL/2023/170	19-Aug-2023	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCL/2024/177	14-Mar-2024	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SCL/2025/184	10-Apr-2025	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCL/2026/191	28-Jan-2026	Clarification on documentation requirements

Section 14.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD); Chapter on Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (SDE); Chapter on Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave (HPL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 15 — Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD)

Clause 15.1 — Overview and Objective. Leave for Court / Jury Duty (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘CJD’ in this Manual) is leave granted to attend court proceedings as a witness, juror, or party to litigation arising from official duty. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Leave for Court / Jury Duty across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to CJD. The objective of CJD is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of leave for court / jury duty without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 15.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 15.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 15.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 5 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 15.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 15.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 15.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 15.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 16 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 15.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for CJD up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for CJD by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	20	17	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	5	6	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	19	8	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	24	17	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	6	7	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	15	16	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	20	21	3 working day(s)

Clause 15.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to CJD for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of CJD for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of CJD of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 15.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 15.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for CJD shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on CJD without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 15.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of CJD, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 15.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

15.5.1 CJD shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

15.5.2 CJD availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

15.5.3 An employee proceeding on CJD while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

15.5.4 CJD may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 15.6.

15.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for CJD, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

15.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned CJD, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

15.5.7 Requests for CJD during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

15.5.8 CJD sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 15.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

CJD may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 15.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine CJD with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 15.4. Combination of CJD with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of CJD, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 15.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q15.7.1. Can CJD be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 15.6, CJD may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q15.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing CJD?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 15.2 for each cadre.

Q15.7.3. What happens to unavailed CJD at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed CJD balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q15.7.4. Can CJD be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for CJD.

Q15.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction CJD for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 15.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q15.7.6. Can CJD be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, CJD may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q15.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for CJD?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 15.2 of this Chapter.

Q15.7.8. Does CJD accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q15.7.9. Can an employee encash CJD while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily CJD is not encashable in service.

Q15.7.10. What is the maximum CJD balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 15.2; balances of approximately 5 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q15.7.11. Can CJD be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of CJD is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q15.7.12. Is CJD available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to CJD linked to the term of the contract.

Q15.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for CJD?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 15.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q15.7.14. Does CJD lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q15.7.15. Can CJD be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q15.7.16. What proof is required for emergency CJD availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 15.2.

Q15.7.17. Can CJD entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 15.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q15.7.18. Is CJD counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

CJD availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q15.7.19. Who maintains the official record of CJD for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 15.9 of this Chapter.

Q15.7.20. Can CJD be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 15.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q15.7.21. Does CJD entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q15.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for CJD exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 15.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q15.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for CJD after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q15.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of CJD?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of CJD is not separately debited to the CJD account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q15.7.25. Can CJD be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction CJD to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q15.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of CJD?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 15.15.

Q15.7.27. Can CJD be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with CJD for the same day.

Q15.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for CJD within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q15.7.29. Does CJD availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; CJD availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q15.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied CJD?

No; as clarified in Clause 15.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer CJD.

Q15.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for CJD if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 15.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q15.7.32. Can I be denied CJD because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 15.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of CJD on this ground.

Q15.7.33. Will my CJD application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 15.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 15.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 15.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for CJD for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 15.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 15.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for CJD was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 15.4.

Case 15.8.3. An employee proceeding on CJD was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 15.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 15.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 15.3.

Case 15.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine CJD with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 15.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for CJD was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 15.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 15.8.7. An employee's CJD was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 15.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where CJD had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 15.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 15.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought CJD spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 15.11.7, that the debit to the CJD account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 15.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile CJD balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 15.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 15.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of CJD was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 15.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 15.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for CJD coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 15.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 15.5.

Case 15.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for CJD through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 15.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 15.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's CJD application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 15.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 15.8.15. An employee's CJD entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 15.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 15.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for CJD under Clause 15.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 15.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 15.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 15.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 15.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 15.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 15.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 15.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 15.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 15.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 15.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 15.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to CJD set out in Section 15.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 15.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of CJD sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 15.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to CJD arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for CJD utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 15.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 15.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of CJD to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for CJD from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 15.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

15.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for CJD exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

15.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to CJD under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's CJD account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

15.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of CJD sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to CJD for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

15.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of CJD may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 15.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

15.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for CJD under Section 15.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

15.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue CJD against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for CJD during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

15.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of CJD within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

15.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for CJD shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while CJD stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 15.5.8 shall apply.

15.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued CJD balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

15.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for CJD, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

15.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of CJD availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of CJD

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

15.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for CJD, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

15.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for CJD on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of CJD remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent CJD is encashable.

15.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of CJD shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

15.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 15.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction CJD to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

15.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing CJD shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

15.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of CJD shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

15.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned CJD, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

15.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of CJD, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

15.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned CJD spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

15.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any CJD balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

15.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for CJD may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

15.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for CJD on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

15.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue CJD in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

15.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to CJD, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

15.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of CJD shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing CJD that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

15.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for CJD shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

15.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of CJD shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

15.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of CJD, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

15.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise CJD for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the CJD account.

15.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile CJD availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

15.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail CJD in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

15.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for CJD that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of CJD exceeding five consecutive days.

15.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for CJD, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

15.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to CJD recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 15.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

15.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for CJD to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 15.2 having regard to the circumstances.

15.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with CJD coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and CJD under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

15.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue CJD under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

15.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of CJD shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 15.15.

15.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for CJD on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring CJD.

15.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for CJD spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

15.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of CJD or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for CJD shall be liable to action under that Policy.

15.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for CJD during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

15.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for CJD on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

15.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for CJD, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

15.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to CJD not resolved through the FAQ in Section 15.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 15.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 15.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 15.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 15.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee A avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee B avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee C avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee D avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 4.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee E avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee F avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee G avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee H avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee I avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee J avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee K avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 2.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee L avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee M avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee N avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee O avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee P avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee Q avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee R avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 5 days = 3.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee S avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee T avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee U avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee V avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee W avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee X avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 15.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 15.3, the pro-rata entitlement to CJD for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 15.3. Where Employee Y avails of CJD in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 15.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — CJD

Ref: RSB/HRD/CJD/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 15.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Leave for Court / Jury

Duty for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 15.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

15.15.1 Sanctioning of CJD recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

15.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for CJD exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

15.15.3 CJD sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 15.4.

15.15.4 Carry-forward of CJD balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 15.2 without a recorded justification.

15.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for CJD.

15.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for CJD.

15.15.7 CJD combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 15.6.

15.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's CJD account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

15.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where CJD was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

15.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for CJD beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

15.15.11 Sanction of CJD recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 15.12.

15.15.12 Physical-format applications for CJD, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 15.12.

15.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to CJD inconsistent with the provisions of Section 15.11.

15.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of CJD within entitlement, contrary to Clause 15.12.

15.15.15 Leave Account for CJD not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 15.12.

15.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of CJD, contrary to Clause 15.12.

15.15.17 CJD entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 15.12.

15.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for CJD, contrary to Clause 15.12.

15.15.19 Sanction order for CJD issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 15.12.

15.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 15.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 15.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to CJD that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 5-day annual entitlement to CJD that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to CJD that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to CJD that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to CJD that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to CJD that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for CJD are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 15.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the CJD is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to CJD that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 15.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 15.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for CJD dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 15.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 15.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 15.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for CJD is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 15.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my CJD balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 15.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 15.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 5 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of CJD utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 15.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 1 and 5 days against the prescribed entitlement of 5 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 13 and 16 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for CJD to which they are entitled under Section 15.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 15.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current CJD balance?

Ticket HD-15101: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

My CJD application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-15102: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

I made an error in my CJD application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-15103: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Will my CJD be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-15104: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I attach a document after submitting my CJD application?

Ticket HD-15105: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Why was my CJD auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-15106: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-15107: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I apply for CJD on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-15108: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

My CJD balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-15109: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Is there a mobile app to apply for CJD?

Ticket HD-15110: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

CJD.

Can I cancel a sanctioned CJD after it has started?

Ticket HD-15111: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

How far in advance can I apply for CJD?

Ticket HD-15112: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-15113: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I see my CJD history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-15114: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Who approves CJD if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-15115: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Does CJD availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-15116: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I split a single CJD application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-15117: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

What if my CJD balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-15118: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I apply for CJD for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-15119: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Is there a separate process for CJD during my notice period?

Ticket HD-15120: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for CJD?

Ticket HD-15121: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

How do I download a certificate of CJD availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-15122: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my CJD application?

Ticket HD-15123: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I apply for CJD if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-15124: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my CJD balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-15125: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I apply for CJD using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-15126: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

What happens to my pending CJD application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-15127: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

CJD.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my CJD application?

Ticket HD-15128: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Is there a helpline number for CJD queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-15129: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can my CJD application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-15130: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for CJD?

Ticket HD-15131: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my CJD application?

Ticket HD-15132: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Is CJD entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-15133: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Who do I contact if my CJD application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-15134: Please refer to Section 15.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 15.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code CJD.

Section 15.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 15.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for CJD from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 15.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 15.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 15.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 15.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 15.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **CJD Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to CJD accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 15.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction CJD for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to CJD computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 15.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed CJD balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which CJD availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned CJD is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of CJD records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 15.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for CJD to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which CJD entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 15.12 in connection with sanction of CJD.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of CJD, as described in Clause 15.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction CJD under Section 15.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 15.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning CJD.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent CJD balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to CJD, as illustrated in Section 15.20.

Section 15.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing CJD since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/CJD/2013/100	22-Jan-2013	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CJD/2014/107	25-Aug-2014	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CJD/2015/114	14-Aug-2015	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2016/121	05-Mar-2016	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CJD/2017/128	06-Nov-2017	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2018/135	06-Jun-2018	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2019/142	06-Sep-2019	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CJD/2020/149	26-Jun-2020	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CJD/2021/156	22-Nov-2021	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2022/163	26-Mar-2022	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CJD/2023/170	06-Nov-2023	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CJD/2024/177	04-Jun-2024	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CJD/2025/184	02-Nov-2025	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2026/191	08-Mar-2026	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation

Section 15.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); Chapter on Special Casual Leave (SCL); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 16 — Bereavement / Compassionate Leave (BCL)

Clause 16.1 — Overview and Objective. Bereavement / Compassionate Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘BCL’ in this Manual) is leave granted on the death of an immediate family member. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Bereavement / Compassionate Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to BCL. The objective of BCL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of bereavement / compassionate leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 16.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 16.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 16.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 16.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 13 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 16.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 16.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 16.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 16.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for BCL up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	22	22	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	23	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	9	13	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	22	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	12	7	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	17	9	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	14	18	3 working day(s)

Clause 16.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to BCL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of BCL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of BCL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 16.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 16.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for BCL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on BCL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 16.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of BCL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 16.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

16.5.1 BCL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

16.5.2 BCL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

16.5.3 An employee proceeding on BCL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

16.5.4 BCL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 16.6.

16.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for BCL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

16.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned BCL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

16.5.7 Requests for BCL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

16.5.8 BCL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 16.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

BCL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 16.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine BCL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 16.4. Combination of BCL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of BCL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 16.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q16.7.1. Can BCL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 16.6, BCL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q16.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing BCL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 16.2 for each cadre.

Q16.7.3. What happens to unavailed BCL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed BCL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q16.7.4. Can BCL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for BCL.

Q16.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction BCL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 16.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q16.7.6. Can BCL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, BCL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q16.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for BCL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 16.2 of this Chapter.

Q16.7.8. Does BCL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q16.7.9. Can an employee encash BCL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily BCL is not encashable in service.

Q16.7.10. What is the maximum BCL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 16.2; balances of approximately 7 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q16.7.11. Can BCL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of BCL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q16.7.12. Is BCL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to BCL linked to the term of the contract.

Q16.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for BCL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 16.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q16.7.14. Does BCL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q16.7.15. Can BCL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q16.7.16. What proof is required for emergency BCL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 16.2.

Q16.7.17. Can BCL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 16.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q16.7.18. Is BCL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

BCL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q16.7.19. Who maintains the official record of BCL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 16.9 of this Chapter.

Q16.7.20. Can BCL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 16.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q16.7.21. Does BCL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q16.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for BCL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 16.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q16.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for BCL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q16.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of BCL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of BCL is not separately debited to the BCL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q16.7.25. Can BCL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction BCL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q16.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of BCL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 16.15.

Q16.7.27. Can BCL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with BCL for the same day.

Q16.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for BCL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q16.7.29. Does BCL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; BCL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q16.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied BCL?

No; as clarified in Clause 16.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer BCL.

Q16.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for BCL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 16.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q16.7.32. Can I be denied BCL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 16.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of BCL on this ground.

Q16.7.33. Will my BCL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 16.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 16.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 16.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for BCL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 16.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 16.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for BCL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 16.4.

Case 16.8.3. An employee proceeding on BCL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 16.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 16.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 16.3.

Case 16.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine BCL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 16.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for BCL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 16.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 16.8.7. An employee's BCL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 16.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where BCL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 16.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 16.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought BCL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 16.11.7, that the debit to the BCL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 16.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile BCL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 16.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 16.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of BCL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 16.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 16.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for BCL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 16.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 16.5.

Case 16.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for BCL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 16.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 16.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's BCL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 16.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 16.8.15. An employee's BCL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 16.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 16.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for BCL under Clause 16.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 16.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 16.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 16.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 16.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 16.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 16.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 16.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 16.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 16.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 16.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 16.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to BCL set out in Section 16.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 16.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of BCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 16.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BCL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for BCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 16.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 16.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BCL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 16.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

16.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for BCL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

16.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to BCL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's BCL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

16.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of BCL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to BCL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

16.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of BCL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 16.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

16.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for BCL under Section 16.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

16.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue BCL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for BCL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

16.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of BCL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

16.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for BCL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while BCL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 16.5.8 shall apply.

16.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued BCL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

16.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for BCL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

16.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of BCL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of BCL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

16.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for BCL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

16.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for BCL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of BCL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent BCL is encashable.

16.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of BCL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

16.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 16.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction BCL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

16.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing BCL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

16.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of BCL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

16.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned BCL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

16.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of BCL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

16.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned BCL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

16.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any BCL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

16.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for BCL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

16.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for BCL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

16.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue BCL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

16.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to BCL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

16.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of BCL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing BCL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

16.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for BCL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

16.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of BCL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

16.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of BCL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

16.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise BCL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the BCL account.

16.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile BCL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

16.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail BCL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

16.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for BCL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of BCL exceeding five consecutive days.

16.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for BCL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

16.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to BCL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 16.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

16.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for BCL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 16.2 having regard to the circumstances.

16.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with BCL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and BCL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

16.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue BCL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

16.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of BCL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 16.15.

16.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for BCL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring BCL.

16.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for BCL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

16.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of BCL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for BCL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

16.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for BCL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

16.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for BCL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

16.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for BCL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

16.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to BCL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 16.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 16.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 16.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 16.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 16.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee A avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee B avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee C avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee D avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee E avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee F avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee G avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee H avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee I avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee J avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee K avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee L avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee M avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee N avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee O avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee P avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee Q avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee R avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee S avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee T avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee U avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee V avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee W avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee X avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 16.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 16.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BCL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 16.3. Where Employee Y avails of BCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 16.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — BCL

Ref: RSB/HRD/BCL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Bereavement / Compassionate Leave (BCL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 16.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Bereavement /

Compassionate Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 16.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

16.15.1 Sanctioning of BCL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

16.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for BCL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

16.15.3 BCL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 16.4.

16.15.4 Carry-forward of BCL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 16.2 without a recorded justification.

16.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for BCL.

16.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for BCL.

16.15.7 BCL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 16.6.

16.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's BCL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

16.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where BCL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

16.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for BCL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

16.15.11 Sanction of BCL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 16.12.

16.15.12 Physical-format applications for BCL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 16.12.

16.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to BCL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 16.11.

16.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of BCL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 16.12.

16.15.15 Leave Account for BCL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 16.12.

16.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of BCL, contrary to Clause 16.12.

16.15.17 BCL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 16.12.

16.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for BCL, contrary to Clause 16.12.

16.15.19 Sanction order for BCL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 16.12.

16.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 16.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 16.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to BCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to BCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to BCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to BCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to BCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to BCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for BCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 16.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to BCL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 16.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 16.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for BCL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 16.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 16.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 16.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for BCL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 16.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my BCL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 16.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 16.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 16.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 10 and 13 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BCL to which they are entitled under Section 16.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 16.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current BCL balance?

Ticket HD-16101: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

My BCL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-16102: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

I made an error in my BCL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-16103: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Will my BCL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-16104: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my BCL application?

Ticket HD-16105: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Why was my BCL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-16106: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-16107: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I apply for BCL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-16108: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

My BCL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-16109: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for BCL?

Ticket HD-16110: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

BCL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned BCL after it has started?

Ticket HD-16111: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

How far in advance can I apply for BCL?

Ticket HD-16112: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-16113: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I see my BCL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-16114: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Who approves BCL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-16115: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Does BCL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-16116: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I split a single BCL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-16117: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

What if my BCL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-16118: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I apply for BCL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-16119: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Is there a separate process for BCL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-16120: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for BCL?

Ticket HD-16121: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

How do I download a certificate of BCL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-16122: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my BCL application?

Ticket HD-16123: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I apply for BCL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-16124: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my BCL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-16125: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I apply for BCL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-16126: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

What happens to my pending BCL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-16127: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

BCL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my BCL application?

Ticket HD-16128: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Is there a helpline number for BCL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-16129: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can my BCL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-16130: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for BCL?

Ticket HD-16131: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my BCL application?

Ticket HD-16132: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Is BCL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-16133: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Who do I contact if my BCL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-16134: Please refer to Section 16.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 16.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BCL.

Section 16.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 16.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for BCL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 16.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 16.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 16.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 16.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 16.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **BCL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to BCL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 16.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction BCL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to BCL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 16.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed BCL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which BCL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned BCL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of BCL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 16.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for BCL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which BCL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 16.12 in connection with sanction of BCL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of BCL, as described in Clause 16.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction BCL under Section 16.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 16.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning BCL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent BCL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to BCL, as illustrated in Section 16.20.

Section 16.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing BCL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/BCL/2013/100	26-Nov-2013	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BCL/2014/107	08-Jan-2014	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BCL/2015/114	07-Jun-2015	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/BCL/2016/121	09-Nov-2016	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2017/128	25-Apr-2017	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/BCL/2018/135	21-Aug-2018	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2019/142	22-Nov-2019	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/BCL/2020/149	11-Jan-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BCL/2021/156	09-Mar-2021	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/BCL/2022/163	09-Jan-2022	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BCL/2023/170	20-Jun-2023	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/BCL/2024/177	24-Nov-2024	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2025/184	14-Aug-2025	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2026/191	04-Jun-2026	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction

Section 16.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Election Duty Leave (EDL); Chapter on Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (SDE); Chapter on Sabbatical Leave (SBL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 17 — Marriage Leave (MGL)

Clause 17.1 — Overview and Objective. Marriage Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘MGL’ in this Manual) is leave granted to an employee on the occasion of their own marriage. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Marriage Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to MGL. The objective of MGL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of marriage leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 17.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 17.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 17.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 17.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority

may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 17.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 17.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 16 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.33 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 20 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 17.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 10 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 17.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for MGL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for MGL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	15	10	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	20	11	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	17	21	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	11	10	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	16	20	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	10	21	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	15	6	3 working day(s)

Clause 17.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to MGL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of MGL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of MGL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 17.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 17.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for MGL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on MGL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 17.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of MGL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 17.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

17.5.1 MGL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

17.5.2 MGL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

17.5.3 An employee proceeding on MGL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

17.5.4 MGL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 17.6.

17.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for MGL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

17.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned MGL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

17.5.7 Requests for MGL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

17.5.8 MGL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 17.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

MGL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 17.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine MGL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 17.4. Combination of MGL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of MGL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 17.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q17.7.1. Can MGL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 17.6, MGL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q17.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing MGL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 17.2 for each cadre.

Q17.7.3. What happens to unavailed MGL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed MGL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q17.7.4. Can MGL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for MGL.

Q17.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction MGL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 17.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q17.7.6. Can MGL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, MGL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q17.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for MGL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 17.2 of this Chapter.

Q17.7.8. Does MGL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q17.7.9. Can an employee encash MGL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily MGL is not encashable in service.

Q17.7.10. What is the maximum MGL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 17.2; balances of approximately 20 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q17.7.11. Can MGL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of MGL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q17.7.12. Is MGL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to MGL linked to the term of the contract.

Q17.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for MGL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 17.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q17.7.14. Does MGL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q17.7.15. Can MGL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q17.7.16. What proof is required for emergency MGL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 17.2.

Q17.7.17. Can MGL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 17.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q17.7.18. Is MGL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

MGL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q17.7.19. Who maintains the official record of MGL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 17.9 of this Chapter.

Q17.7.20. Can MGL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 17.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q17.7.21. Does MGL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q17.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for MGL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 17.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q17.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for MGL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q17.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of MGL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of MGL is not separately debited to the MGL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q17.7.25. Can MGL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction MGL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q17.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of MGL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 17.15.

Q17.7.27. Can MGL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with MGL for the same day.

Q17.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for MGL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q17.7.29. Does MGL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; MGL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q17.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied MGL?

No; as clarified in Clause 17.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer MGL.

Q17.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for MGL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 17.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q17.7.32. Can I be denied MGL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 17.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of MGL on this ground.

Q17.7.33. Will my MGL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 17.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 17.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 17.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for MGL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 17.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 17.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for MGL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 17.4.

Case 17.8.3. An employee proceeding on MGL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 17.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 17.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 17.3.

Case 17.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine MGL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 17.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for MGL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 17.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 17.8.7. An employee's MGL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 17.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where MGL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 17.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 17.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought MGL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 17.11.7, that the debit to the MGL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 17.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile MGL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 17.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 17.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of MGL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 17.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 17.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for MGL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 17.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 17.5.

Case 17.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for MGL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 17.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 17.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's MGL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 17.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 17.8.15. An employee's MGL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 17.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 17.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for MGL under Clause 17.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 17.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 17.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 17.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 17.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 17.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 17.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 17.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 17.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 17.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 17.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 17.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to MGL set out in Section 17.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 17.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of MGL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 17.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to MGL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for MGL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 17.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 17.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of MGL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for MGL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 17.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

17.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for MGL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

17.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to MGL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's MGL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

17.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of MGL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to MGL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

17.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of MGL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 17.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

17.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for MGL under Section 17.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

17.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue MGL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for MGL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

17.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of MGL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

17.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for MGL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while MGL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 17.5.8 shall apply.

17.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued MGL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

17.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for MGL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

17.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of MGL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of MGL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

17.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for MGL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

17.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for MGL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of MGL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent MGL is encashable.

17.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of MGL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

17.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 17.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction MGL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

17.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing MGL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

17.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of MGL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

17.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned MGL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

17.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of MGL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly

Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

17.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned MGL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

17.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any MGL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

17.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for MGL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

17.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for MGL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

17.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue MGL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

17.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to MGL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

17.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of MGL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing MGL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

17.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for MGL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

17.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of MGL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

17.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of MGL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

17.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise MGL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the MGL account.

17.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile MGL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

17.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail MGL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

17.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for MGL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of MGL exceeding five consecutive days.

17.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for MGL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

17.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to MGL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 17.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

17.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for MGL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 17.2 having regard to the circumstances.

17.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with MGL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and MGL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

17.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue MGL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

17.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of MGL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 17.15.

17.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for MGL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring MGL.

17.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for MGL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

17.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of MGL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for MGL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

17.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for MGL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

17.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for MGL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

17.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for MGL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

17.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to MGL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 17.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 17.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 17.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 17.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 17.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee A avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee B avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee C avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee D avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee E avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee F avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be

treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee G avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee H avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee I avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee J avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 8.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee K avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee L avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee M works

out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee M avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee N avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee O avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee P avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee Q avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee R avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee S avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee T avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee U avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee V avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee W avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee X avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 17.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 17.3, the pro-rata entitlement to MGL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 17.3. Where Employee Y avails of MGL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 17.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — MGL

Ref: RSB/HRD/MGL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Marriage Leave (MGL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 17.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Marriage Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 17.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

17.15.1 Sanctioning of MGL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

17.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for MGL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

17.15.3 MGL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 17.4.

17.15.4 Carry-forward of MGL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 17.2 without a recorded justification.

17.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for MGL.

17.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for MGL.

17.15.7 MGL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 17.6.

17.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's MGL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

17.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where MGL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

17.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for MGL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

17.15.11 Sanction of MGL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 17.12.

17.15.12 Physical-format applications for MGL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 17.12.

17.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to MGL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 17.11.

17.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of MGL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 17.12.

17.15.15 Leave Account for MGL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 17.12.

17.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of MGL, contrary to Clause 17.12.

17.15.17 MGL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 17.12.

17.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for MGL, contrary to Clause 17.12.

17.15.19 Sanction order for MGL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 17.12.

17.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 17.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 17.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall

additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 16-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 10-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for MGL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 17.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the MGL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to MGL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 17.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 17.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for MGL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 17.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 17.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 17.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for MGL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 17.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my MGL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 17.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 17.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to

the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 16 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 10 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of MGL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 17.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment

trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 12 and 16 days against the prescribed entitlement of 16 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 17 and 20 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 6 and 10 days against the prescribed entitlement of 10 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for MGL to which they are entitled under Section 17.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 17.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current MGL balance?

Ticket HD-17101: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

My MGL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-17102: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

I made an error in my MGL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-17103: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Will my MGL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-17104: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my MGL application?

Ticket HD-17105: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Why was my MGL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-17106: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-17107: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I apply for MGL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-17108: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

My MGL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-17109: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the

Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for MGL?

Ticket HD-17110: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned MGL after it has started?

Ticket HD-17111: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

How far in advance can I apply for MGL?

Ticket HD-17112: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-17113: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I see my MGL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-17114: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Who approves MGL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-17115: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Does MGL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-17116: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I split a single MGL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-17117: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

What if my MGL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-17118: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I apply for MGL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-17119: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Is there a separate process for MGL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-17120: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for MGL?

Ticket HD-17121: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

How do I download a certificate of MGL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-17122: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my MGL application?

Ticket HD-17123: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I apply for MGL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-17124: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my MGL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-17125: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I apply for MGL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-17126: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

MGL.

What happens to my pending MGL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-17127: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my MGL application?

Ticket HD-17128: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Is there a helpline number for MGL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-17129: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can my MGL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-17130: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for MGL?

Ticket HD-17131: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my MGL application?

Ticket HD-17132: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Is MGL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-17133: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Who do I contact if my MGL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-17134: Please refer to Section 17.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 17.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code MGL.

Section 17.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 17.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for MGL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 17.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 17.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 17.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 17.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 17.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **MGL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to MGL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 17.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction MGL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to MGL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 17.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed MGL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which MGL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned MGL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of MGL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 17.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for MGL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which MGL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 17.12 in connection with sanction of MGL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of MGL, as described in Clause 17.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction MGL under Section 17.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 17.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning MGL.

- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent MGL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to MGL, as illustrated in Section 17.20.

Section 17.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing MGL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/MGL/2013/100	23-Jun-2013	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2014/107	17-Nov-2014	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2015/114	22-Sep-2015	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/MGL/2016/121	24-Sep-2016	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/MGL/2017/128	12-Jun-2017	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/MGL/2018/135	22-Apr-2018	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2019/142	11-Sep-2019	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/MGL/2020/149	04-Sep-2020	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/MGL/2021/156	17-Apr-2021	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/MGL/2022/163	14-Apr-2022	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/MGL/2023/170	23-Apr-2023	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/MGL/2024/177	05-Mar-2024	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/MGL/2025/184	22-Jun-2025	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/MGL/2026/191	24-Mar-2026	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Section 17.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Blood Donation Leave (BDL); Chapter on Election Duty Leave (EDL); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 18 — Leave Encashment (LE)

Clause 18.1 — Overview and Objective. Leave Encashment (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘LE’ in this Manual) is the rules governing conversion of accumulated leave balance into monetary compensation. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Leave Encashment across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to LE. The objective of LE is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of leave encashment without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 18.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 18.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 18.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 18.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 16 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 18.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 18.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 18.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 18.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for LE up to a maximum of 16 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.33 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LE by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	17	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	21	7	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	15	16	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	20	21	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	14	7	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	12	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	16	6	3 working day(s)

Clause 18.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to LE for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of LE for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of LE of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 18.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 18.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for LE shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on LE without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 18.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of LE, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 18.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

18.5.1 LE shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

18.5.2 LE availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

18.5.3 An employee proceeding on LE while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

18.5.4 LE may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 18.6.

18.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for LE, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

18.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned LE, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

18.5.7 Requests for LE during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

18.5.8 LE sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 18.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

LE may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 18.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine LE with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 18.4. Combination of LE with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of LE, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 18.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q18.7.1. Can LE be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 18.6, LE may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q18.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing LE?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 18.2 for each cadre.

Q18.7.3. What happens to unavailed LE at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed LE balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q18.7.4. Can LE be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for LE.

Q18.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction LE for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 18.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q18.7.6. Can LE be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, LE may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q18.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for LE?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 18.2 of this Chapter.

Q18.7.8. Does LE accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q18.7.9. Can an employee encash LE while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily LE is not encashable in service.

Q18.7.10. What is the maximum LE balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 18.2; balances of approximately 21 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q18.7.11. Can LE be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of LE is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q18.7.12. Is LE available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to LE linked to the term of the contract.

Q18.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for LE?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 18.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q18.7.14. Does LE lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q18.7.15. Can LE be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q18.7.16. What proof is required for emergency LE availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 18.2.

Q18.7.17. Can LE entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 18.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q18.7.18. Is LE counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

LE availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q18.7.19. Who maintains the official record of LE for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 18.9 of this Chapter.

Q18.7.20. Can LE be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 18.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q18.7.21. Does LE entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q18.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for LE exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 18.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q18.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for LE after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q18.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of LE?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of LE is not separately debited to the LE account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q18.7.25. Can LE be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction LE to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q18.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of LE?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 18.15.

Q18.7.27. Can LE be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with LE for the same day.

Q18.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for LE within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q18.7.29. Does LE availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; LE availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q18.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied LE?

No; as clarified in Clause 18.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer LE.

Q18.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for LE if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 18.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q18.7.32. Can I be denied LE because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 18.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of LE on this ground.

Q18.7.33. Will my LE application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 18.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 18.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 18.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for LE for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 18.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 18.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for LE was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 18.4.

Case 18.8.3. An employee proceeding on LE was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 18.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 18.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 18.3.

Case 18.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine LE with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 18.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for LE was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 18.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 18.8.7. An employee's LE was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 18.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where LE had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 18.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 18.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought LE spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 18.11.7, that the debit to the LE account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 18.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile LE balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 18.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 18.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of LE was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 18.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 18.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for LE coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 18.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 18.5.

Case 18.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for LE through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 18.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 18.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's LE application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 18.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 18.8.15. An employee's LE entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 18.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 18.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for LE under Clause 18.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 18.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 18.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 18.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 18.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 18.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 18.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 18.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 18.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 18.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 18.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 18.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to LE set out in Section 18.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 18.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of LE sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 18.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LE arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for LE utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 18.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 18.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LE to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LE from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 18.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

18.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for LE exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

18.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to LE under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's LE account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

18.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of LE sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to LE for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

18.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of LE may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 18.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

18.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for LE under Section 18.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

18.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue LE against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for LE during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

18.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of LE within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

18.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for LE shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while LE stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 18.5.8 shall apply.

18.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued LE balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

18.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for LE, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

18.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of LE availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of LE entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD

Department.

18.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for LE, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

18.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for LE on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of LE remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent LE is encashable.

18.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of LE shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

18.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 18.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction LE to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

18.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing LE shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

18.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of LE shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

18.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned LE, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

18.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of LE, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

18.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned LE spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

18.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any LE balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

18.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for LE may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

18.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for LE on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

18.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue LE in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

18.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to LE, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

18.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of LE shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing LE that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

18.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for LE shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

18.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of LE shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

18.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of LE, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

18.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise LE for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the LE account.

18.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile LE availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

18.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail LE in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

18.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for LE that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of LE exceeding five consecutive days.

18.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for LE, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

18.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to LE recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 18.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

18.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for LE to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 18.2 having regard to the circumstances.

18.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with LE coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and LE under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

18.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue LE under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

18.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of LE shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 18.15.

18.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for LE on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring LE.

18.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for LE spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

18.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of LE or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for LE shall be liable to action under that Policy.

18.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for LE during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

18.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for LE on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

18.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for LE, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

18.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to LE not resolved through the FAQ in Section 18.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 18.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 18.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 18.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 18.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee A avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee B avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee C avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee D avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee E avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee F avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee G avails of LE in excess of this

pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee H avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee I avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee J avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee K avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee L avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee M avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year.

Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee N avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee O avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 10.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee P avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee Q avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee R avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee S avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee T avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee U avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee V avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 16 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee W avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee X avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 18.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 18.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LE for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 18.3. Where Employee Y avails of LE in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 18.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — LE

Ref: RSB/HRD/LE/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Leave Encashment (LE) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 18.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Leave Encashment for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has

been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 18.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

18.15.1 Sanctioning of LE recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

18.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for LE exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

18.15.3 LE sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 18.4.

18.15.4 Carry-forward of LE balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 18.2 without a recorded justification.

18.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for LE.

18.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for LE.

18.15.7 LE combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 18.6.

18.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's LE account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

18.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where LE was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

18.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for LE beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

18.15.11 Sanction of LE recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 18.12.

18.15.12 Physical-format applications for LE, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 18.12.

18.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to LE inconsistent with the provisions of Section 18.11.

18.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of LE within entitlement, contrary to Clause 18.12.

18.15.15 Leave Account for LE not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 18.12.

18.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of LE, contrary to Clause 18.12.

18.15.17 LE entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 18.12.

18.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for LE, contrary to Clause 18.12.

18.15.19 Sanction order for LE issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 18.12.

18.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 18.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 18.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to LE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to LE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to LE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to LE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to LE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to LE that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for LE are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 18.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LE is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 16-day annual entitlement to LE that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 18.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 18.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for LE dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 18.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 18.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 18.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for LE is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 18.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my LE balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 18.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 18.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LE utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 16 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 18.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 13 and 16 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 12 and 16 days against the prescribed entitlement of 16 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LE to which they are entitled under Section 18.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 18.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current LE balance?

Ticket HD-18101: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

My LE application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-18102: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

I made an error in my LE application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-18103: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Will my LE be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-18104: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I attach a document after submitting my LE application?

Ticket HD-18105: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Why was my LE auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-18106: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-18107: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I apply for LE on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-18108: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

My LE balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-18109: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Is there a mobile app to apply for LE?

Ticket HD-18110: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

LE.

Can I cancel a sanctioned LE after it has started?

Ticket HD-18111: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

How far in advance can I apply for LE?

Ticket HD-18112: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-18113: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I see my LE history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-18114: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Who approves LE if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-18115: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Does LE availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-18116: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I split a single LE application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-18117: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

What if my LE balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-18118: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I apply for LE for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-18119: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Is there a separate process for LE during my notice period?

Ticket HD-18120: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for LE?

Ticket HD-18121: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

How do I download a certificate of LE availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-18122: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my LE application?

Ticket HD-18123: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I apply for LE if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-18124: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my LE balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-18125: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I apply for LE using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-18126: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

What happens to my pending LE application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-18127: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

LE.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my LE application?

Ticket HD-18128: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Is there a helpline number for LE queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-18129: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can my LE application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-18130: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for LE?

Ticket HD-18131: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my LE application?

Ticket HD-18132: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Is LE entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-18133: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Who do I contact if my LE application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-18134: Please refer to Section 18.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 18.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LE.

Section 18.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 18.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for LE from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 18.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 18.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 18.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 18.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 18.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **LE Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to LE accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 18.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction LE for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to LE computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 18.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed LE balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which LE availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned LE is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of LE records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 18.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for LE to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which LE entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 18.12 in connection with sanction of LE.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of LE, as described in Clause 18.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction LE under Section 18.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 18.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning LE.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent LE balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to LE, as illustrated in Section 18.20.

Section 18.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing LE since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/LE/2013/100	18-Nov-2013	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LE/2014/107	10-Apr-2014	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LE/2015/114	14-Nov-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LE/2016/121	20-Sep-2016	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LE/2017/128	15-Jun-2017	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LE/2018/135	22-Mar-2018	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LE/2019/142	16-Nov-2019	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LE/2020/149	24-Mar-2020	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LE/2021/156	03-Apr-2021	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LE/2022/163	22-Sep-2022	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LE/2023/170	11-Jan-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LE/2024/177	25-Mar-2024	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LE/2025/184	10-Mar-2025	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LE/2026/191	07-Mar-2026	Clarification on documentation requirements

Section 18.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Casual Leave (CL); Chapter on Sick Leave (SL); Chapter on Study Leave (STL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 19 — Quarantine Leave (QL)

Clause 19.1 — Overview and Objective. Quarantine Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘QL’ in this Manual) is leave granted where an employee is required to be isolated on account of a notified infectious disease. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Quarantine Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to QL. The objective of QL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of quarantine leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 19.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 19.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 19.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 19.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 13 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 19.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 19.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 19.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 23 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 19.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for QL up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for QL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	8	22	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	13	19	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	18	13	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	12	18	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	9	12	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	23	9	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	8	23	3 working day(s)

Clause 19.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to QL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of QL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of QL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 19.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 19.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for QL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on QL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 19.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of QL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 19.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

19.5.1 QL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

19.5.2 QL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

19.5.3 An employee proceeding on QL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

19.5.4 QL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 19.6.

19.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for QL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

19.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned QL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

19.5.7 Requests for QL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

19.5.8 QL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 19.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

QL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 19.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine QL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 19.4. Combination of QL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of QL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 19.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q19.7.1. Can QL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 19.6, QL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q19.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing QL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 19.2 for each cadre.

Q19.7.3. What happens to unavailed QL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed QL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q19.7.4. Can QL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for QL.

Q19.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction QL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 19.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q19.7.6. Can QL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, QL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q19.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for QL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 19.2 of this Chapter.

Q19.7.8. Does QL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q19.7.9. Can an employee encash QL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily QL is not encashable in service.

Q19.7.10. What is the maximum QL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 19.2; balances of approximately 13 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q19.7.11. Can QL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of QL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q19.7.12. Is QL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to QL linked to the term of the contract.

Q19.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for QL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 19.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q19.7.14. Does QL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q19.7.15. Can QL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q19.7.16. What proof is required for emergency QL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 19.2.

Q19.7.17. Can QL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 19.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q19.7.18. Is QL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

QL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q19.7.19. Who maintains the official record of QL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 19.9 of this Chapter.

Q19.7.20. Can QL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 19.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q19.7.21. Does QL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q19.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for QL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 19.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q19.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for QL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q19.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of QL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of QL is not separately debited to the QL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q19.7.25. Can QL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction QL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q19.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of QL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 19.15.

Q19.7.27. Can QL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with QL for the same day.

Q19.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for QL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q19.7.29. Does QL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; QL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q19.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied QL?

No; as clarified in Clause 19.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer QL.

Q19.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for QL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 19.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q19.7.32. Can I be denied QL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 19.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of QL on this ground.

Q19.7.33. Will my QL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 19.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 19.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 19.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for QL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 19.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 19.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for QL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 19.4.

Case 19.8.3. An employee proceeding on QL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 19.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 19.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 19.3.

Case 19.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine QL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 19.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for QL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 19.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 19.8.7. An employee's QL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 19.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where QL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 19.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 19.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought QL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 19.11.7, that the debit to the QL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 19.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile QL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 19.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 19.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of QL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 19.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 19.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for QL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 19.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 19.5.

Case 19.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for QL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 19.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 19.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's QL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 19.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 19.8.15. An employee's QL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 19.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 19.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for QL under Clause 19.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 19.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 19.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 19.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 19.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 19.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 19.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 19.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 19.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 19.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 19.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 19.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to QL set out in Section 19.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 19.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of QL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 19.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to QL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for QL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 19.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 19.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of QL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for QL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 19.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

19.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for QL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

19.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to QL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's QL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

19.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of QL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to QL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

19.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of QL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 19.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

19.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for QL under Section 19.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

19.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue QL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for QL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

19.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of QL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

19.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for QL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while QL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 19.5.8 shall apply.

19.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued QL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

19.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for QL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

19.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of QL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of QL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

19.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for QL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

19.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for QL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of QL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent QL is encashable.

19.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of QL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

19.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 19.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction QL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

19.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing QL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

19.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of QL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

19.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned QL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

19.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of QL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

19.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned QL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

19.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any QL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

19.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for QL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

19.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for QL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

19.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue QL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

19.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to QL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

19.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of QL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing QL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

19.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for QL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

19.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of QL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

19.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of QL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

19.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise QL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the QL account.

19.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile QL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

19.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail QL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

19.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for QL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of QL exceeding five consecutive days.

19.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for QL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

19.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to QL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 19.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

19.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for QL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 19.2 having regard to the circumstances.

19.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with QL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and QL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

19.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue QL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

19.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of QL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 19.15.

19.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for QL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring QL.

19.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for QL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

19.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of QL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for QL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

19.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for QL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

19.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for QL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

19.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for QL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

19.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to QL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 19.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 19.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 19.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 19.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 19.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee A avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee B avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee C avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee D avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee E avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee F avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee G avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee H avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee I avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee J avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 19.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee K avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee L avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee M avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee N avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee O avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee P avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee Q avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee R avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee S avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee T avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee U avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee V avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee W avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee X avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 19.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 19.3, the pro-rata entitlement to QL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 19.3. Where Employee Y avails of QL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 19.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — QL

Ref: RSB/HRD/QL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Quarantine Leave (QL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 19.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Quarantine Leave for

[Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 19.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

19.15.1 Sanctioning of QL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

19.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for QL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

19.15.3 QL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 19.4.

19.15.4 Carry-forward of QL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 19.2 without a recorded justification.

19.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for QL.

19.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for QL.

19.15.7 QL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 19.6.

19.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's QL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

19.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where QL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

19.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for QL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

19.15.11 Sanction of QL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 19.12.

19.15.12 Physical-format applications for QL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 19.12.

19.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to QL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 19.11.

19.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of QL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 19.12.

19.15.15 Leave Account for QL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 19.12.

19.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of QL, contrary to Clause 19.12.

19.15.17 QL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 19.12.

19.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for QL, contrary to Clause 19.12.

19.15.19 Sanction order for QL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 19.12.

19.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 19.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 19.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to QL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to QL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to QL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to QL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to QL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 23-day annual entitlement to QL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for QL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 19.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the QL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to QL that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 19.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 19.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for QL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 19.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 19.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 19.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for QL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 19.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my QL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 19.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 19.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 23 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of QL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 19.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 10 and 13 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 19 and 23 days against the prescribed entitlement of 23 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for QL to which they are entitled under Section 19.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 19.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current QL balance?

Ticket HD-19101: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

My QL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-19102: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

I made an error in my QL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-19103: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Will my QL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-19104: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my QL application?

Ticket HD-19105: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Why was my QL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-19106: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-19107: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I apply for QL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-19108: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

My QL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-19109: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for QL?

Ticket HD-19110: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

QL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned QL after it has started?

Ticket HD-19111: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

How far in advance can I apply for QL?

Ticket HD-19112: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-19113: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I see my QL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-19114: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Who approves QL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-19115: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Does QL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-19116: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I split a single QL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-19117: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

What if my QL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-19118: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I apply for QL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-19119: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Is there a separate process for QL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-19120: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for QL?

Ticket HD-19121: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

How do I download a certificate of QL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-19122: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my QL application?

Ticket HD-19123: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I apply for QL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-19124: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my QL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-19125: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I apply for QL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-19126: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

What happens to my pending QL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-19127: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

QL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my QL application?

Ticket HD-19128: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Is there a helpline number for QL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-19129: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can my QL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-19130: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for QL?

Ticket HD-19131: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my QL application?

Ticket HD-19132: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Is QL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-19133: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Who do I contact if my QL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-19134: Please refer to Section 19.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 19.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code QL.

Section 19.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 19.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for QL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 19.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 19.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 19.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 19.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 19.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **QL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to QL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 19.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction QL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to QL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 19.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed QL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which QL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned QL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of QL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 19.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for QL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which QL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 19.12 in connection with sanction of QL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of QL, as described in Clause 19.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction QL under Section 19.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 19.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning QL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent QL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to QL, as illustrated in Section 19.20.

Section 19.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing QL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/QL/2013/100	20-Nov-2013	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/QL/2014/107	03-Jun-2014	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2015/114	21-Aug-2015	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/QL/2016/121	23-Sep-2016	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/QL/2017/128	16-Jun-2017	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/QL/2018/135	05-Sep-2018	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/QL/2019/142	01-Nov-2019	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/QL/2020/149	25-Jan-2020	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2021/156	14-Mar-2021	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2022/163	26-Sep-2022	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/QL/2023/170	15-Jan-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/QL/2024/177	08-Nov-2024	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/QL/2025/184	15-Mar-2025	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/QL/2026/191	15-Sep-2026	Clarification on documentation requirements

Section 19.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (NCL); Chapter on Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA); Chapter on Blood Donation Leave (BDL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 20 — National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (NCL)

Clause 20.1 — Overview and Objective. National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘NCL’ in this Manual) is special leave granted to employees engaged in relief or rehabilitation work during a notified calamity. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to NCL. The objective of NCL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of national calamity / disaster relief leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 20.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 20.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 20.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 20.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 23 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the

Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 20.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 20.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 20.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 20.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for NCL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for NCL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in

cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	12	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	22	6	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	23	11	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	8	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	22	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	12	7	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	9	21	3 working day(s)

Clause 20.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to NCL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of NCL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of NCL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 20.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 20.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for NCL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on NCL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 20.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of NCL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 20.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

20.5.1 NCL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

20.5.2 NCL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

20.5.3 An employee proceeding on NCL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

20.5.4 NCL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 20.6.

20.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for NCL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

20.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned NCL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

20.5.7 Requests for NCL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

20.5.8 NCL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 20.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

NCL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 20.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine NCL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 20.4. Combination of NCL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of NCL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 20.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q20.7.1. Can NCL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 20.6, NCL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q20.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing NCL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 20.2 for each cadre.

Q20.7.3. What happens to unavailed NCL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed NCL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q20.7.4. Can NCL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for NCL.

Q20.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction NCL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 20.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q20.7.6. Can NCL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, NCL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q20.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for NCL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 20.2 of this Chapter.

Q20.7.8. Does NCL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q20.7.9. Can an employee encash NCL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily NCL is not encashable in service.

Q20.7.10. What is the maximum NCL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 20.2; balances of approximately 22 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q20.7.11. Can NCL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of NCL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q20.7.12. Is NCL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to NCL linked to the term of the contract.

Q20.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for NCL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 20.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q20.7.14. Does NCL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q20.7.15. Can NCL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q20.7.16. What proof is required for emergency NCL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 20.2.

Q20.7.17. Can NCL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 20.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q20.7.18. Is NCL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

NCL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q20.7.19. Who maintains the official record of NCL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 20.9 of this Chapter.

Q20.7.20. Can NCL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 20.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q20.7.21. Does NCL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q20.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for NCL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 20.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q20.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for NCL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q20.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of NCL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of NCL is not separately debited to the NCL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q20.7.25. Can NCL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction NCL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q20.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of NCL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 20.15.

Q20.7.27. Can NCL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with NCL for the same day.

Q20.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for NCL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q20.7.29. Does NCL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; NCL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q20.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied NCL?

No; as clarified in Clause 20.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer NCL.

Q20.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for NCL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 20.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q20.7.32. Can I be denied NCL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 20.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of NCL on this ground.

Q20.7.33. Will my NCL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 20.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 20.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 20.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for NCL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 20.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 20.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for NCL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 20.4.

Case 20.8.3. An employee proceeding on NCL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 20.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 20.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 20.3.

Case 20.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine NCL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 20.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for NCL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 20.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 20.8.7. An employee's NCL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 20.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where NCL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 20.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 20.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought NCL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 20.11.7, that the debit to the NCL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 20.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile NCL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 20.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 20.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of NCL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 20.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 20.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for NCL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 20.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 20.5.

Case 20.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for NCL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 20.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 20.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's NCL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 20.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 20.8.15. An employee's NCL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 20.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 20.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for NCL under Clause 20.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 20.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 20.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to NCL

set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 20.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of

reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 20.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 20.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 20.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 20.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 20.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 20.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save

that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 20.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager

responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 20.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to NCL set out in Section 20.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 20.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of NCL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 20.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to NCL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for NCL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 20.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 20.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of NCL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for NCL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 20.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

20.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for NCL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

20.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to NCL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent

of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's NCL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

20.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of NCL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to NCL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

20.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of NCL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 20.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

20.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for NCL under Section 20.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

20.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue NCL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for NCL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

20.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of NCL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

20.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for NCL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while NCL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 20.5.8 shall apply.

20.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued NCL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

20.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for NCL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

20.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of NCL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of NCL entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

20.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for NCL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

20.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for NCL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of NCL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent NCL is encashable.

20.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of NCL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

20.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 20.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction NCL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

20.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing NCL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

20.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of NCL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

20.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned NCL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

20.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of NCL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly

Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

20.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned NCL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

20.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any NCL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

20.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for NCL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

20.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for NCL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

20.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue NCL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

20.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to NCL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

20.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of NCL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing NCL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

20.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for NCL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

20.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of NCL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

20.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of NCL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

20.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise NCL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the NCL account.

20.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile NCL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

20.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail NCL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

20.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for NCL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of NCL exceeding five consecutive days.

20.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for NCL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

20.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to NCL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 20.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

20.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for NCL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 20.2 having regard to the circumstances.

20.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with NCL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and NCL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

20.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue NCL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

20.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of NCL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 20.15.

20.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for NCL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring NCL.

20.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for NCL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

20.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of NCL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for NCL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

20.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for NCL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

20.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for NCL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

20.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for NCL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

20.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to NCL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 20.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 20.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 20.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 20.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 20.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee A avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee B avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee C avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee D avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee E avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee F avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be

treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee G avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee H avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee I avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee J avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee K avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee L avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee M works

out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee M avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee N avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee O avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee P avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 19.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee Q avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee R avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee S avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee T avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee U avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee V avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee W avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee X avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 20.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 20.3, the pro-rata entitlement to NCL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 20.3. Where Employee Y avails of NCL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 20.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — NCL

Ref: RSB/HRD/NCL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (NCL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 20.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 20.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

20.15.1 Sanctioning of NCL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

20.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for NCL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

20.15.3 NCL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 20.4.

20.15.4 Carry-forward of NCL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 20.2 without a recorded justification.

20.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for NCL.

20.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for NCL.

20.15.7 NCL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 20.6.

20.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's NCL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

20.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where NCL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

20.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for NCL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

20.15.11 Sanction of NCL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 20.12.

20.15.12 Physical-format applications for NCL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 20.12.

20.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to NCL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 20.11.

20.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of NCL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 20.12.

20.15.15 Leave Account for NCL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 20.12.

20.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of NCL, contrary to Clause 20.12.

20.15.17 NCL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 20.12.

20.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for NCL, contrary to Clause 20.12.

20.15.19 Sanction order for NCL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 20.12.

20.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 20.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 20.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall

additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 23-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for NCL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 20.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the NCL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to NCL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 20.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 20.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for NCL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 20.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 20.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 20.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for NCL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 20.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my NCL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 20.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 20.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to

the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 23 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of NCL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 20.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment

trending between approximately 19 and 23 days against the prescribed entitlement of 23 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for NCL to which they are entitled under Section 20.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 20.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current NCL balance?

Ticket HD-20101: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

My NCL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-20102: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

I made an error in my NCL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-20103: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Will my NCL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-20104: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my NCL application?

Ticket HD-20105: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Why was my NCL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-20106: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-20107: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I apply for NCL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-20108: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

My NCL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-20109: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the

Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for NCL?

Ticket HD-20110: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned NCL after it has started?

Ticket HD-20111: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

How far in advance can I apply for NCL?

Ticket HD-20112: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-20113: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I see my NCL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-20114: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Who approves NCL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-20115: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Does NCL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-20116: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I split a single NCL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-20117: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

What if my NCL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-20118: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I apply for NCL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-20119: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Is there a separate process for NCL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-20120: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for NCL?

Ticket HD-20121: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

How do I download a certificate of NCL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-20122: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my NCL application?

Ticket HD-20123: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I apply for NCL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-20124: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my NCL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-20125: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I apply for NCL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-20126: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

NCL.

What happens to my pending NCL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-20127: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my NCL application?

Ticket HD-20128: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Is there a helpline number for NCL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-20129: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can my NCL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-20130: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for NCL?

Ticket HD-20131: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my NCL application?

Ticket HD-20132: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Is NCL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-20133: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Who do I contact if my NCL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-20134: Please refer to Section 20.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 20.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code NCL.

Section 20.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 20.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for NCL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 20.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 20.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 20.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 20.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 20.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **NCL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to NCL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 20.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction NCL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to NCL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 20.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed NCL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which NCL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned NCL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of NCL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 20.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for NCL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which NCL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 20.12 in connection with sanction of NCL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of NCL, as described in Clause 20.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction NCL under Section 20.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 20.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning NCL.

- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent NCL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to NCL, as illustrated in Section 20.20.

Section 20.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing NCL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/NCL/2013/100	25-Jun-2013	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/NCL/2014/107	27-Sep-2014	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2015/114	14-Nov-2015	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2016/121	15-Mar-2016	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2017/128	28-Jun-2017	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/NCL/2018/135	09-Nov-2018	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/NCL/2019/142	27-Sep-2019	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/NCL/2020/149	25-Nov-2020	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/NCL/2021/156	16-Sep-2021	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2022/163	09-Jun-2022	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/NCL/2023/170	23-Apr-2023	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/NCL/2024/177	09-Apr-2024	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/NCL/2025/184	18-Jan-2025	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/NCL/2026/191	05-Mar-2026	Clarification on combination with other leave types

Section 20.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD); Chapter on Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (LTC); Chapter on Paternity Leave (PTL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 21 — Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA)

Clause 21.1 — Overview and Objective. Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘SCA’ in this Manual) is leave granted to employees selected to represent the Bank, State, or Nation in recognised sporting or cultural events. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Sports & Cultural Activities Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to SCA. The objective of SCA is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of sports & cultural activities leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 21.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 21.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 8 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 23 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 21.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 21.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the

application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 21.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 21.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 13 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 21.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 21.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for SCA up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 12 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for SCA by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	8	23	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	14	17	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	19	22	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	11	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	18	13	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	15	22	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	9	12	3 working day(s)

Clause 21.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to SCA for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of SCA for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of SCA of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 21.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 21.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for SCA shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on SCA without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 21.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of SCA, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 21.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

21.5.1 SCA shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

21.5.2 SCA availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

21.5.3 An employee proceeding on SCA while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

21.5.4 SCA may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 21.6.

21.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for SCA, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

21.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned SCA, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

21.5.7 Requests for SCA during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

21.5.8 SCA sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 21.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

SCA may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 21.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine SCA with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 21.4. Combination of SCA with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of SCA, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 21.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q21.7.1. Can SCA be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 21.6, SCA may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q21.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing SCA?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 21.2 for each cadre.

Q21.7.3. What happens to unavailed SCA at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed SCA balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q21.7.4. Can SCA be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for SCA.

Q21.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction SCA for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 21.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q21.7.6. Can SCA be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, SCA may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q21.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for SCA?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 21.2 of this Chapter.

Q21.7.8. Does SCA accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q21.7.9. Can an employee encash SCA while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily SCA is not encashable in service.

Q21.7.10. What is the maximum SCA balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 21.2; balances of approximately 14 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q21.7.11. Can SCA be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of SCA is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q21.7.12. Is SCA available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to SCA linked to the term of the contract.

Q21.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for SCA?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 21.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q21.7.14. Does SCA lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q21.7.15. Can SCA be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q21.7.16. What proof is required for emergency SCA availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 21.2.

Q21.7.17. Can SCA entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 21.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q21.7.18. Is SCA counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

SCA availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q21.7.19. Who maintains the official record of SCA for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 21.9 of this Chapter.

Q21.7.20. Can SCA be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 21.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q21.7.21. Does SCA entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q21.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for SCA exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 21.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q21.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for SCA after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q21.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SCA?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of SCA is not separately debited to the SCA account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q21.7.25. Can SCA be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction SCA to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q21.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of SCA?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 21.15.

Q21.7.27. Can SCA be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with SCA for the same day.

Q21.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for SCA within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q21.7.29. Does SCA availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; SCA availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q21.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied SCA?

No; as clarified in Clause 21.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer SCA.

Q21.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for SCA if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 21.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q21.7.32. Can I be denied SCA because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 21.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of SCA on this ground.

Q21.7.33. Will my SCA application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 21.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 21.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 21.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for SCA for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 21.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 21.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for SCA was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 21.4.

Case 21.8.3. An employee proceeding on SCA was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 21.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 21.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 21.3.

Case 21.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine SCA with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 21.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for SCA was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 21.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 21.8.7. An employee's SCA was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 21.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where SCA had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 21.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 21.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought SCA spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 21.11.7, that the debit to the SCA account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 21.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile SCA balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 21.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 21.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of SCA was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 21.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 21.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for SCA coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 21.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 21.5.

Case 21.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for SCA through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 21.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 21.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's SCA application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 21.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 21.8.15. An employee's SCA entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 21.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 21.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for SCA under Clause 21.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 21.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 21.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 21.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 21.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 21.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 21.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 21.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 21.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 21.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 21.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 21.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to SCA set out in Section 21.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 21.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of SCA sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 21.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to SCA arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for SCA utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 21.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 21.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of SCA to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for SCA from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 21.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

21.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for SCA exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

21.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to SCA under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's SCA account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

21.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of SCA sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to SCA for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

21.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of SCA may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 21.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

21.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for SCA under Section 21.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

21.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue SCA against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for SCA during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

21.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of SCA within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

21.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for SCA shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while SCA stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 21.5.8 shall apply.

21.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued SCA balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

21.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for SCA, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

21.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of SCA availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of SCA

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

21.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for SCA, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

21.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for SCA on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of SCA remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent SCA is encashable.

21.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of SCA shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

21.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 21.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction SCA to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

21.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing SCA shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

21.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of SCA shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

21.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned SCA, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

21.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of SCA, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

21.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned SCA spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

21.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any SCA balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

21.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for SCA may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

21.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for SCA on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

21.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue SCA in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

21.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to SCA, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

21.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of SCA shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing SCA that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

21.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for SCA shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

21.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of SCA shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

21.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of SCA, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

21.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise SCA for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the SCA account.

21.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile SCA availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

21.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail SCA in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

21.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for SCA that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of SCA exceeding five consecutive days.

21.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for SCA, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

21.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to SCA recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 21.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

21.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for SCA to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 21.2 having regard to the circumstances.

21.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with SCA coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and SCA under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

21.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue SCA under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

21.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of SCA shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 21.15.

21.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for SCA on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring SCA.

21.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for SCA spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

21.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of SCA or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for SCA shall be liable to action under that Policy.

21.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for SCA during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

21.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for SCA on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

21.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for SCA, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

21.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to SCA not resolved through the FAQ in Section 21.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 21.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 21.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 21.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 21.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee A avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee B avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee C avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee D avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee E avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee F avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 5.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee G avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee H avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee I avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee J avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee K avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee L avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee M avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee N avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee O avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee P avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee Q avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee R avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee S avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee T avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 8 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee U avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee V avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee W avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee X avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 21.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 21.3, the pro-rata entitlement to SCA for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 21.3. Where Employee Y avails of SCA in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 21.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — SCA

Ref: RSB/HRD/SCA/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 21.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Sports & Cultural

Activities Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 21.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

21.15.1 Sanctioning of SCA recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

21.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for SCA exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

21.15.3 SCA sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 21.4.

21.15.4 Carry-forward of SCA balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 21.2 without a recorded justification.

21.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for SCA.

21.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for SCA.

21.15.7 SCA combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 21.6.

21.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's SCA account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

21.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where SCA was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

21.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for SCA beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

21.15.11 Sanction of SCA recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 21.12.

21.15.12 Physical-format applications for SCA, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 21.12.

21.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to SCA inconsistent with the provisions of Section 21.11.

21.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of SCA within entitlement, contrary to Clause 21.12.

21.15.15 Leave Account for SCA not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 21.12.

21.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of SCA, contrary to Clause 21.12.

21.15.17 SCA entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 21.12.

21.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for SCA, contrary to Clause 21.12.

21.15.19 Sanction order for SCA issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 21.12.

21.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 21.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 21.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 8-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for SCA are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 21.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the SCA is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to SCA that varies

by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 21.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 21.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for SCA dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 21.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 21.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 21.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for SCA is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 21.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my SCA balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 21.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 21.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 8 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of SCA utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 21.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 4 and 8 days against the prescribed entitlement of 8 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 20 and 23 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 10 and 13 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 9 and 12 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for SCA to which they are entitled under Section 21.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 21.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current SCA balance?

Ticket HD-21101: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

My SCA application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-21102: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

I made an error in my SCA application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-21103: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Will my SCA be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-21104: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I attach a document after submitting my SCA application?

Ticket HD-21105: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Why was my SCA auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-21106: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-21107: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I apply for SCA on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-21108: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

My SCA balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-21109: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Is there a mobile app to apply for SCA?

Ticket HD-21110: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SCA.

Can I cancel a sanctioned SCA after it has started?

Ticket HD-21111: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

How far in advance can I apply for SCA?

Ticket HD-21112: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-21113: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I see my SCA history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-21114: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Who approves SCA if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-21115: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Does SCA availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-21116: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I split a single SCA application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-21117: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

What if my SCA balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-21118: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I apply for SCA for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-21119: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Is there a separate process for SCA during my notice period?

Ticket HD-21120: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for SCA?

Ticket HD-21121: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

How do I download a certificate of SCA availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-21122: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my SCA application?

Ticket HD-21123: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I apply for SCA if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-21124: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my SCA balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-21125: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I apply for SCA using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-21126: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

What happens to my pending SCA application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-21127: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

SCA.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my SCA application?

Ticket HD-21128: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Is there a helpline number for SCA queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-21129: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can my SCA application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-21130: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for SCA?

Ticket HD-21131: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my SCA application?

Ticket HD-21132: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Is SCA entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-21133: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Who do I contact if my SCA application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-21134: Please refer to Section 21.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 21.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code SCA.

Section 21.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 21.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for SCA from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 21.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 21.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 21.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 21.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 21.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **SCA Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to SCA accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 21.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction SCA for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to SCA computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 21.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed SCA balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which SCA availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned SCA is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of SCA records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 21.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for SCA to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which SCA entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 21.12 in connection with sanction of SCA.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of SCA, as described in Clause 21.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction SCA under Section 21.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 21.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning SCA.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent SCA balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to SCA, as illustrated in Section 21.20.

Section 21.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing SCA since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SCA/2013/100	07-Jan-2013	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2014/107	14-Apr-2014	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2015/114	15-Jun-2015	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SCA/2016/121	07-Nov-2016	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCA/2017/128	13-Nov-2017	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2018/135	23-Jan-2018	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SCA/2019/142	25-Aug-2019	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SCA/2020/149	16-Jan-2020	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2021/156	10-Nov-2021	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCA/2022/163	28-Nov-2022	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2023/170	18-Sep-2023	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2024/177	18-Nov-2024	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2025/184	08-Jun-2025	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SCA/2026/191	09-Jun-2026	Clarification on combination with other leave types

Section 21.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); Chapter on Casual Leave (CL); Chapter on Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 22 — Election Duty Leave (EDL)

Clause 22.1 — Overview and Objective. Election Duty Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘EDL’ in this Manual) is leave granted for performance of statutory election-related duties. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Election Duty Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to EDL. The objective of EDL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of election duty leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 22.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 22.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 20 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 22.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 22.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 10 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its

discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 22.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 22.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 22.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 22.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for EDL up to a maximum of 20 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.67 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for EDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish

supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	24	20	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	21	9	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	10	19	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	24	8	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	9	10	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	19	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	20	9	3 working day(s)

Clause 22.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to EDL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of EDL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of EDL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 22.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 22.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for EDL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on EDL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 22.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of EDL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 22.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

22.5.1 EDL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

22.5.2 EDL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

22.5.3 An employee proceeding on EDL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

22.5.4 EDL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 22.6.

22.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for EDL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

22.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned EDL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

22.5.7 Requests for EDL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

22.5.8 EDL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 22.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

EDL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 22.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine EDL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 22.4. Combination of EDL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of EDL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 22.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q22.7.1. Can EDL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 22.6, EDL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q22.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing EDL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 22.2 for each cadre.

Q22.7.3. What happens to unavailed EDL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed EDL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q22.7.4. Can EDL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for EDL.

Q22.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction EDL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 22.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q22.7.6. Can EDL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, EDL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q22.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for EDL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 22.2 of this Chapter.

Q22.7.8. Does EDL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q22.7.9. Can an employee encash EDL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily EDL is not encashable in service.

Q22.7.10. What is the maximum EDL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 22.2; balances of approximately 21 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q22.7.11. Can EDL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of EDL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q22.7.12. Is EDL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to EDL linked to the term of the contract.

Q22.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for EDL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 22.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q22.7.14. Does EDL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q22.7.15. Can EDL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q22.7.16. What proof is required for emergency EDL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 22.2.

Q22.7.17. Can EDL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 22.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q22.7.18. Is EDL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

EDL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q22.7.19. Who maintains the official record of EDL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 22.9 of this Chapter.

Q22.7.20. Can EDL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 22.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q22.7.21. Does EDL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q22.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for EDL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 22.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q22.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for EDL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q22.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of EDL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of EDL is not separately debited to the EDL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q22.7.25. Can EDL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction EDL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q22.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of EDL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 22.15.

Q22.7.27. Can EDL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with EDL for the same day.

Q22.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for EDL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q22.7.29. Does EDL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; EDL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q22.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied EDL?

No; as clarified in Clause 22.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer EDL.

Q22.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for EDL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 22.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q22.7.32. Can I be denied EDL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 22.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of EDL on this ground.

Q22.7.33. Will my EDL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 22.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 22.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 22.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for EDL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 22.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 22.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for EDL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 22.4.

Case 22.8.3. An employee proceeding on EDL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 22.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 22.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 22.3.

Case 22.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine EDL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 22.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for EDL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 22.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 22.8.7. An employee's EDL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 22.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where EDL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 22.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 22.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought EDL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 22.11.7, that the debit to the EDL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 22.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile EDL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 22.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 22.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of EDL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 22.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 22.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for EDL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 22.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 22.5.

Case 22.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for EDL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 22.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 22.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's EDL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 22.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 22.8.15. An employee's EDL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 22.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 22.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for EDL under Clause 22.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 22.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 22.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 22.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 22.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 22.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 22.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 22.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 22.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 22.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 22.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 22.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to EDL set out in Section 22.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 22.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of EDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 22.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to EDL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for EDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 22.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 22.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of EDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for EDL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 22.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

22.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for EDL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

22.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to EDL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's EDL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

22.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of EDL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to EDL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

22.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of EDL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 22.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

22.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for EDL under Section 22.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

22.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue EDL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for EDL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

22.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of EDL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

22.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for EDL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while EDL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 22.5.8 shall apply.

22.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued EDL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

22.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for EDL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

22.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of EDL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of EDL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

22.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for EDL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

22.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for EDL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of EDL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent EDL is encashable.

22.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of EDL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

22.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 22.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction EDL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

22.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing EDL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

22.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of EDL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

22.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned EDL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

22.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of EDL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

22.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned EDL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

22.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any EDL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

22.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for EDL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

22.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for EDL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

22.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue EDL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

22.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to EDL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

22.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of EDL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing EDL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

22.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for EDL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

22.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of EDL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

22.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of EDL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

22.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise EDL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the EDL account.

22.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile EDL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

22.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail EDL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

22.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for EDL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of EDL exceeding five consecutive days.

22.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for EDL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

22.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to EDL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 22.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

22.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for EDL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 22.2 having regard to the circumstances.

22.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with EDL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and EDL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

22.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue EDL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

22.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of EDL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 22.15.

22.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for EDL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring EDL.

22.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for EDL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

22.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of EDL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for EDL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

22.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for EDL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

22.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for EDL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

22.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for EDL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

22.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to EDL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 22.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 22.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 22.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 22.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 22.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee A avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee B avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee C avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee D avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee E avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee F avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee G avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee H avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee I avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 6.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee J avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee K avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee L avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee M avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee N avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee O avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 13.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee P avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 8.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee Q avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee R avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee S avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee T avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee U avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee V avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 20 days = 16.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee W avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 10 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee X avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 22.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 22.3, the pro-rata entitlement to EDL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 22.3. Where Employee Y avails of EDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 22.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — EDL

Ref: RSB/HRD/EDL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Election Duty Leave (EDL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 22.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Election Duty Leave for

[Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 22.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

22.15.1 Sanctioning of EDL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

22.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for EDL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

22.15.3 EDL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 22.4.

22.15.4 Carry-forward of EDL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 22.2 without a recorded justification.

22.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for EDL.

22.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for EDL.

22.15.7 EDL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 22.6.

22.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's EDL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

22.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where EDL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

22.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for EDL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

22.15.11 Sanction of EDL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 22.12.

22.15.12 Physical-format applications for EDL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 22.12.

22.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to EDL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 22.11.

22.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of EDL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 22.12.

22.15.15 Leave Account for EDL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 22.12.

22.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of EDL, contrary to Clause 22.12.

22.15.17 EDL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 22.12.

22.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for EDL, contrary to Clause 22.12.

22.15.19 Sanction order for EDL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 22.12.

22.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 22.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 22.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to EDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to EDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 10-day annual entitlement to EDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to EDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to EDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to EDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for EDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 22.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the EDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 20-day annual entitlement to EDL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 22.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 22.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for EDL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 22.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 22.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 22.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for EDL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 22.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my EDL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 22.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 22.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 10 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of EDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 20 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 22.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 17 and 20 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 6 and 10 days against the prescribed entitlement of 10 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 16 and 20 days against the prescribed entitlement of 20 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for EDL to which they are entitled under Section 22.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 22.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current EDL balance?

Ticket HD-22101: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

My EDL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-22102: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

I made an error in my EDL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-22103: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Will my EDL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-22104: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my EDL application?

Ticket HD-22105: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Why was my EDL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-22106: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-22107: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I apply for EDL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-22108: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

My EDL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-22109: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for EDL?

Ticket HD-22110: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

EDL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned EDL after it has started?

Ticket HD-22111: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

How far in advance can I apply for EDL?

Ticket HD-22112: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-22113: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I see my EDL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-22114: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Who approves EDL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-22115: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Does EDL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-22116: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I split a single EDL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-22117: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

What if my EDL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-22118: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I apply for EDL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-22119: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Is there a separate process for EDL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-22120: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for EDL?

Ticket HD-22121: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

How do I download a certificate of EDL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-22122: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my EDL application?

Ticket HD-22123: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I apply for EDL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-22124: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my EDL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-22125: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I apply for EDL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-22126: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

What happens to my pending EDL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-22127: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

EDL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my EDL application?

Ticket HD-22128: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Is there a helpline number for EDL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-22129: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can my EDL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-22130: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for EDL?

Ticket HD-22131: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my EDL application?

Ticket HD-22132: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Is EDL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-22133: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Who do I contact if my EDL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-22134: Please refer to Section 22.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 22.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code EDL.

Section 22.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 22.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for EDL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 22.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 22.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 22.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 22.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 22.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **EDL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to EDL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 22.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction EDL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to EDL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 22.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed EDL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which EDL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned EDL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of EDL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 22.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for EDL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which EDL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 22.12 in connection with sanction of EDL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of EDL, as described in Clause 22.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction EDL under Section 22.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 22.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning EDL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent EDL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to EDL, as illustrated in Section 22.20.

Section 22.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing EDL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/EDL/2013/100	22-Sep-2013	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/EDL/2014/107	13-Sep-2014	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EDL/2015/114	27-Jun-2015	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EDL/2016/121	20-Aug-2016	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EDL/2017/128	13-Aug-2017	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/EDL/2018/135	22-Jan-2018	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EDL/2019/142	21-Jun-2019	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/EDL/2020/149	28-Jun-2020	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EDL/2021/156	02-Apr-2021	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EDL/2022/163	11-Mar-2022	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/EDL/2023/170	11-Apr-2023	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/EDL/2024/177	13-Apr-2024	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EDL/2025/184	27-Jun-2025	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EDL/2026/191	27-Jan-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 22.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); Chapter on Casual Leave (CL); Chapter on Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees (PPT); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 23 — Blood Donation Leave (BDL)

Clause 23.1 — Overview and Objective. Blood Donation Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘BDL’ in this Manual) is a single day's special leave granted on the day of voluntary blood donation. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Blood Donation Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to BDL. The objective of BDL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of blood donation leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 23.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 23.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 19 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 23.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 19 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 24 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 23.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 23.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 18 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 15 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 23.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 9 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 23.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 9 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 14 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 23.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for BDL up to a maximum of 14 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.17 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for BDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	19	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	19	24	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	24	10	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	15	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	7	9	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	9	14	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	14	11	3 working day(s)

Clause 23.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to BDL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of BDL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of BDL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 23.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 23.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for BDL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on BDL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 23.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of BDL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 23.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

23.5.1 BDL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

23.5.2 BDL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

23.5.3 An employee proceeding on BDL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

23.5.4 BDL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 23.6.

23.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for BDL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

23.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned BDL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

23.5.7 Requests for BDL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

23.5.8 BDL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 23.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

BDL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 23.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine BDL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 23.4. Combination of BDL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of BDL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 23.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q23.7.1. Can BDL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 23.6, BDL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q23.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing BDL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 23.2 for each cadre.

Q23.7.3. What happens to unavailed BDL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed BDL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q23.7.4. Can BDL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for BDL.

Q23.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction BDL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 23.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q23.7.6. Can BDL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, BDL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q23.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for BDL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 23.2 of this Chapter.

Q23.7.8. Does BDL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q23.7.9. Can an employee encash BDL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily BDL is not encashable in service.

Q23.7.10. What is the maximum BDL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 23.2; balances of approximately 19 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q23.7.11. Can BDL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of BDL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q23.7.12. Is BDL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to BDL linked to the term of the contract.

Q23.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for BDL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 23.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q23.7.14. Does BDL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q23.7.15. Can BDL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q23.7.16. What proof is required for emergency BDL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 23.2.

Q23.7.17. Can BDL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 23.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q23.7.18. Is BDL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

BDL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q23.7.19. Who maintains the official record of BDL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 23.9 of this Chapter.

Q23.7.20. Can BDL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 23.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q23.7.21. Does BDL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q23.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for BDL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 23.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q23.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for BDL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q23.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of BDL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of BDL is not separately debited to the BDL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q23.7.25. Can BDL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction BDL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q23.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of BDL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 23.15.

Q23.7.27. Can BDL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with BDL for the same day.

Q23.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for BDL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q23.7.29. Does BDL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; BDL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q23.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied BDL?

No; as clarified in Clause 23.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer BDL.

Q23.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for BDL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 23.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q23.7.32. Can I be denied BDL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 23.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of BDL on this ground.

Q23.7.33. Will my BDL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 23.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 23.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 23.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for BDL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 23.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 23.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for BDL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 23.4.

Case 23.8.3. An employee proceeding on BDL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 23.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 23.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 23.3.

Case 23.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine BDL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 23.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for BDL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 23.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 23.8.7. An employee's BDL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 23.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where BDL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 23.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 23.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought BDL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 23.11.7, that the debit to the BDL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 23.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile BDL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 23.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 23.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of BDL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 23.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 23.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for BDL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 23.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 23.5.

Case 23.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for BDL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 23.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 23.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's BDL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 23.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 23.8.15. An employee's BDL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 23.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 23.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for BDL under Clause 23.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 23.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 23.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 23.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 23.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 23.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 23.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 23.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 23.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 23.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 23.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 23.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to BDL set out in Section 23.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 23.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of BDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 23.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to BDL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for BDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 23.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 23.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of BDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for BDL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 23.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

23.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for BDL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

23.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to BDL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's BDL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

23.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of BDL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to BDL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

23.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of BDL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 23.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

23.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for BDL under Section 23.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

23.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue BDL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for BDL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

23.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of BDL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

23.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for BDL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while BDL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 23.5.8 shall apply.

23.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued BDL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

23.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for BDL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

23.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of BDL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of BDL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

23.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for BDL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

23.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for BDL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of BDL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent BDL is encashable.

23.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of BDL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

23.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 23.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction BDL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

23.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing BDL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

23.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of BDL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

23.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned BDL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

23.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of BDL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

23.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned BDL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

23.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any BDL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

23.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for BDL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

23.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for BDL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

23.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue BDL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

23.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to BDL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

23.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of BDL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing BDL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

23.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for BDL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

23.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of BDL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

23.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of BDL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

23.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise BDL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the BDL account.

23.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile BDL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

23.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail BDL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

23.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for BDL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of BDL exceeding five consecutive days.

23.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for BDL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

23.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to BDL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 23.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

23.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for BDL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 23.2 having regard to the circumstances.

23.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with BDL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and BDL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

23.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue BDL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

23.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of BDL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 23.15.

23.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for BDL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring BDL.

23.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for BDL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

23.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of BDL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for BDL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

23.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for BDL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

23.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for BDL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

23.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for BDL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

23.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to BDL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 23.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 23.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 23.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 23.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 23.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee A avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee B avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee C avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee D avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 15.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee E avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee F avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee G avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 15.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee H avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 7.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee I avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee J avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee K avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 9.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee L avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee M avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee N avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 9.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee O avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 9.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee P avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee Q avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 4.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee R avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 19 days = 12.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee S avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee T avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee U avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 18 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee V avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 14 days = 11.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee W avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee X avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 23.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 23.3, the pro-rata entitlement to BDL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 9 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 23.3. Where Employee Y avails of BDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 23.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — BDL

Ref: RSB/HRD/BDL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Blood Donation Leave (BDL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 23.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Blood Donation Leave

for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 23.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

23.15.1 Sanctioning of BDL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

23.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for BDL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

23.15.3 BDL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 23.4.

23.15.4 Carry-forward of BDL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 23.2 without a recorded justification.

23.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for BDL.

23.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for BDL.

23.15.7 BDL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 23.6.

23.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's BDL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

23.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where BDL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

23.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for BDL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

23.15.11 Sanction of BDL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 23.12.

23.15.12 Physical-format applications for BDL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 23.12.

23.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to BDL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 23.11.

23.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of BDL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 23.12.

23.15.15 Leave Account for BDL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 23.12.

23.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of BDL, contrary to Clause 23.12.

23.15.17 BDL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 23.12.

23.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for BDL, contrary to Clause 23.12.

23.15.19 Sanction order for BDL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 23.12.

23.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 23.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 23.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to BDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 19-day annual entitlement to BDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to BDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 18-day annual entitlement to BDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to BDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 9-day annual entitlement to BDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for BDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 23.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the BDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 14-day annual entitlement to BDL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 23.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 23.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for BDL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 23.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 23.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 23.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for BDL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 23.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my BDL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 23.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 23.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 19 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 18 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 9 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of BDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 14 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 23.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 16 and 19 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 15 and 19 days against the prescribed entitlement of 19 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 21 and 24 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 14 and 18 days against the prescribed entitlement of 18 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 12 and 15 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 6 and 9 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 5 and 9 days against the prescribed entitlement of 9 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 11 and 14 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 10 and 14 days against the prescribed entitlement of 14 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for BDL to which they are entitled under Section 23.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 23.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current BDL balance?

Ticket HD-23101: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

My BDL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-23102: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

I made an error in my BDL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-23103: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Will my BDL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-23104: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my BDL application?

Ticket HD-23105: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Why was my BDL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-23106: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-23107: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I apply for BDL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-23108: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

My BDL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-23109: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for BDL?

Ticket HD-23110: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

BDL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned BDL after it has started?

Ticket HD-23111: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

How far in advance can I apply for BDL?

Ticket HD-23112: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-23113: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I see my BDL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-23114: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Who approves BDL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-23115: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Does BDL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-23116: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I split a single BDL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-23117: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

What if my BDL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-23118: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I apply for BDL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-23119: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Is there a separate process for BDL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-23120: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for BDL?

Ticket HD-23121: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

How do I download a certificate of BDL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-23122: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my BDL application?

Ticket HD-23123: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I apply for BDL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-23124: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my BDL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-23125: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I apply for BDL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-23126: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

What happens to my pending BDL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-23127: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

BDL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my BDL application?

Ticket HD-23128: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Is there a helpline number for BDL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-23129: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can my BDL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-23130: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for BDL?

Ticket HD-23131: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my BDL application?

Ticket HD-23132: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Is BDL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-23133: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Who do I contact if my BDL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-23134: Please refer to Section 23.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 23.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code BDL.

Section 23.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 23.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for BDL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 23.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 23.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 23.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 23.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 23.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **BDL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to BDL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 23.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction BDL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to BDL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 23.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed BDL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which BDL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned BDL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of BDL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 23.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for BDL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which BDL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 23.12 in connection with sanction of BDL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of BDL, as described in Clause 23.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction BDL under Section 23.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 23.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning BDL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent BDL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to BDL, as illustrated in Section 23.20.

Section 23.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing BDL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/BDL/2013/100	02-Apr-2013	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BDL/2014/107	21-Jan-2014	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BDL/2015/114	21-Jan-2015	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BDL/2016/121	01-Mar-2016	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BDL/2017/128	27-Jan-2017	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BDL/2018/135	05-Mar-2018	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BDL/2019/142	16-Sep-2019	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BDL/2020/149	19-Mar-2020	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/BDL/2021/156	23-Apr-2021	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/BDL/2022/163	12-Mar-2022	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BDL/2023/170	20-Sep-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BDL/2024/177	04-Nov-2024	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/BDL/2025/184	06-Apr-2025	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BDL/2026/191	19-Jan-2026	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres

Section 23.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); Chapter on Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA); Chapter on Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave (HPL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 24 — Leave for Training & Deputation (TDL)

Clause 24.1 — Overview and Objective. Leave for Training & Deputation (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘TDL’ in this Manual) is leave and duty arrangements applicable to employees nominated for training programmes or deputed to other institutions. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Leave for Training & Deputation across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to TDL. The objective of TDL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of leave for training & deputation without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 24.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 24.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 24.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 24.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 24.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 24.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 24.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 24.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for TDL up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 16 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for TDL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	7	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	22	17	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	11	6	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	8	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	17	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	12	7	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	16	3 working day(s)

Clause 24.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to TDL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of TDL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of TDL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 24.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 24.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for TDL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on TDL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 24.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of TDL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 24.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

24.5.1 TDL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

24.5.2 TDL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

24.5.3 An employee proceeding on TDL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

24.5.4 TDL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 24.6.

24.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for TDL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

24.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned TDL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

24.5.7 Requests for TDL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

24.5.8 TDL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 24.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

TDL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 24.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine TDL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 24.4. Combination of TDL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of TDL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 24.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q24.7.1. Can TDL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 24.6, TDL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q24.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing TDL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 24.2 for each cadre.

Q24.7.3. What happens to unavailed TDL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed TDL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q24.7.4. Can TDL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for TDL.

Q24.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction TDL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 24.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q24.7.6. Can TDL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, TDL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q24.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for TDL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 24.2 of this Chapter.

Q24.7.8. Does TDL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q24.7.9. Can an employee encash TDL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily TDL is not encashable in service.

Q24.7.10. What is the maximum TDL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 24.2; balances of approximately 22 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q24.7.11. Can TDL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of TDL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q24.7.12. Is TDL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to TDL linked to the term of the contract.

Q24.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for TDL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 24.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q24.7.14. Does TDL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q24.7.15. Can TDL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q24.7.16. What proof is required for emergency TDL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 24.2.

Q24.7.17. Can TDL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 24.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q24.7.18. Is TDL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

TDL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q24.7.19. Who maintains the official record of TDL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 24.9 of this Chapter.

Q24.7.20. Can TDL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 24.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q24.7.21. Does TDL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q24.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for TDL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 24.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q24.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for TDL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q24.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of TDL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of TDL is not separately debited to the TDL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q24.7.25. Can TDL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction TDL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q24.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of TDL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 24.15.

Q24.7.27. Can TDL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with TDL for the same day.

Q24.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for TDL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q24.7.29. Does TDL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; TDL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q24.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied TDL?

No; as clarified in Clause 24.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer TDL.

Q24.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for TDL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 24.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q24.7.32. Can I be denied TDL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 24.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of TDL on this ground.

Q24.7.33. Will my TDL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 24.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 24.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 24.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for TDL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 24.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 24.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for TDL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 24.4.

Case 24.8.3. An employee proceeding on TDL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 24.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 24.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 24.3.

Case 24.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine TDL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 24.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for TDL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 24.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 24.8.7. An employee's TDL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 24.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where TDL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 24.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 24.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought TDL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 24.11.7, that the debit to the TDL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 24.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile TDL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 24.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 24.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of TDL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 24.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 24.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for TDL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 24.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 24.5.

Case 24.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for TDL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 24.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 24.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's TDL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 24.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 24.8.15. An employee's TDL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 24.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 24.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for TDL under Clause 24.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 24.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 24.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 24.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 24.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 24.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 24.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 24.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 24.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 24.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 24.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 24.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to TDL set out in Section 24.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 24.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of TDL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 24.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to TDL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for TDL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 24.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 24.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of TDL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for TDL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 24.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

24.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for TDL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

24.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to TDL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's TDL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

24.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of TDL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to TDL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

24.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of TDL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 24.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

24.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for TDL under Section 24.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

24.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue TDL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for TDL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

24.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of TDL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

24.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for TDL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while TDL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 24.5.8 shall apply.

24.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued TDL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

24.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for TDL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

24.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of TDL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of TDL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

24.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for TDL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

24.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for TDL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of TDL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent TDL is encashable.

24.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of TDL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

24.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 24.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction TDL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

24.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing TDL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

24.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of TDL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

24.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned TDL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

24.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of TDL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

24.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned TDL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

24.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any TDL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

24.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for TDL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

24.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for TDL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

24.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue TDL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

24.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to TDL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

24.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of TDL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing TDL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

24.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for TDL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

24.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of TDL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

24.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of TDL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

24.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise TDL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the TDL account.

24.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile TDL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

24.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail TDL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

24.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for TDL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of TDL exceeding five consecutive days.

24.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for TDL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

24.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to TDL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 24.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

24.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for TDL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 24.2 having regard to the circumstances.

24.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with TDL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and TDL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

24.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue TDL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

24.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of TDL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 24.15.

24.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for TDL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring TDL.

24.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for TDL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

24.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of TDL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for TDL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

24.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for TDL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

24.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for TDL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

24.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for TDL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

24.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to TDL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 24.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 24.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 24.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 24.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 24.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee A avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee B avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee C avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee D avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee E avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee F avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee G avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee H avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee I avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee J avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee K avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee L avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee M avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee N avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee O avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee P avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee Q avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee R avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee S avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee T avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee U avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee V avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee W avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee X avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 24.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 24.3, the pro-rata entitlement to TDL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 24.3. Where Employee Y avails of TDL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 24.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — TDL

Ref: RSB/HRD/TDL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Leave for Training & Deputation (TDL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 24.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Leave for Training &

Deputation for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 24.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

24.15.1 Sanctioning of TDL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

24.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for TDL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

24.15.3 TDL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 24.4.

24.15.4 Carry-forward of TDL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 24.2 without a recorded justification.

24.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for TDL.

24.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for TDL.

24.15.7 TDL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 24.6.

24.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's TDL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

24.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where TDL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

24.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for TDL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

24.15.11 Sanction of TDL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 24.12.

24.15.12 Physical-format applications for TDL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 24.12.

24.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to TDL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 24.11.

24.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of TDL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 24.12.

24.15.15 Leave Account for TDL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 24.12.

24.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of TDL, contrary to Clause 24.12.

24.15.17 TDL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 24.12.

24.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for TDL, contrary to Clause 24.12.

24.15.19 Sanction order for TDL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 24.12.

24.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 24.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 24.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to TDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to TDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to TDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to TDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to TDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to TDL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for TDL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 24.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the TDL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to TDL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 24.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 24.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for TDL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 24.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 24.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 24.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for TDL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 24.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my TDL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 24.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 24.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of TDL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 24.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 13 and 16 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for TDL to which they are entitled under Section 24.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 24.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current TDL balance?

Ticket HD-24101: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

My TDL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-24102: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

I made an error in my TDL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-24103: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Will my TDL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-24104: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my TDL application?

Ticket HD-24105: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Why was my TDL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-24106: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-24107: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I apply for TDL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-24108: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

My TDL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-24109: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for TDL?

Ticket HD-24110: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

TDL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned TDL after it has started?

Ticket HD-24111: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

How far in advance can I apply for TDL?

Ticket HD-24112: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-24113: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I see my TDL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-24114: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Who approves TDL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-24115: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Does TDL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-24116: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I split a single TDL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-24117: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

What if my TDL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-24118: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I apply for TDL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-24119: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Is there a separate process for TDL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-24120: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for TDL?

Ticket HD-24121: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

How do I download a certificate of TDL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-24122: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my TDL application?

Ticket HD-24123: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I apply for TDL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-24124: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my TDL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-24125: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I apply for TDL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-24126: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

What happens to my pending TDL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-24127: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

TDL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my TDL application?

Ticket HD-24128: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Is there a helpline number for TDL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-24129: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can my TDL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-24130: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for TDL?

Ticket HD-24131: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my TDL application?

Ticket HD-24132: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Is TDL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-24133: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Who do I contact if my TDL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-24134: Please refer to Section 24.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 24.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code TDL.

Section 24.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 24.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for TDL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 24.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 24.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 24.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 24.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 24.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **TDL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to TDL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 24.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction TDL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to TDL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 24.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed TDL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which TDL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned TDL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of TDL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 24.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for TDL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which TDL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 24.12 in connection with sanction of TDL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of TDL, as described in Clause 24.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction TDL under Section 24.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 24.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning TDL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent TDL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to TDL, as illustrated in Section 24.20.

Section 24.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing TDL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/TDL/2013/100	13-Sep-2013	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/TDL/2014/107	03-Aug-2014	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/TDL/2015/114	27-Sep-2015	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/TDL/2016/121	04-Sep-2016	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/TDL/2017/128	10-Nov-2017	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/TDL/2018/135	20-Nov-2018	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/TDL/2019/142	26-Aug-2019	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/TDL/2020/149	02-Apr-2020	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/TDL/2021/156	14-Sep-2021	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/TDL/2022/163	03-Aug-2022	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/TDL/2023/170	11-Jan-2023	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/TDL/2024/177	14-Nov-2024	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/TDL/2025/184	04-Jun-2025	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/TDL/2026/191	21-Nov-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 24.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Marriage Leave (MGL); Chapter on Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (LTC); Chapter on Paternity Leave (PTL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 25 — Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave (HPL)

Clause 25.1 — Overview and Objective. Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘HPL’ in this Manual) is leave granted on medical grounds at half the ordinary rate of pay, which may be commuted to full pay leave subject to conditions. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to HPL. The objective of HPL is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of half pay leave / commuted leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 25.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 25.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 25.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 7 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.58 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 13 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 25.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 18 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be

regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 25.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 6 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.5 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 25.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 15 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.25 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 17 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 25.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 14 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 25.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for HPL up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 8 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for HPL by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of

resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	22	7	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	13	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	12	18	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	6	7	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	15	17	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	17	14	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	22	8	3 working day(s)

Clause 25.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to HPL for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of HPL for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of HPL of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 25.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 25.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for HPL shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on HPL without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 25.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of HPL, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 25.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

25.5.1 HPL shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

25.5.2 HPL availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

25.5.3 An employee proceeding on HPL while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

25.5.4 HPL may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 25.6.

25.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for HPL, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

25.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned HPL, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

25.5.7 Requests for HPL during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

25.5.8 HPL sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 25.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

HPL may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 25.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine HPL with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 25.4. Combination of HPL with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of HPL, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 25.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q25.7.1. Can HPL be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 25.6, HPL may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q25.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing HPL?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 25.2 for each cadre.

Q25.7.3. What happens to unavailed HPL at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed HPL balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q25.7.4. Can HPL be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for HPL.

Q25.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction HPL for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 25.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q25.7.6. Can HPL be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, HPL may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q25.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for HPL?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 25.2 of this Chapter.

Q25.7.8. Does HPL accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q25.7.9. Can an employee encash HPL while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily HPL is not encashable in service.

Q25.7.10. What is the maximum HPL balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 25.2; balances of approximately 7 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q25.7.11. Can HPL be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of HPL is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q25.7.12. Is HPL available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to HPL linked to the term of the contract.

Q25.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for HPL?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 25.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q25.7.14. Does HPL lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q25.7.15. Can HPL be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q25.7.16. What proof is required for emergency HPL availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 25.2.

Q25.7.17. Can HPL entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 25.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q25.7.18. Is HPL counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

HPL availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q25.7.19. Who maintains the official record of HPL for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 25.9 of this Chapter.

Q25.7.20. Can HPL be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 25.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q25.7.21. Does HPL entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q25.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for HPL exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 25.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q25.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for HPL after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q25.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of HPL?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of HPL is not separately debited to the HPL account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q25.7.25. Can HPL be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction HPL to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q25.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of HPL?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 25.15.

Q25.7.27. Can HPL be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with HPL for the same day.

Q25.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for HPL within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q25.7.29. Does HPL availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; HPL availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q25.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied HPL?

No; as clarified in Clause 25.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer HPL.

Q25.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for HPL if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 25.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q25.7.32. Can I be denied HPL because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 25.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of HPL on this ground.

Q25.7.33. Will my HPL application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 25.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 25.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 25.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for HPL for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 25.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 25.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for HPL was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 25.4.

Case 25.8.3. An employee proceeding on HPL was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 25.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 25.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 25.3.

Case 25.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine HPL with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the

employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 25.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for HPL was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 25.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 25.8.7. An employee's HPL was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 25.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where HPL had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 25.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 25.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought HPL spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 25.11.7, that the debit to the HPL account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 25.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile HPL balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 25.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 25.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of HPL was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 25.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 25.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for HPL coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 25.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 25.5.

Case 25.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for HPL through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 25.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 25.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's HPL application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 25.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 25.8.15. An employee's HPL entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 25.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 25.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for HPL under Clause 25.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 25.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 25.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where

the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 25.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 25.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 25.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall

maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 25.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 25.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at currency chest branches, the first point of

escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 25.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 25.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for

physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 25.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee

performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 25.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to HPL set out in Section 25.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 25.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of HPL sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 25.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to HPL arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for HPL utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 25.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 25.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of HPL to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for HPL from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 25.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

25.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for HPL exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

25.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to HPL under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's HPL account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

25.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of HPL sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to HPL for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

25.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of HPL may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 25.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

25.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for HPL under Section 25.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

25.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue HPL against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for HPL during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

25.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of HPL within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

25.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for HPL shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while HPL stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 25.5.8 shall apply.

25.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued HPL balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

25.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for HPL, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

25.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of HPL availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of HPL

entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

25.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for HPL, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

25.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for HPL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of HPL remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent HPL is encashable.

25.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of HPL shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

25.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 25.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction HPL to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

25.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing HPL shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

25.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of HPL shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

25.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned HPL, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

25.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of HPL, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

25.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned HPL spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

25.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any HPL balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

25.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for HPL may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

25.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for HPL on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

25.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue HPL in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

25.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to HPL, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

25.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of HPL shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing HPL that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

25.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for HPL shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

25.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of HPL shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

25.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of HPL, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

25.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise HPL for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the HPL account.

25.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile HPL availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

25.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail HPL in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

25.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for HPL that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of HPL exceeding five consecutive days.

25.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for HPL, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

25.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to HPL recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 25.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

25.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for HPL to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 25.2 having regard to the circumstances.

25.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with HPL coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and HPL under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise

covered.

25.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue HPL under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

25.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of HPL shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 25.15.

25.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for HPL on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring HPL.

25.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for HPL spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

25.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of HPL or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for HPL shall be liable to action under that Policy.

25.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for HPL during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

25.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for HPL on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

25.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for HPL, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

25.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to HPL not resolved through the FAQ in Section 25.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 25.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 25.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be

incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 25.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 25.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee A avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee B avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee C avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee D avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 5.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee E avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 7.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee F avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying

the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee G avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 5.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee H avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee I avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee J avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee K avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 3.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee L avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee M works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee M avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee N avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 3.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee O avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee P avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee Q avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee R avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 7 days = 4.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee S avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 15 days = 12.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee T avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised

against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee U avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 6 days = 4.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee V avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee W avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee X avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 25.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 25.3, the pro-rata entitlement to HPL for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 25.3. Where Employee Y avails of HPL in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 25.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — HPL

Ref: RSB/HRD/HPL/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave (HPL) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 25.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Half Pay Leave /

Commuted Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 25.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

25.15.1 Sanctioning of HPL recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

25.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for HPL exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

25.15.3 HPL sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 25.4.

25.15.4 Carry-forward of HPL balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 25.2 without a recorded justification.

25.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for HPL.

25.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for HPL.

25.15.7 HPL combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 25.6.

25.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's HPL account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

25.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where HPL was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

25.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for HPL beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

25.15.11 Sanction of HPL recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 25.12.

25.15.12 Physical-format applications for HPL, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 25.12.

25.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to HPL inconsistent with the provisions of Section 25.11.

25.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of HPL within entitlement, contrary to Clause 25.12.

25.15.15 Leave Account for HPL not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 25.12.

25.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of HPL, contrary to Clause 25.12.

25.15.17 HPL entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 25.12.

25.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for HPL, contrary to Clause 25.12.

25.15.19 Sanction order for HPL issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 25.12.

25.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 25.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 25.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to HPL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 7-day annual entitlement to HPL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to HPL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's

recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 6-day annual entitlement to HPL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 15-day annual entitlement to HPL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to HPL that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for HPL are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 25.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the HPL is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to HPL that

varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 25.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 25.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for HPL dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 25.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 25.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 25.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for HPL is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 25.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my HPL balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 25.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 25.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 7 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 6 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 15 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process

described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of HPL utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 25.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 3 and 7 days against the prescribed entitlement of 7 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 10 and 13 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 15 and 18 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 2 and 6 days against the prescribed entitlement of 6 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 11 and 15 days against the prescribed entitlement of 15 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 14 and 17 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 11 and 14 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 5 and 8 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for HPL to which they are entitled under Section 25.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 25.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current HPL balance?

Ticket HD-25101: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

My HPL application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-25102: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

I made an error in my HPL application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-25103: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Will my HPL be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-25104: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I attach a document after submitting my HPL application?

Ticket HD-25105: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Why was my HPL auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-25106: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-25107: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I apply for HPL on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-25108: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

My HPL balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-25109: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Is there a mobile app to apply for HPL?

Ticket HD-25110: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

HPL.

Can I cancel a sanctioned HPL after it has started?

Ticket HD-25111: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

How far in advance can I apply for HPL?

Ticket HD-25112: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-25113: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I see my HPL history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-25114: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Who approves HPL if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-25115: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Does HPL availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-25116: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I split a single HPL application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-25117: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

What if my HPL balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-25118: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I apply for HPL for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-25119: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Is there a separate process for HPL during my notice period?

Ticket HD-25120: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for HPL?

Ticket HD-25121: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

How do I download a certificate of HPL availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-25122: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my HPL application?

Ticket HD-25123: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I apply for HPL if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-25124: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my HPL balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-25125: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I apply for HPL using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-25126: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

What happens to my pending HPL application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-25127: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

HPL.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my HPL application?

Ticket HD-25128: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Is there a helpline number for HPL queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-25129: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can my HPL application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-25130: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for HPL?

Ticket HD-25131: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my HPL application?

Ticket HD-25132: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Is HPL entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-25133: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Who do I contact if my HPL application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-25134: Please refer to Section 25.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 25.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code HPL.

Section 25.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 25.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for HPL from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 25.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 25.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 25.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 25.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 25.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **HPL Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to HPL accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 25.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction HPL for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to HPL computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 25.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed HPL balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which HPL availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned HPL is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of HPL records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 25.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for HPL to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which HPL entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 25.12 in connection with sanction of HPL.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of HPL, as described in Clause 25.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction HPL under Section 25.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 25.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning HPL.
- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent HPL balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to HPL, as illustrated in Section 25.20.

Section 25.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing HPL since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/HPL/2013/100	06-Sep-2013	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/HPL/2014/107	21-Apr-2014	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/HPL/2015/114	26-Aug-2015	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/HPL/2016/121	16-Jun-2016	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/HPL/2017/128	27-Sep-2017	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/HPL/2018/135	09-Apr-2018	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/HPL/2019/142	08-Nov-2019	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/HPL/2020/149	09-Jun-2020	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/HPL/2021/156	25-Jun-2021	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/HPL/2022/163	20-Sep-2022	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/HPL/2023/170	11-Jan-2023	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/HPL/2024/177	28-Apr-2024	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/HPL/2025/184	16-Mar-2025	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/HPL/2026/191	26-Apr-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 25.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Compensatory Off (CO); Chapter on Sabbatical Leave (SBL); Chapter on Election Duty Leave (EDL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 26 — Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (LTC)

Clause 26.1 — Overview and Objective. Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘LTC’ in this Manual) is leave availed by an employee in conjunction with the Leave Travel Concession facility. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to LTC. The objective of LTC is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of leave travel concession linked leave without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 26.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 26.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 23 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 26.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 7 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 26.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the

Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 26.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 24 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 2.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 6 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 26.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 26.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 23 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 5 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 26.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for LTC up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 22 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for LTC by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in

cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	23	10	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	13	7	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	22	21	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	24	6	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	13	11	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	23	5	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	12	22	3 working day(s)

Clause 26.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to LTC for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of LTC for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of LTC of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 26.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 26.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for LTC shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on LTC without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 26.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of LTC, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 26.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

26.5.1 LTC shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

26.5.2 LTC availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

26.5.3 An employee proceeding on LTC while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

26.5.4 LTC may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 26.6.

26.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for LTC, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

26.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned LTC, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

26.5.7 Requests for LTC during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

26.5.8 LTC sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 26.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

LTC may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 26.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine LTC with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 26.4. Combination of LTC with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of LTC, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 26.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q26.7.1. Can LTC be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 26.6, LTC may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q26.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing LTC?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 26.2 for each cadre.

Q26.7.3. What happens to unavailed LTC at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed LTC balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q26.7.4. Can LTC be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for LTC.

Q26.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction LTC for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 26.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q26.7.6. Can LTC be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, LTC may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q26.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for LTC?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 26.2 of this Chapter.

Q26.7.8. Does LTC accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q26.7.9. Can an employee encash LTC while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily LTC is not encashable in service.

Q26.7.10. What is the maximum LTC balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 26.2; balances of approximately 13 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q26.7.11. Can LTC be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of LTC is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q26.7.12. Is LTC available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to LTC linked to the term of the contract.

Q26.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for LTC?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 26.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q26.7.14. Does LTC lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q26.7.15. Can LTC be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q26.7.16. What proof is required for emergency LTC availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 26.2.

Q26.7.17. Can LTC entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 26.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q26.7.18. Is LTC counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

LTC availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q26.7.19. Who maintains the official record of LTC for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 26.9 of this Chapter.

Q26.7.20. Can LTC be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 26.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q26.7.21. Does LTC entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q26.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for LTC exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 26.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q26.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for LTC after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q26.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of LTC?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of LTC is not separately debited to the LTC account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q26.7.25. Can LTC be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction LTC to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q26.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of LTC?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 26.15.

Q26.7.27. Can LTC be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with LTC for the same day.

Q26.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for LTC within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q26.7.29. Does LTC availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; LTC availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q26.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied LTC?

No; as clarified in Clause 26.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer LTC.

Q26.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for LTC if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 26.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q26.7.32. Can I be denied LTC because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 26.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of LTC on this ground.

Q26.7.33. Will my LTC application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 26.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 26.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 26.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for LTC for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 26.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 26.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for LTC was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 26.4.

Case 26.8.3. An employee proceeding on LTC was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 26.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 26.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 26.3.

Case 26.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine LTC with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 26.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for LTC was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 26.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 26.8.7. An employee's LTC was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 26.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where LTC had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 26.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 26.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought LTC spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 26.11.7, that the debit to the LTC account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 26.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile LTC balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 26.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 26.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of LTC was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 26.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 26.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for LTC coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 26.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 26.5.

Case 26.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for LTC through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 26.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 26.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's LTC application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 26.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 26.8.15. An employee's LTC entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 26.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 26.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for LTC under Clause 26.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 26.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 26.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LTC

set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 26.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of

reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 26.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 26.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 26.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 26.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 26.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 26.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save

that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 26.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager

responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 26.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to LTC set out in Section 26.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 26.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of LTC sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 26.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to LTC arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for LTC utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 26.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 26.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of LTC to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for LTC from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 26.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

26.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for LTC exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

26.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to LTC under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent

of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's LTC account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

26.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of LTC sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to LTC for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

26.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of LTC may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 26.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

26.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for LTC under Section 26.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

26.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue LTC against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for LTC during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

26.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of LTC within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

26.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for LTC shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while LTC stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 26.5.8 shall apply.

26.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued LTC balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

26.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for LTC, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

26.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of LTC availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of LTC entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

26.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for LTC, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

26.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for LTC on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of LTC remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent LTC is encashable.

26.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of LTC shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

26.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 26.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction LTC to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

26.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing LTC shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

26.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of LTC shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

26.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned LTC, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

26.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of LTC, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly

Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

26.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned LTC spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

26.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any LTC balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

26.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for LTC may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

26.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for LTC on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

26.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue LTC in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

26.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to LTC, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

26.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of LTC shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing LTC that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

26.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for LTC shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

26.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of LTC shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

26.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of LTC, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

26.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise LTC for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the LTC account.

26.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile LTC availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

26.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail LTC in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

26.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for LTC that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of LTC exceeding five consecutive days.

26.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for LTC, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

26.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to LTC recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 26.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

26.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for LTC to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 26.2 having regard to the circumstances.

26.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with LTC coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and LTC under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

26.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue LTC under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

26.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of LTC shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 26.15.

26.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for LTC on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring LTC.

26.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for LTC spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

26.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of LTC or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for LTC shall be liable to action under that Policy.

26.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for LTC during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

26.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for LTC on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

26.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for LTC, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

26.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to LTC not resolved through the FAQ in Section 26.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 26.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 26.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 26.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 26.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee A avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee B avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee C avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee D avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee E avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee F avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be

treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee G avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 20.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee H avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee I avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee J avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 19.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee K avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee L avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee M works

out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee M avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 19.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee N avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 12.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee O avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee P avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee Q avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee R avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee S avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee T avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 11.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee U avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 24 days = 16.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee V avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee W avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee X avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 26.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 26.3, the pro-rata entitlement to LTC for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 23 days = 15.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 26.3. Where Employee Y avails of LTC in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 26.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — LTC

Ref: RSB/HRD/LTC/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (LTC) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 26.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 26.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

26.15.1 Sanctioning of LTC recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

26.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for LTC exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

26.15.3 LTC sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 26.4.

26.15.4 Carry-forward of LTC balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 26.2 without a recorded justification.

26.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for LTC.

26.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for LTC.

26.15.7 LTC combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 26.6.

26.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's LTC account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

26.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where LTC was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

26.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for LTC beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

26.15.11 Sanction of LTC recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 26.12.

26.15.12 Physical-format applications for LTC, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 26.12.

26.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to LTC inconsistent with the provisions of Section 26.11.

26.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of LTC within entitlement, contrary to Clause 26.12.

26.15.15 Leave Account for LTC not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 26.12.

26.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of LTC, contrary to Clause 26.12.

26.15.17 LTC entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 26.12.

26.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for LTC, contrary to Clause 26.12.

26.15.19 Sanction order for LTC issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 26.12.

26.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 26.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 26.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 23-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall

additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 24-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 23-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for LTC are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 26.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the LTC is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to LTC that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 26.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 26.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for LTC dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 26.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 26.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 26.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for LTC is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 26.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my LTC balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 26.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 26.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 23 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to

the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 24 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 23 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of LTC utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 26.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 19 and 23 days against the prescribed entitlement of 23 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 4 and 7 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment

trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 20 and 24 days against the prescribed entitlement of 24 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 3 and 6 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 19 and 23 days against the prescribed entitlement of 23 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 2 and 5 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 19 and 22 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for LTC to which they are entitled under Section 26.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 26.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current LTC balance?

Ticket HD-26101: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

My LTC application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-26102: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

I made an error in my LTC application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-26103: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Will my LTC be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-26104: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I attach a document after submitting my LTC application?

Ticket HD-26105: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Why was my LTC auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-26106: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-26107: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I apply for LTC on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-26108: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

My LTC balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-26109: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the

Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Is there a mobile app to apply for LTC?

Ticket HD-26110: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I cancel a sanctioned LTC after it has started?

Ticket HD-26111: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

How far in advance can I apply for LTC?

Ticket HD-26112: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-26113: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I see my LTC history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-26114: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Who approves LTC if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-26115: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Does LTC availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-26116: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I split a single LTC application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-26117: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

What if my LTC balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-26118: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I apply for LTC for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-26119: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Is there a separate process for LTC during my notice period?

Ticket HD-26120: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for LTC?

Ticket HD-26121: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

How do I download a certificate of LTC availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-26122: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my LTC application?

Ticket HD-26123: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I apply for LTC if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-26124: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my LTC balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-26125: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I apply for LTC using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-26126: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

LTC.

What happens to my pending LTC application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-26127: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my LTC application?

Ticket HD-26128: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Is there a helpline number for LTC queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-26129: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can my LTC application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-26130: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for LTC?

Ticket HD-26131: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my LTC application?

Ticket HD-26132: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Is LTC entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-26133: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Who do I contact if my LTC application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-26134: Please refer to Section 26.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 26.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code LTC.

Section 26.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 26.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for LTC from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 26.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 26.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 26.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 26.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 26.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **LTC Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to LTC accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 26.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction LTC for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to LTC computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 26.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed LTC balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which LTC availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned LTC is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of LTC records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 26.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for LTC to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which LTC entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 26.12 in connection with sanction of LTC.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of LTC, as described in Clause 26.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction LTC under Section 26.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 26.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning LTC.

- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent LTC balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to LTC, as illustrated in Section 26.20.

Section 26.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing LTC since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/LTC/2013/100	09-Aug-2013	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LTC/2014/107	17-Mar-2014	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LTC/2015/114	08-Sep-2015	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LTC/2016/121	16-Aug-2016	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2017/128	08-Sep-2017	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LTC/2018/135	21-Sep-2018	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2019/142	15-Nov-2019	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2020/149	03-Apr-2020	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LTC/2021/156	13-Sep-2021	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LTC/2022/163	10-Sep-2022	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LTC/2023/170	12-Jun-2023	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LTC/2024/177	17-Apr-2024	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LTC/2025/184	24-Aug-2025	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2026/191	12-Sep-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 26.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Marriage Leave (MGL); Chapter on Sabbatical Leave (SBL); Chapter on Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 27 — Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees (PPT)

Clause 27.1 — Overview and Objective. Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees (hereinafter referred to by the short code ‘PPT’ in this Manual) is the modified leave entitlements applicable during the probation period and to part-time or contractual staff. This Chapter sets out the eligibility, accrual, sanctioning procedure, restrictions, and audit requirements applicable to Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees across all cadres of Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited (“the Bank”). The provisions of this Chapter shall be read together with the General Leave Rules contained in Chapter 2 of this Manual, and in the event of any conflict, the specific provisions of this Chapter shall prevail for matters relating to PPT. The objective of PPT is to provide a structured, equitable, and auditable mechanism by which employees of the Bank may avail of leave rules for probationers & part-time employees without disruption to branch or departmental operations, while ensuring that the Bank's obligations under applicable labour legislation, service regulations, and the bipartite/tripartite settlements in force from time to time are duly discharged.

Section 27.2 — Eligibility, Entitlement and Carry-Forward by Cadre

Clause 27.2.1 — Subordinate Staff (Class IV). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 17 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.42 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 11 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 27.2.2 — Clerical & Award Staff Cadre. An employee confirmed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 5 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Branch Manager / Departmental Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 27.2.3 — Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 11 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 0.92 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 10 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT

by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 4 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 27.2.4 — Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 13 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.08 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 16 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Regional Manager / Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 5 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 27.2.5 — Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 22 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.83 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 21 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Zonal Head, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 1 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 27.2.6 — Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 12 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.0 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 15 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the General Manager (HRD), records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily be submitted at least 2 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Clause 27.2.7 — Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade). An employee confirmed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) is eligible for PPT up to a maximum of 21 days in a calendar year, accruing at the rate of approximately 1.75 days per completed month of service, subject to the employee having rendered continuous service with the Bank. Unavailed balance may be carried forward to the succeeding calendar year up to a ceiling of 20 days; balances in excess of this ceiling shall lapse automatically unless the Competent Authority, being the Managing Director & CEO, records specific reasons in writing for permitting a further carry-forward on grounds of exigencies of Bank work. An application for PPT by an employee in this cadre shall ordinarily

be submitted at least 3 working day(s) in advance through the Bank's online HRMS leave module, save in cases of genuine emergency, where the application may be regularised within three working days of resumption of duty. The Competent Authority may, at its discretion, require the employee to furnish supporting documentation where the circumstances of the leave so warrant.

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)	Notice Period
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	11	2 working day(s)
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	22	5	3 working day(s)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	11	10	4 working day(s)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	16	5 working day(s)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	21	1 working day(s)
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	12	15	2 working day(s)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	20	3 working day(s)

Clause 27.3 — Computation and Accrual Formula. The entitlement to PPT for any employee shall be computed on a pro-rata basis for the year of joining, resignation, retirement, or death-in-service, calculated as: (Number of completed months of service in the calendar year ÷ 12) × Annual Entitlement, rounded to the nearest half-day. Where an employee is on Leave Without Pay, suspension, or unauthorised absence during any part of the year, the period so spent shall not count towards accrual of PPT for that year unless otherwise directed by the Head Office HRD Department. Fractional balances of PPT of 0.5 day or above shall be rounded up to the next full day at the time of final settlement; fractional balances below 0.5 day shall be ignored. All computations under this Clause are subject to reconciliation by the Bank's HRMS system on a quarterly basis, and any discrepancy noted by the employee must be reported to the Branch HR Coordinator within thirty days of the quarterly statement being made available.

Section 27.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure

Clause 27.4 — Application and Sanctioning Procedure. All applications for PPT shall be submitted through the Bank's HRMS Leave Module. The applicant's Reporting Officer shall record recommendations within two working days of submission, following which the application shall be routed to the Competent Authority prescribed in the table below for final sanction. No employee shall proceed on PPT without either (a) express sanction recorded in the HRMS, or (b) in cases of emergency, prior intimation to the Reporting Officer followed by regularisation within the timeline prescribed in Clause 27.2. The Competent Authority for sanction of PPT, cadre-wise, is as follows:

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Subordinate Staff (Class IV)	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre	Branch Manager / Departmental Head
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)	Regional Manager
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)	Regional Manager / Zonal Head
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)	Zonal Head
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)	General Manager (HRD)

Cadre	Competent Sanctioning Authority
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)	Managing Director & CEO

Section 27.5 — Restrictions and Special Conditions

27.5.1 PPT shall not ordinarily be granted for a continuous period exceeding the maximum prescribed under this Chapter without the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

27.5.2 PPT availed shall be debited to the employee's leave account maintained in the Bank's HRMS on the date of sanction, irrespective of the date of actual availment.

27.5.3 An employee proceeding on PPT while under a charge-sheet, suspension, or disciplinary proceeding shall require the specific concurrence of the Disciplinary Authority.

27.5.4 PPT may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly-off, Bank holiday, or other sanctioned leave, subject to the combination restrictions set out in Clause 27.6.

27.5.5 Misrepresentation of facts in an application for PPT, if established, shall render the employee liable to disciplinary action under the Bank's Service Regulations, in addition to recovery of wages paid for the period of unauthorised absence.

27.5.6 An employee who does not report for duty on the day following expiry of sanctioned PPT, without a further sanctioned extension, shall be treated as on unauthorised absence for the excess period.

27.5.7 Requests for PPT during the last week of a financial year quarter shall be subject to prior staffing clearance from the Branch Manager or Departmental Head, having regard to operational requirements.

27.5.8 PPT sanctioned shall stand automatically cancelled if the employee is transferred, relieved, or placed under suspension prior to the commencement of the sanctioned period, unless specifically revalidated by the Competent Authority.

Section 27.6 — Combination with Other Leave Types

PPT may be combined with other categories of leave prescribed under this Manual, subject to the general restrictions set out in Section 2.3 and the cadre-specific restrictions set out in Section 27.5 above. Where an employee seeks to combine PPT with Earned Leave / Privilege Leave for a continuous period exceeding thirty days, prior concurrence of the Head Office HRD Department shall be obtained in addition to sanction from the Competent Authority prescribed in Section 27.4. Combination of PPT with Leave Without Pay shall require that the entire balance of PPT, Earned Leave, and Half Pay Leave standing to the employee's credit be first exhausted, save where the Competent Authority records specific reasons for relaxing this requirement.

Section 27.7 — Frequently Asked Questions

Q27.7.1. Can PPT be combined with Earned Leave?

Yes, subject to the combination restrictions in Clause 27.6, PPT may be prefixed or suffixed to Earned Leave with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Q27.7.2. Is medical certification mandatory for availing PPT?

This depends on the duration and the cadre of the employee; certification requirements are detailed in Clause 27.2 for each cadre.

Q27.7.3. What happens to unavailed PPT at the time of an employee's retirement?

Unavailed PPT balance, where encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, shall be settled as part of the final dues; where not encashable, it shall lapse on the date of retirement.

Q27.7.4. Can PPT be availed during the probation period?

Employees on probation are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Probationers), which prescribes a modified entitlement for PPT.

Q27.7.5. Who is the Competent Authority to sanction PPT for an Officer in Scale III?

As per Clause 27.4, the Competent Authority for Officer Scale III is the Zonal Head.

Q27.7.6. Can PPT be denied by the Competent Authority?

Yes, PPT may be declined or deferred having regard to exigencies of Bank work, provided reasons are recorded in writing and communicated to the applicant through the HRMS.

Q27.7.7. Is there a minimum notice period for applying for PPT?

Yes, the notice period is cadre-specific and is set out against each cadre in Clause 27.2 of this Chapter.

Q27.7.8. Does PPT accrue during a period of deputation to another organisation?

Accrual during deputation is governed by Chapter 22 of this Manual (Leave Rules for Training & Deputation) read with this Chapter.

Q27.7.9. Can an employee encash PPT while still in service?

En-cashment while in service is permitted only where expressly provided under Chapter 16 of this Manual; ordinarily PPT is not encashable in service.

Q27.7.10. What is the maximum PPT balance that can be carried forward?

The carry-forward ceiling is prescribed cadre-wise in Clause 27.2; balances of approximately 22 days or the prescribed ceiling, whichever is lower, may ordinarily be carried forward.

Q27.7.11. Can PPT be availed on a half-day basis?

Half-day availment of PPT is permitted only where the Branch Manager or Departmental Head certifies that operational requirements permit split availment, and shall be recorded as 0.5 day in the HRMS.

Q27.7.12. Is PPT available to employees engaged on a fixed-term contract?

Fixed-term contractual employees are governed by Chapter 25 of this Manual, which prescribes a pro-rata entitlement to PPT linked to the term of the contract.

Q27.7.13. Can a Reporting Officer decline to forward an application for PPT?

The Reporting Officer may record a 'Not Recommended' remark but must forward the application to the Competent Authority within the timeline in Section 27.4; the Reporting Officer cannot unilaterally reject the application.

Q27.7.14. Does PPT lapse on transfer to a subsidiary of the Bank?

No; the balance is transferred along with the employee's service record in accordance with Section 2.6 of this Manual, subject to the receiving entity's leave rules for future accrual.

Q27.7.15. Can PPT be availed abroad?

Yes, subject to the employee furnishing contact details as required under the HRMS application fields listed in Appendix B, and subject to recall provisions in Section 2.4.

Q27.7.16. What proof is required for emergency PPT availed without prior sanction?

The employee must submit a written explanation along with any available supporting documentation at the time of regularisation, as prescribed in Clause 27.2.

Q27.7.17. Can PPT entitlement be enhanced by the Competent Authority beyond the prescribed ceiling?

No; the Competent Authority has no power to enhance the entitlement prescribed in Section 27.2. Any such enhancement requires Head Office HRD Department approval by way of a specific circular.

Q27.7.18. Is PPT counted for the purpose of computing bonus or incentive eligibility?

PPT availed within entitlement does not affect eligibility for bonus or incentive schemes, which are governed separately under the Bank's Compensation Policy.

Q27.7.19. Who maintains the official record of PPT for audit purposes?

The Branch HR Coordinator maintains the primary record in the HRMS, with the Regional Office and Head Office HRD Department maintaining consolidated records for audit under Section 27.9 of this Chapter.

Q27.7.20. Can PPT be applied for retrospectively for a period already spent on unauthorised absence?

Only in exceptional circumstances, and only with the specific approval of the next higher Competent Authority beyond that prescribed in Section 27.4, upon a written explanation from the employee.

Q27.7.21. Does PPT entitlement differ for employees working part-time?

Yes; Chapter 25 of this Manual prescribes a pro-rata entitlement for part-time employees based on the proportion of full-time hours worked.

Q27.7.22. Is a second level of approval required for PPT exceeding fifteen consecutive days?

Yes, in accordance with Section 27.5.1, availment exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit requires approval of the next higher Competent Authority.

Q27.7.23. Can an employee withdraw an application for PPT after submission but before sanction?

Yes, the employee may withdraw the application through the HRMS at any point prior to final sanction being recorded by the Competent Authority.

Q27.7.24. What is the effect of a public holiday falling within a sanctioned period of PPT?

A declared Bank holiday falling within a sanctioned period of PPT is not separately debited to the PPT account, in accordance with Section 2.3 of this Manual.

Q27.7.25. Can PPT be sanctioned by an officiating Competent Authority?

Yes, an officer officiating in the post of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank may sanction PPT to the same extent as the substantive incumbent.

Q27.7.26. Is there a cooling-off period between two spells of PPT?

No mandatory cooling-off period is prescribed under this Chapter, save that frequent short spells may attract the audit observations described in Section 27.15.

Q27.7.27. Can PPT be availed concurrently with a sanctioned Compensatory Off?

No; Compensatory Off under Chapter 11 of this Manual must be availed or shall lapse independently, and cannot be availed concurrently with PPT for the same day.

Q27.7.28. What is the escalation path if the Competent Authority does not act on an application for PPT within the prescribed timeline?

The employee may escalate through the grievance mechanism described in Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism) to the next higher Competent Authority.

Q27.7.29. Does PPT availed affect eligibility for the Bank's Employee of the Quarter recognition?

No; PPT availed within entitlement is not a disqualifying factor for any recognition scheme administered by the Bank, provided the employee otherwise meets the scheme's stated criteria.

Q27.7.30. Can an employee on a Performance Improvement Plan be denied PPT?

No; as clarified in Clause 27.12 (Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan), such status is not by itself a ground to deny or defer PPT.

Q27.7.31. Is concurrence of a Project Lead required for PPT if I am on a cross-functional project team?

Yes, in accordance with Clause 27.12 (Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams), joint concurrence is required in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer's recommendation.

Q27.7.32. Can I be denied PPT because I recently made a disclosure under the Whistleblower Policy?

No; Clause 27.12 (Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy) expressly prohibits retaliatory denial of PPT on this ground.

Q27.7.33. Will my PPT application be affected if it spans a scheduled Board Meeting or AGM?

It may be reviewed with reference to your role's criticality to that meeting, as set out in Clause 27.12; you may be asked to identify a suitable delegate before sanction.

Section 27.8 — Illustrative Case Studies

Case 27.8.1. An employee in Officer Scale II applied for PPT for eleven consecutive days on account of a family medical emergency, exceeding the ordinarily permissible continuous limit. The Zonal Head, being the next higher Competent Authority for that cadre in this instance, examined the medical documentation furnished and granted approval by way of a reasoned order under Clause 27.5.1, noting the genuineness of the emergency.

Case 27.8.2. A Clerical cadre employee's application for PPT was returned for want of supporting documentation. On resubmission with the requisite documents within the prescribed window, the Branch Manager sanctioned the leave with retrospective effect from the date of original application, in line with Clause 27.4.

Case 27.8.3. An employee proceeding on PPT was transferred to another Region prior to commencement of the sanctioned period. In accordance with Clause 27.5.8, the sanction stood automatically cancelled, and the employee was required to seek fresh sanction from the Competent Authority at the transferred location.

Case 27.8.4. A dispute arose regarding the carry-forward ceiling applicable to a Subordinate Staff employee following a mid-year promotion to the Clerical cadre. The Head Office HRD Department clarified that the higher ceiling applicable to the Clerical cadre would apply pro-rata from the date of promotion, read with Clause 27.3.

Case 27.8.5. An Officer in Scale IV sought to combine PPT with Study Leave under Chapter 9 of this Manual for the purpose of attending a certification programme. The General Manager (HRD), being the Competent Authority, sanctioned the combination subject to a bond of service being executed by the employee in accordance with the Study Leave Chapter.

Case 27.8.6. A Rural Branch employee's application for PPT was delayed beyond the prescribed timeline on account of intermittent HRMS connectivity. In accordance with Clause 27.11.4, the sanction was backdated to the date of original manual application, upon verification by the Regional Manager.

Case 27.8.7. An employee's PPT was recalled midway under Section 2.4 owing to an unforeseen branch audit. The employee's unavailed balance was restored to the Leave Account, and travel expenses for the return journey were reimbursed upon production of bills, in accordance with Section 2.4.

Case 27.8.8. An internal audit flagged an instance where PPT had been sanctioned by an officer not authorised under the delegation register maintained pursuant to Clause 27.11 (Delegation of Sanctioning Authority). The Head Office HRD Department directed retrospective ratification by the properly Competent Authority and updation of the delegation register.

Case 27.8.9. A Digital Banking Unit employee working a rotational shift sought PPT spanning a shift boundary. The Regional Manager clarified, with reference to Clause 27.11.7, that the debit to the PPT account would be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day.

Case 27.8.10. An employee absorbed into the Bank pursuant to a merger raised a query regarding conversion of their erstwhile PPT balance. The Head Office HRD Department, applying Clause 27.12 (Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities), issued a conversion table and credited the converted balance to the employee's HRMS Leave Account.

Case 27.8.11. An employee's representation against curtailment of PPT was disposed of beyond the thirty-day timeline prescribed in Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). The delay was recorded as an audit observation under Section 27.15, and the Regional Office was directed to strengthen tracking of pending representations.

Case 27.8.12. A Currency Chest Branch employee's application for PPT coinciding with a scheduled currency verification was deferred by two days under Clause 27.11.6, with reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee through the HRMS, consistent with Section 27.5.

Case 27.8.13. An employee on long-term overseas secondment applied for PPT through the Head Office HRD Department as required under Clause 27.12 (Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment). The application was sanctioned after confirmation that the host institution's local requirements did not entitle the employee to a more favourable provision than this Chapter.

Case 27.8.14. A Regional Processing Centre employee's PPT application was processed by a centralised staffing desk rather than the Branch Manager, in accordance with Clause 27.11.10, and sanction was communicated within the standard timeline notwithstanding the centralised structure.

Case 27.8.15. An employee's PPT entitlement was recomputed mid-year following promotion, in accordance with Clause 27.12 (Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees), and the revised balance was reflected in the HRMS within the prescribed seven working days.

Case 27.8.16. Following a notified natural calamity at an employee's native place, the Branch Manager relaxed the ordinary notice period for PPT under Clause 27.12 (Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place), and the application was sanctioned on an expedited same-day basis.

Section 27.11 — Regional and Branch-Category Variations

Clause 27.11.1 — Metropolitan Branches. In respect of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to PPT

set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at metropolitan branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.1 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Metropolitan Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at metropolitan branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering metropolitan branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.1 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Metropolitan Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in cities with a population exceeding one million, as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for metropolitan branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at metropolitan branches.

Clause 27.11.2 — Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.2 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering urban branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.2 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in urban centres not classified as Metropolitan under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of

reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at urban branches.

Clause 27.11.3 — Semi-Urban Branches. In respect of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at semi-urban branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.3 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Semi-Urban Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at semi-urban branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering semi-urban branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.3 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Semi-Urban Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in semi-urban centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, the Regional Manager responsible for semi-urban branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at semi-urban branches.

Clause 27.11.4 — Rural Branches. In respect of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at rural branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.4 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Rural Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at rural branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering rural branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.4 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Rural Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches situated in rural centres as classified under the Bank's Branch Categorisation Policy, including single-officer branches, the Regional Manager responsible for rural branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at rural branches.

Clause 27.11.5 — Representative and Overseas Offices. In respect of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at representative and overseas offices are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.5 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Representative and Overseas Offices. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at representative and overseas offices, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering representative and overseas offices shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.5 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Representative and Overseas Offices. Given the operating characteristics of representative offices and overseas establishments of the Bank, where local statutory requirements may additionally apply, the Regional Manager responsible for representative and overseas offices shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at representative and overseas offices.

Clause 27.11.6 — Currency Chest Branches. In respect of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at currency chest branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.6 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Currency Chest Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at currency chest branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering currency chest branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.6 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Currency Chest Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches designated as Currency Chest Branches, where custodial duties may affect the timing and combination restrictions otherwise applicable, the Regional Manager responsible for currency chest branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at currency chest branches.

Clause 27.11.7 — Digital Banking Units. In respect of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at digital banking units are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.7 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Digital Banking Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at digital banking units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering digital banking units shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.7 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Digital Banking Units. Given the operating characteristics of Digital Banking Units operating on extended or shift-based hours, where the notice period may be computed with reference to the shift roster rather than the calendar day, the Regional Manager responsible for digital banking units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at digital banking units.

Clause 27.11.8 — Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In respect of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save

that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at corporate and wholesale banking branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.8 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at corporate and wholesale banking branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering corporate and wholesale banking branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.8 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Corporate and Wholesale Banking Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches handling corporate and wholesale banking relationships, where sanctioning timelines may be compressed having regard to client-facing obligations, the Regional Manager responsible for corporate and wholesale banking branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at corporate and wholesale banking branches.

Clause 27.11.9 — Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In respect of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at agricultural and priority sector branches are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.9 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at agricultural and priority sector branches, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering agricultural and priority sector branches shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.9 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Agricultural and Priority Sector Branches. Given the operating characteristics of branches with a predominant agricultural or priority-sector portfolio, where seasonal disbursement cycles may affect the scheduling of leave, the Regional Manager

responsible for agricultural and priority sector branches shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at agricultural and priority sector branches.

Clause 27.11.10 — Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In respect of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the entitlement to PPT set out in Section 27.2 shall apply without variation, save that the sanctioning timelines prescribed in Section 27.4 may be extended by up to two additional working days where the Competent Authority is not stationed at the same location as the applicant, to allow for physical verification of documentation where the HRMS connectivity at such location is intermittent. Branch Managers at regional processing centres and back-office units are required to maintain a manual register of PPT sanctioned, in addition to the HRMS record, and to reconcile the two on a monthly basis, forwarding a certified extract to the Regional Office by the fifth working day of the succeeding month. Any variance between the manual register and the HRMS record exceeding two instances in a quarter shall be reported by the Regional Manager to the Head Office HRD Department as an audit observation.

Clause 27.11.10 (contd.) — Escalation and Local Record-Keeping at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. In the event of a dispute regarding entitlement to PPT arising at regional processing centres and back-office units, the first point of escalation shall be the Regional HR Manager, who shall dispose of the matter within ten working days before any further escalation to the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism). Regional Offices covering regional processing centres and back-office units shall include a specific line item for PPT utilisation in the quarterly HR dashboard submitted to the Zonal Head, distinguishing sanctioned, availed, and lapsed balances, so as to enable trend analysis of the kind described in Section 27.17 of this Chapter.

Clause 27.11.10 (contd.) — Staffing Contingency Planning at Regional Processing Centres and Back-Office Units. Given the operating characteristics of centralised processing centres and back-office units, where staffing rosters are managed centrally rather than at the individual branch level, the Regional Manager responsible for regional processing centres and back-office units shall maintain a standing contingency roster identifying at least one backup employee per critical function, so that sanction of PPT to an employee performing a critical function is not unreasonably withheld or delayed. Where no adequate backup is available, the Regional Manager shall record this constraint in the HRMS at the time of reviewing the application, and shall simultaneously initiate cross-training or temporary redeployment measures so that the constraint does not recur in respect of future applications for PPT from employees performing the same function at regional processing centres and back-office units.

Section 27.12 — Detailed Commentary and Ancillary Provisions

27.12.1 — Documentation Requirements

Applications for PPT exceeding three consecutive days shall ordinarily be accompanied by supporting documentation appropriate to the nature of the leave, as prescribed by the Head Office HRD Department from time to time. The Branch HR Coordinator shall retain scanned copies of such documentation in the employee's electronic personnel file for a minimum period of eight years, in line with the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

27.12.2 — Interaction with Statutory Provisions

Where the entitlement to PPT under this Chapter is less than the corresponding entitlement (if any) prescribed under applicable central or state legislation, the statutory entitlement shall prevail to the extent

of the excess, and the Bank shall grant such excess without debit to the employee's PPT account, subject to certification by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

27.12.3 — Record-Keeping and Audit

The HRMS record of PPT sanctioned, availed, and lapsed for each employee shall be subject to annual audit by the Bank's Internal Audit Department. Branches and Regional Offices shall preserve all supporting documentation relating to PPT for the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy, and shall produce the same to the Internal Audit Department upon request.

27.12.4 — Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism

An employee aggrieved by refusal or curtailment of PPT may, within fifteen days of communication of such refusal or curtailment, submit a representation to the next higher Competent Authority in the hierarchy set out in Section 27.4. The next higher Competent Authority shall dispose of such representation within thirty days, recording reasons in writing, a copy of which shall be furnished to the employee.

27.12.5 — Special Provisions for Employees with Long Service

Employees who have completed twenty-five years or more of continuous service with the Bank shall, at the discretion of the Competent Authority, be granted relaxation of up to twenty percent in the notice period otherwise prescribed for PPT under Section 27.2, having regard to their long and satisfactory service record.

27.12.6 — Provisions for Employees on Deputation

An employee on deputation to a subsidiary, associate, or Government body shall continue to accrue PPT against their substantive post in the Bank, and applications for PPT during the period of deputation shall be routed through the deputing authority for record purposes, notwithstanding sanction being accorded by the authority at the place of deputation.

27.12.7 — Impact on Performance Appraisal

Availment of PPT within the entitlement prescribed under this Chapter shall not, by itself, be treated as an adverse factor in the employee's annual performance appraisal. However, the Reporting Officer may record factual observations regarding the impact of extended or frequent absence on team deliverables, strictly in accordance with the Bank's Performance Management Guidelines.

27.12.8 — Interaction with Transfer Policy

A pending application for PPT shall not, by itself, operate as a bar to an employee's transfer under the Bank's Transfer Policy. Where an employee is transferred while PPT stands sanctioned but not yet availed, the provisions of Section 27.5.8 shall apply.

27.12.9 — Provisions During Mergers, Acquisitions or Restructuring

In the event of a merger, acquisition, or organisational restructuring affecting the Bank, employees transferred to or from the Bank's rolls shall have their accrued PPT balance carried forward in accordance with the scheme of merger or restructuring approved by the Board of Directors, subject to Reserve Bank of India guidelines where applicable.

27.12.10 — Data Privacy in Leave Records

Documentation submitted in support of an application for PPT, including any medical or personal information, shall be handled strictly in accordance with the Bank's Data Privacy Policy, and access to such documentation shall be restricted to the Branch HR Coordinator, the Competent Authority, and the Head Office HRD Department on a need-to-know basis.

27.12.11 — Interaction with Pension and Retiral Benefits

Periods of PPT availed within entitlement shall count as qualifying service for the purposes of the Bank's Pension Regulations and Provident Fund Rules. Periods of Leave Without Pay availed in excess of PPT entitlement shall not count as qualifying service unless specifically condoned by the Head Office HRD Department.

27.12.12 — Addendum for Pandemic or Public Health Emergencies

During a period notified by the Government of India or the State Government as a public health emergency, the Head Office HRD Department may, by special circular, modify the notice period, documentation requirements, or sanctioning authority otherwise prescribed under this Chapter for PPT, and any such special circular shall be read as a temporary addendum to this Chapter for its period of operation.

27.12.13 — Provisions for Employees Under Notice of Termination

An employee under notice of termination for reasons other than misconduct shall continue to be eligible for PPT on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre, save that any balance of PPT remaining unavailed on the effective date of termination shall be dealt with in accordance with Chapter 16 of this Manual (Leave Encashment), to the extent PPT is encashable.

27.12.14 — Interaction with Flexible and Remote Working Arrangements

Where an employee is permitted to work under a flexible or remote working arrangement approved by the Competent Authority, availment of PPT shall continue to require formal application and sanction through the HRMS in the same manner as for employees working from Bank premises, and no distinction in entitlement shall be made on the ground of the employee's working arrangement.

27.12.15 — Delegation of Sanctioning Authority

The Competent Authority prescribed in Section 27.4 may, by a specific written order, delegate the power to sanction PPT to an officer subordinate in rank, provided such delegation is recorded in the HRMS and is subject to periodic review by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every financial year.

27.12.16 — Treatment During Industry-Level Settlements

Where a bipartite or tripartite industry-level settlement revises the general framework of leave applicable to bank employees, the provisions of this Chapter governing PPT shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department within ninety days of such settlement coming into force, and any consequential amendment shall be issued by way of a specific circular and incorporated into this Chapter at the next revision of this Manual.

27.12.17 — Language and Communication of Sanction Orders

Sanction or refusal of PPT shall be communicated to the employee in writing through the HRMS, in English or in the regional language of the Branch, at the option of the employee, provided that the English text recorded in the HRMS shall be treated as authoritative in the event of any discrepancy in translation.

27.12.18 — Treatment of Part-Availed Leave

Where an employee resumes duty before exhausting the full period of sanctioned PPT, the unavailed portion shall be restored to the employee's Leave Account only upon the employee furnishing written intimation of early resumption to the Reporting Officer, who shall update the HRMS accordingly within one working day.

27.12.19 — Coordination with Branch Succession Planning

Branch Managers and Departmental Heads are required to factor anticipated availment of PPT, based on historical patterns and pending applications, into succession and staffing plans reviewed at the quarterly

Branch Operations Review, so as to minimise operational disruption.

27.12.20 — Treatment of Leave Spanning a Financial Year-End

Where a period of sanctioned PPT spans the close of a financial year, the days falling in each financial year shall be debited to the Leave Account maintained for that respective year, and no portion of such leave shall be treated as having accrued in advance against the succeeding year's entitlement.

27.12.21 — Provisions for Newly Acquired or Merged Entities

Employees absorbed into the Bank's rolls pursuant to acquisition of, or merger with, another banking or financial entity shall be governed by this Chapter with effect from the date of absorption, and any PPT balance standing to their credit under the erstwhile entity's rules shall be converted to the nearest equivalent under this Manual by the Head Office HRD Department.

27.12.22 — Treatment of Leave Applications During System Downtime

Where the HRMS is unavailable due to scheduled maintenance or unscheduled downtime, applications for PPT may be submitted in the physical format prescribed in Appendix B, and shall be entered into the HRMS retrospectively within two working days of the system becoming available, bearing the original date of physical submission.

27.12.23 — Restrictions Applicable to Employees on the Bank's Watch-List

Employees placed on the Bank's internal watch-list pursuant to an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry shall continue to be eligible for PPT on the same terms as other employees, save that sanction shall additionally require a no-objection recorded by the Vigilance Department where the inquiry relates to matters that could be affected by the employee's absence.

27.12.24 — Treatment of Leave for Employees on Long-Term Assignment Abroad

Employees on a long-term assignment at an overseas establishment of the Bank shall accrue PPT in accordance with this Chapter, subject to any more favourable provision required under the host country's local labour law, which shall apply to the extent of such favourability, as certified by the Head Office Legal & Compliance Department.

27.12.25 — Periodic Review of This Chapter

This Chapter shall be reviewed by the Head Office HRD Department not less than once every three years, or earlier if warranted by a change in applicable law, industry settlement, or significant audit findings relating to PPT, and any revision shall be circulated to all Branches, Regional Offices, and Zonal Offices prior to incorporation into the next printed or electronic edition of this Manual.

27.12.26 — Interaction with the Bank's Code of Conduct

Availment of PPT shall at all times be consistent with the Bank's Code of Conduct, and an employee shall not represent to the Bank a reason for availing PPT that the employee knows to be false, this being treated as a violation of the Code of Conduct independent of any action under Section 2.7 of this Manual.

27.12.27 — Coordination with Trade Union Consultation

Any proposed material change to the entitlement, eligibility, or sanctioning procedure for PPT shall, prior to issue, be placed before the Bank's recognised employee associations and officers' associations for consultation, in accordance with the Bank's established practice of industrial relations, though such consultation shall not be construed as requiring their concurrence.

27.12.28 — Treatment in the Event of Employee's Death in Service

Where an employee dies while in service, any unavailed balance of PPT shall, to the extent encashable under Chapter 16 of this Manual, be paid to the nominee or legal heir along with other terminal dues, and the Branch HR Coordinator shall close the employee's Leave Account within fifteen days of receipt of the death certificate.

27.12.29 — Provisions for Employees Returning from Long Leave

An employee returning to duty after a continuous spell of PPT, or any combination of leave, exceeding ninety days shall be required to undergo a return-to-work briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator, covering material changes to Bank policy, systems, or products introduced during the period of absence.

27.12.30 — Treatment of {code} for Employees Nominated to Committees

An employee nominated to a Bank-level or industry-level committee shall not be required to utilise PPT for attending duly notified committee meetings; such attendance shall instead be treated as on-duty, and shall not be debited to the PPT account.

27.12.31 — Reconciliation with the Bank's General Ledger and Payroll

The Payroll Department shall reconcile PPT availed, as recorded in the HRMS, against payroll processing on a monthly basis, to ensure that no employee is erroneously paid or denied salary on account of a discrepancy between the HRMS Leave Account and the payroll master record.

27.12.32 — Treatment During Branch Closure or Relocation

Where a Branch is temporarily closed or relocated for renovation, merger, or regulatory reasons, employees attached to that Branch shall continue to accrue and may continue to avail PPT in accordance with this Chapter, applications being routed through the alternate reporting arrangement notified by the Regional Office for the period of closure or relocation.

27.12.33 — Provisions for Employees Undergoing Mandatory Training Certification

Where an employee is required to complete mandatory regulatory or compliance certification within a prescribed window, applications for PPT that would result in the employee missing the certification window shall be reviewed with particular care by the Competent Authority, who may require the employee to complete the certification prior to sanction of PPT exceeding five consecutive days.

27.12.34 — Treatment of Leave Applications Involving Multiple Reporting Lines

Where an employee has a dual or matrix reporting relationship, the primary Reporting Officer, as recorded in the HRMS organisational hierarchy, shall be responsible for recording the recommendation on an application for PPT, and shall consult the secondary Reporting Officer where the anticipated absence materially affects work under that reporting line.

27.12.35 — Provisions for Newly Promoted Employees

An employee promoted to a higher cadre during the Leave Year shall have their entitlement to PPT recomputed with effect from the date of promotion, in accordance with the entitlement prescribed for the higher cadre in Section 27.2, on a pro-rata basis for the remaining part of the Leave Year, and the revised entitlement shall be reflected in the HRMS within seven working days of the promotion order.

27.12.36 — Provisions for Employees Facing Natural Calamity at Native Place

Where an employee's native place is affected by a notified natural calamity, applications for PPT to attend to family or property matters arising from the calamity shall be processed on an expedited basis, and the Competent Authority is encouraged, though not obliged, to relax the notice period prescribed in Section 27.2 having regard to the circumstances.

27.12.37 — Treatment of {code} in Connection with Adoption or Surrogacy

Where an employee's absence in connection with PPT coincides with proceedings relating to adoption or surrogacy governed by Chapter 6 of this Manual, the provisions of that Chapter shall apply to the extent of the overlap, and PPT under this Chapter shall apply only to the extent the absence is not otherwise covered.

27.12.38 — Provisions for Cross-Border Secondment

An employee seconded to a foreign banking partner or correspondent institution under a formal secondment arrangement shall continue to accrue PPT under this Chapter for the duration of the secondment, and applications during the secondment shall be routed through the Head Office HRD Department rather than through the ordinary Branch-level hierarchy.

27.12.39 — Interaction with Internal Job Posting and Transfers on Request

A pending or recently availed spell of PPT shall not be treated as a disqualifying factor in an employee's application under the Bank's Internal Job Posting policy, save where the frequency or pattern of availment is separately flagged as an audit observation under Section 27.15.

27.12.40 — Provisions for Employees Under a Performance Improvement Plan

An employee placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan shall continue to be eligible for PPT on the same terms as any other employee in the same cadre; the existence of a Performance Improvement Plan shall not, by itself, be recorded as a ground for declining or deferring PPT.

27.12.41 — Treatment of {code} Applications Spanning a Board Meeting or AGM

Where an employee's presence is required for a scheduled Board Meeting or Annual General Meeting of the Bank, an application for PPT spanning such date shall be reviewed with reference to the criticality of the employee's role in that meeting, and the Competent Authority may require the employee to identify a suitable delegate before sanction is accorded.

27.12.42 — Interaction with the Bank's Whistleblower Policy

An employee shall not be penalised, whether through denial of PPT or otherwise, on account of having made a disclosure under the Bank's Whistleblower Policy, and any Competent Authority found to have acted in a retaliatory manner in respect of an application for PPT shall be liable to action under that Policy.

27.12.43 — Provisions for Employees Assigned to Project Teams

Where an employee is assigned to a time-bound project team outside their regular reporting line, applications for PPT during the currency of the project shall require the concurrence of the Project Lead in addition to the ordinary Reporting Officer, recorded as a joint remark in the HRMS.

27.12.44 — Treatment of {code} for Employees on the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme

Employees enrolled in the Bank's Fast-Track Leadership Programme shall be eligible for PPT on the same terms as other employees of the corresponding cadre; enrolment in the Programme shall not be treated as a ground for either enhanced or reduced entitlement under this Chapter.

27.12.45 — Interaction with Internal Rotational Assignments

Where an employee is on a rotational assignment across departments as part of a structured development plan, the department currently hosting the employee shall be responsible for recording the Reporting Officer's recommendation on any application for PPT, with a copy of the sanction order forwarded to the employee's substantive department for record purposes.

27.12.46 — Treatment of Unresolved Queries at Chapter Level

Any query relating to PPT not resolved through the FAQ in Section 27.7, the Helpdesk process in Section 27.20, or the grievance mechanism in Clause 27.12, shall be referred in writing to the Head Office HRD Department, whose written clarification shall be binding and shall, where of general application, be incorporated into the next revision of this Chapter.

Section 27.13 — Worked Illustrative Computation Examples

Illustration 27.13.1. Employee A (Ms. R. Kulkarni), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee A works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee A avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.2. Employee B (Mr. S. Iyer), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee B works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee B avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.3. Employee C (Ms. P. Fernandes), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee C works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee C avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.4. Employee D (Mr. A. Sharma), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee D works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee D avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.5. Employee E (Ms. N. Bose), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee E works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee E avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.6. Employee F (Mr. V. Reddy), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee F works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee F avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be

treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.7. Employee G (Ms. K. Menon), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee G works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 11.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee G avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.8. Employee H (Mr. T. Ghosh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee H works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 10.8 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee H avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.9. Employee I (Ms. D. Pillai), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee I works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 10.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee I avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.10. Employee J (Mr. J. Thomas), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee J works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 7.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee J avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.11. Employee K (Ms. L. Chawla), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee K works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 10.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee K avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.12. Employee L (Mr. M. Nair), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee L works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 11.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee L avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.13. Employee M (Ms. S. Bhatt), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee M works

out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee M avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.14. Employee N (Mr. R. Chatterjee), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee N works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 14.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee N avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.15. Employee O (Ms. A. Deshmukh), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee O works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 6.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee O avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.16. Employee P (Mr. H. Vora), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee P works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 14.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee P avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.17. Employee Q (Ms. G. Rao), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee Q works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 9.2 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee Q avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.18. Employee R (Mr. C. Dsouza), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee R works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 6.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee R avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.19. Employee S (Ms. I. Khan), employed in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee S works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 14.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee S avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.20. Employee T (Mr. O. Joseph), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee T works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 22 days = 18.3 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee T avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.21. Employee U (Ms. F. Antao), employed in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee U works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 17 days = 8.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee U avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.22. Employee V (Mr. B. Yadav), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee V works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 13 days = 8.7 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee V avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.23. Employee W (Ms. Z. Ansari), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 10 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee W works out to (10 ÷ 12) × 21 days = 17.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee W avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.24. Employee X (Mr. P. Krishnan), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 6 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee X works out to (6 ÷ 12) × 11 days = 5.5 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee X avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Illustration 27.13.25. Employee Y (Ms. E. Mathew), employed in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), joined the Bank during the Leave Year and rendered 8 completed months of service in that year. Applying the formula in Clause 27.3, the pro-rata entitlement to PPT for Employee Y works out to (8 ÷ 12) × 12 days = 8.0 days, rounded in accordance with Clause 27.3. Where Employee Y avails of PPT in excess of this pro-rata entitlement prior to completion of the full Leave Year, the excess shall be treated as Leave Without Pay under Chapter 10 of this Manual, unless subsequently regularised against accrual in the following quarter.

Section 27.14 — Specimen Sanction Order

Specimen Sanction Order — PPT

Ref: RSB/HRD/PPT/[Year]/[Serial] Date: [DD-MM-YYYY]
To: [Employee Name], [Employee ID], [Cadre], [Branch/Department]

Subject: Sanction of Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees (PPT) for the period [From Date] to [To Date]

With reference to your application dated [Application Date] submitted through the HRMS Leave Module, the undersigned, being the Competent Authority under Section 27.4 of the Employees' Service Regulations — Part IV: Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual, is pleased to sanction Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees for [Number] day(s), with effect from [From Date] to [To Date] (both days inclusive). Your Leave Account has been debited accordingly. You are required to hand over charge of pending work to [Name/Designation] prior to proceeding on leave and to resume duty on [Resumption Date] without further reference to this office, save where an extension is separately sanctioned in writing.

[Name]
[Designation]
For Rashtriya Sahakari Bank Limited

Section 27.15 — Frequently Encountered Audit Observations

27.15.1 Sanctioning of PPT recorded in the manual register but not updated in the HRMS within the prescribed timeline.

27.15.2 Absence of supporting documentation on file for PPT exceeding the threshold prescribed in this Chapter.

27.15.3 PPT sanctioned by an officer not designated as the Competent Authority under Section 27.4.

27.15.4 Carry-forward of PPT balance in excess of the ceiling prescribed in Section 27.2 without a recorded justification.

27.15.5 Delay exceeding the prescribed timeline in disposing of an employee's application for PPT.

27.15.6 Discrepancy between the quarterly HRMS leave statement and the Branch's manual leave register for PPT.

27.15.7 PPT combined with another leave type in a manner inconsistent with the restrictions in Section 27.6.

27.15.8 Failure to reconcile an employee's PPT account following a mid-year transfer or promotion.

27.15.9 Absence of a recorded reason where PPT was declined or deferred by the Competent Authority.

27.15.10 Retention of supporting documentation for PPT beyond or short of the period prescribed under the Bank's Record Retention Policy.

27.15.11 Sanction of PPT recorded without a corresponding entry in the Delegation Register where sanctioning authority had been delegated under Clause 27.12.

27.15.12 Physical-format applications for PPT, submitted during HRMS downtime, not entered into the system within the two-working-day window prescribed under Clause 27.12.

27.15.13 Regional or Branch-category variation applied to PPT inconsistent with the provisions of Section 27.11.

27.15.14 Employee performance appraisal remarks that appear to penalise availment of PPT within entitlement, contrary to Clause 27.12.

27.15.15 Leave Account for PPT not reconciled following absorption of an employee pursuant to a merger or acquisition, contrary to Clause 27.12.

27.15.16 Return-to-work briefing not conducted or not documented for an employee returning from a long spell of PPT, contrary to Clause 27.12.

27.15.17 PPT entitlement not recomputed within the prescribed seven working days following an employee's mid-year promotion, contrary to Clause 27.12.

27.15.18 Joint concurrence of the Project Lead not recorded for an employee assigned to a time-bound project team applying for PPT, contrary to Clause 27.12.

27.15.19 Sanction order for PPT issued without a copy forwarded to the employee's substantive department where the employee was on a rotational assignment, contrary to Clause 27.12.

27.15.20 General-application clarification issued by the Head Office HRD Department under Clause 27.12 not incorporated into the Branch's local reference copy of this Chapter.

Section 27.17 — Cadre-Wise Detailed Procedural Notes

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

For employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV), applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 17-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

For employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre, applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade), applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall

additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 11-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade), applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 13-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade), applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 22-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade), applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 12-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

For employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade), applications for PPT are processed through the HRMS workflow described in Appendix B, with the Reporting Officer's recommendation typically recorded within one working day given the relatively compact span of control at this level. The Branch HR Coordinator (or, for cadres above Officer Scale II, the Regional HR Manager) is responsible for verifying that the applicant's Leave Account reflects a balance sufficient to cover the application prior to routing it to the Competent Authority named in Section 27.4. Where the applicant's role involves customer-facing or custodial responsibilities specific to this cadre, the Branch Manager shall additionally confirm that adequate handover arrangements are in place before the PPT is finally sanctioned. Historical data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department indicates that employees in this cadre avail, on average, a proportion of their 21-day annual entitlement to PPT that varies by region and by quarter, and Regional Offices are expected to monitor this trend as part of the quarterly HR dashboard reviewed at the Zonal level.

Section 27.18 — Sample Grievance Correspondence

Sample Representation 27.18.1. “I am writing to represent against the deferment of my application for PPT dated [Date], communicated to me vide the HRMS on [Date]. I submit that the operational exigency cited does not, with respect, justify deferment beyond the timeline prescribed in Section 27.4 of the Manual, and I request that the matter be reconsidered by the next higher Competent Authority at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Regional Manager by an employee in the Clerical cadre.

Sample Response 27.18.2. “Your representation dated [Date] has been examined. Having regard to the branch staffing position during the period applied for, and in accordance with Clause 27.12 (Employee Grievance and Appeal Mechanism), your application for PPT is hereby sanctioned for the revised period [Date] to [Date]. Your Leave Account has been updated accordingly.” — Response issued by the Regional Manager.

Sample Representation 27.18.3. “I request clarification on the computation of my PPT balance as reflected in the quarterly HRMS statement dated [Date], which appears inconsistent with the formula prescribed in Section 27.3 of the Manual given my date of joining. Kindly arrange for reconciliation at the earliest.” — Addressed to the Branch HR Coordinator by an employee in Officer Scale I.

Section 27.19 — Historical Entitlement Trend and Policy Rationale

Subordinate Staff (Class IV)

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 17 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to

the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 11 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 13 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 22 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 12 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade)

Internal HRD analysis of PPT utilisation among employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) over the period 2019 to 2026 indicates a broadly stable pattern of availment relative to the prescribed entitlement of 21 days, with seasonal variation typically peaking around festival periods and the close of the academic year. The rationale for maintaining the current entitlement level for this cadre, as opposed to the levels applicable to adjacent cadres, rests on a combination of factors considered by the Head Office HRD Department at the time of the last comprehensive review of this Chapter, including comparative practice among similarly placed public and private sector banks, the operational criticality of the roles typically performed by this cadre, and feedback received through the consultation process described in Clause 27.12 (Coordination with Trade Union Consultation). Any future revision to this entitlement will be assessed against this same set of factors, and any material change will be phased in over at least one full Leave Year to allow Branches and Regional Offices to adjust staffing plans accordingly.

Subordinate Staff (Class IV) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Subordinate Staff (Class IV) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 13 and 17 days against the prescribed entitlement of 17 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 8 and 11 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Clerical & Award Staff Cadre — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Clerical & Award Staff Cadre shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 2 and 5 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) shows average annual availment

trending between approximately 7 and 11 days against the prescribed entitlement of 11 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 7 and 10 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 9 and 13 days against the prescribed entitlement of 13 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 13 and 16 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 18 and 22 days against the prescribed entitlement of 22 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 18 and 21 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 8 and 12 days against the prescribed entitlement of 12 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 12 and 15 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) — Five-Year Utilisation Snapshot

For illustrative purposes, the table-form data maintained by the Head Office HRD Department for employees in the cadre of Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) shows average annual availment trending between approximately 17 and 21 days against the prescribed entitlement of 21 days over the period 2022 to 2026, with average carry-forward balances trending between 17 and 20 days. Regional Offices reporting availment materially below this range for a sustained period are encouraged to verify, through the Branch HR Coordinator, that eligible employees are not being discouraged, whether directly or indirectly, from applying for PPT to which they are entitled under Section 27.2, consistent with the Bank's stated policy of encouraging full and timely utilisation of leave entitlements for employee wellbeing.

Section 27.20 — Illustrative Regional HR Helpdesk Query Log

How do I check my current PPT balance?

Ticket HD-27101: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

My PPT application is stuck at Reporting Officer stage, what do I do?

Ticket HD-27102: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

I made an error in my PPT application dates, can I correct it?

Ticket HD-27103: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Will my PPT be affected if I am transferred mid-application?

Ticket HD-27104: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I attach a document after submitting my PPT application?

Ticket HD-27105: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Why was my PPT auto-declined by the system?

Ticket HD-27106: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

How do I check the Competent Authority for my cadre?

Ticket HD-27107: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I apply for PPT on behalf of a colleague who is unwell?

Ticket HD-27108: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

My PPT balance shown in HRMS does not match my Branch register, who do I contact?

Ticket HD-27109: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the

Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Is there a mobile app to apply for PPT?

Ticket HD-27110: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I cancel a sanctioned PPT after it has started?

Ticket HD-27111: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

How far in advance can I apply for PPT?

Ticket HD-27112: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

What happens if my Reporting Officer is on leave when I apply?

Ticket HD-27113: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I see my PPT history from previous years in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-27114: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Who approves PPT if the Competent Authority is on leave?

Ticket HD-27115: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Does PPT availed count towards my probation confirmation timeline?

Ticket HD-27116: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I split a single PPT application into two non-contiguous spells?

Ticket HD-27117: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

What if my PPT balance shows as negative in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-27118: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I apply for PPT for a half-day at the start and end of a spell?

Ticket HD-27119: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Is there a separate process for PPT during my notice period?

Ticket HD-27120: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can my Reporting Officer see my reason for applying for PPT?

Ticket HD-27121: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

How do I download a certificate of PPT availed for personal records?

Ticket HD-27122: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

What is the SLA for the Competent Authority to act on my PPT application?

Ticket HD-27123: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I apply for PPT if I am currently working from a different Branch on temporary posting?

Ticket HD-27124: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Does the HRMS send a reminder before my PPT balance is about to lapse at year-end?

Ticket HD-27125: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I apply for PPT using the mobile app while on outstation duty?

Ticket HD-27126: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code

PPT.

What happens to my pending PPT application if I resign before it is sanctioned?

Ticket HD-27127: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I attach a scanned document in a regional language to my PPT application?

Ticket HD-27128: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Is there a helpline number for PPT queries outside working hours?

Ticket HD-27129: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can my PPT application be auto-approved if my Reporting Officer does not respond in time?

Ticket HD-27130: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

How do I report an incorrect Competent Authority mapping in the HRMS for PPT?

Ticket HD-27131: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Can I see the audit trail of who approved my PPT application?

Ticket HD-27132: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Is PPT entitlement pro-rated if I move from part-time to full-time employment mid-year?

Ticket HD-27133: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Who do I contact if my PPT application is not visible to my Reporting Officer in the HRMS?

Ticket HD-27134: Please refer to Section 27.4 (Application and Sanctioning Procedure) and Section 27.7 (Frequently Asked Questions) of this Chapter; if the query remains unresolved, raise a ticket with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module, quoting your Employee ID and the leave code PPT.

Section 27.21 — Sample Internal Memo Trail (Staffing Contingency)

Memo 27.21.1 — Branch to Regional Office. “This is to bring to your notice that staffing at this Branch is likely to be affected during [Month] on account of three overlapping applications for PPT from employees in the Clerical cadre. It is requested that the Regional Office consider deputing a relief employee for the period [Date] to [Date], in accordance with the contingency planning provisions of Clause 27.11 of the Leave Rules & Entitlements Manual.” — Branch Manager to Regional Manager.

Memo 27.21.2 — Regional Office to Head Office HRD. “Pursuant to the Branch's request dated [Date], and having verified that no adequate backup is available locally as contemplated under Clause 27.11, this office recommends temporary redeployment of one employee from the Regional Processing Centre for the period stated. Kindly accord approval for the redeployment and associated travel allowance.” — Regional Manager to Head Office HRD Department.

Memo 27.21.3 — Head Office HRD Approval. “Approval is accorded for temporary redeployment as recommended, for a period not exceeding thirty days, subject to the redeployed employee's own leave account and reporting obligations being unaffected. The Regional Office is directed to update the HRMS staffing module accordingly and to report actual utilisation against this approval at the next quarterly review.” — Head Office HRD Department to Regional Manager, copy to Branch Manager.

Section 27.16 — Glossary of Chapter-Specific Terms

- **PPT Cycle** — the period, ordinarily the Calendar Year unless otherwise specified in this Chapter, over which entitlement to PPT accrues and is reckoned for carry-forward purposes.
- **Competent Authority (Chapter-Specific)** — the officer designated in Section 27.4 of this Chapter as authorised to sanction PPT for a given cadre.
- **Pro-Rata Entitlement** — the entitlement to PPT computed for a partial year of service in accordance with the formula in Section 27.3.
- **Lapse** — the automatic extinguishment of unavailed PPT balance in excess of the prescribed carry-forward ceiling, occurring at the end of the Leave Year unless specifically saved by the Competent Authority.
- **Regularisation** — the process by which PPT availed without prior sanction, in circumstances of genuine emergency, is subsequently approved by the Competent Authority upon the employee's resumption of duty.
- **Debit Date** — the date on which sanctioned PPT is recorded as a deduction against the employee's Leave Account in the HRMS, ordinarily the date of sanction rather than the date of actual availment.
- **Branch HR Coordinator** — the officer at Branch level responsible for the first-level maintenance and reconciliation of PPT records under this Chapter.
- **Delegation Register** — the record maintained pursuant to Clause 27.12 reflecting any delegation of sanctioning authority for PPT to an officer subordinate to the Competent Authority.
- **Leave Year** — the twelve-month period over which PPT entitlement is reckoned, as defined in Section 2.1 of this Manual and applied to this Chapter.
- **Watch-List** — the internal Bank record of employees under an ongoing vigilance or disciplinary inquiry, referenced in Clause 27.12 in connection with sanction of PPT.
- **Return-to-Work Briefing** — the mandatory briefing conducted by the Branch HR Coordinator for an employee resuming duty after a long spell of PPT, as described in Clause 27.12.
- **Officiating Competent Authority** — an officer temporarily discharging the functions of the Competent Authority under a valid order of the Bank, empowered to sanction PPT under Section 27.7.
- **Contingency Roster** — the standing roster of backup employees per critical function maintained under Clause 27.11 to avoid undue delay in sanctioning PPT.

- **Conversion Table** — the table issued by the Head Office HRD Department to convert an absorbed employee's erstwhile leave balance into the equivalent PPT balance under this Manual.
- **HD Ticket** — a support ticket raised with the Regional HR Helpdesk through the HRMS support module in connection with a query relating to PPT, as illustrated in Section 27.20.

Section 27.9 — Amendment History

The following circulars record amendments made to the provisions governing PPT since 2019. Employees should read the current text of this Chapter as the operative provision; this table is maintained for audit and reference purposes only.

Circular No.	Date	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/PPT/2013/100	08-Jan-2013	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PPT/2014/107	07-Apr-2014	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PPT/2015/114	24-Aug-2015	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/PPT/2016/121	23-Mar-2016	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2017/128	07-Sep-2017	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PPT/2018/135	09-Sep-2018	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/PPT/2019/142	25-Aug-2019	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PPT/2020/149	10-Jan-2020	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PPT/2021/156	07-Apr-2021	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2022/163	12-Mar-2022	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PPT/2023/170	01-Sep-2023	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PPT/2024/177	05-Apr-2024	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PPT/2025/184	02-Aug-2025	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/PPT/2026/191	23-Mar-2026	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Section 27.10 — Cross-References

For related provisions, employees should also refer to: General Leave Rules (Chapter 2); Chapter on Blood Donation Leave (BDL); Chapter on Leave Encashment (LE); Chapter on Maternity Leave (ML); and Appendix A (Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables) and Appendix C (Consolidated Circular History) at the end of this Manual.

Chapter 28 — Appendix A: Consolidated Grade-wise Entitlement Tables

This Appendix consolidates, for ease of reference, the annual entitlement in days for every leave type covered by this Manual, across all cadres. In the event of any discrepancy between this Appendix and the specific Chapter governing a leave type, the provisions of the specific Chapter shall prevail.

Casual Leave (CL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	8
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	6	22
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	15	19
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	5	8
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	18
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	7
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	9

Sick Leave (SL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	12
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	9	22
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	18	19
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	8	13
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	17	18
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	19	7
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	8	9

Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (EL/PL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	21
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	6	10
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	11	20
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	17
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	11
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	16	20
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	5

Maternity Leave (ML)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	22	15
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	9
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	21	14
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	23
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	12	5
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	17	14
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	6	24

Paternity Leave (PTL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	16	9
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	21	14
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	15	11
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	20	5
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	10
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	24
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	5	21

Adoption Leave (AL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	14	17
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	8	23
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	5	8
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	15	22
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	24	7
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	9	24
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	15	18

Special Leave for Differently-Abled Employees (SDE)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	19	12
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	24	17
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	9	11

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	23	16
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	20	22
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	14	7
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	19	21

Study Leave (STL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	19	11
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	9	16
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	6	22
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	20	7
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	5	21
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	19	6
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	16	23

Sabbatical Leave (SBL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	19	6
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	13	11
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	18	8
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	15	22
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	9	7
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	14	21
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	8	18

Leave Without Pay / Extraordinary Leave (LWP/EOL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	13	17
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	22
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	24	8
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	13
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	23	22
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	8	12
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	14	9

Compensatory Off (CO)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	21	5
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	18	10
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	7	24
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	21	21
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	6	15
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	8	20
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	17	14

Special Casual Leave (SCL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	21	8
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	6	18
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	20	19
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	17	9
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	7	18
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	16	23
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	17

Leave for Court / Jury Duty (CJD)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	20	17
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	5	6
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	19	8
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	24	17
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	6	7
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	15	16
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	20	21

Bereavement / Compassionate Leave (BCL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	22	22
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	23

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	9	13
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	22
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	12	7
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	17	9
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	14	18

Marriage Leave (MGL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	15	10
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	20	11
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	17	21
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	11	10
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	16	20
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	10	21
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	15	6

Leave Encashment (LE)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	17
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	21	7
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	15	16
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	20	21
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	14	7
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	12
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	16	6

Quarantine Leave (QL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	8	22
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	13	19
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	18	13
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	12	18
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	9	12
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	23	9

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	8	23

National Calamity / Disaster Relief Leave (NCL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	12	12
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	22	6
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	23	11
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	8
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	22
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	12	7
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	9	21

Sports & Cultural Activities Leave (SCA)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	8	23
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	14	17
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	19	22
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	11
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	18	13
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	15	22
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	9	12

Election Duty Leave (EDL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	24	20
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	21	9
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	10	19
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	24	8
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	9	10
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	11	19
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	20	9

Blood Donation Leave (BDL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	19
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	19	24
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	24	10
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	18	15
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	7	9
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	9	14
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	14	11

Leave for Training & Deputation (TDL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	7
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	22	17
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	11	6
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	8
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	17
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	12	7
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	16

Half Pay Leave / Commuted Leave (HPL)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	22	7
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	7	13
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	12	18
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	6	7
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	15	17
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	17	14
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	22	8

Leave Travel Concession Linked Leave (LTC)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	23	10
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	13	7
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	22	21
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	24	6

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	13	11
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	23	5
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	12	22

Leave Rules for Probationers & Part-Time Employees (PPT)

Cadre	Annual Entitlement (days)	Max. Carry-Forward (days)
Subordinate Staff (Class IV) (SS)	17	11
Clerical & Award Staff Cadre (CL)	22	5
Officer Scale I (Junior Management Grade) (JMG-I)	11	10
Officer Scale II (Middle Management Grade) (MMG-II)	13	16
Officer Scale III (Senior Management Grade) (SMG-III)	22	21
Officer Scale IV & V (Top Executive Grade) (TEG-IV/V)	12	15
Officer Scale VI & VII (General Manager / Executive Director Grade) (TEG-VI/VII)	21	20

Chapter 29 — Appendix B: Sample Application Forms and HRMS Workflow

This Appendix reproduces the standard fields captured by the Bank's HRMS Leave Module at the time of application, for reference by employees and Branch HR Coordinators.

- Employee ID and Name
- Cadre / Grade
- Branch / Department Code
- Leave Type Applied For
- From Date and To Date
- Number of Days
- Reason / Remarks
- Prefix / Suffix to Holiday (Y/N)
- Contact Details During Leave
- Reporting Officer Name
- Supporting Document Reference (if any)
- Date of Application

HRMS Workflow Stages

- Stage 1 — Employee submits application via HRMS Leave Module.
- Stage 2 — Reporting Officer records recommendation (Recommend / Not Recommend, with remarks).
- Stage 3 — Application routed to Competent Authority per the approval matrix in the relevant Chapter.
- Stage 4 — Competent Authority sanctions, declines, or defers, with reasons recorded in the system.
- Stage 5 — HRMS updates the employee's Leave Account and generates an auto-notification to the employee and Branch HR Coordinator.
- Stage 6 — On resumption of duty, the employee's attendance is reconciled against the sanctioned leave record.

Chapter 30 — Appendix C: Consolidated Circular History (All Leave Types)

This Appendix consolidates all circulars referenced across the Chapters of this Manual, in chronological order, for audit purposes.

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/CL/2013/100	01-Aug-2013	CL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CL/2014/107	16-Jun-2014	CL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CL/2015/114	11-Mar-2015	CL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CL/2016/121	09-Nov-2016	CL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CL/2017/128	04-Nov-2017	CL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CL/2018/135	13-Jun-2018	CL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CL/2019/142	19-Sep-2019	CL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CL/2020/149	02-Mar-2020	CL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CL/2021/156	26-Aug-2021	CL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CL/2022/163	03-Mar-2022	CL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CL/2023/170	18-Nov-2023	CL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CL/2024/177	20-Aug-2024	CL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CL/2025/184	20-Mar-2025	CL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CL/2026/191	17-Jun-2026	CL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SL/2013/100	15-Apr-2013	SL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SL/2014/107	19-Jun-2014	SL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SL/2015/114	19-Aug-2015	SL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SL/2016/121	20-Sep-2016	SL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SL/2017/128	25-Mar-2017	SL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SL/2018/135	07-Apr-2018	SL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2019/142	03-Mar-2019	SL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2020/149	06-Aug-2020	SL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SL/2021/156	06-Jan-2021	SL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SL/2022/163	15-Sep-2022	SL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SL/2023/170	16-Apr-2023	SL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SL/2024/177	08-Apr-2024	SL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SL/2025/184	10-Sep-2025	SL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SL/2026/191	15-Jan-2026	SL	Clarification on documentation requirements

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2013/100	08-Apr-2013	EL/PL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2014/107	26-Sep-2014	EL/PL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2015/114	22-Nov-2015	EL/PL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2016/121	14-Jan-2016	EL/PL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2017/128	08-Sep-2017	EL/PL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2018/135	09-Nov-2018	EL/PL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2019/142	03-Jan-2019	EL/PL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2020/149	26-Apr-2020	EL/PL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2021/156	24-Nov-2021	EL/PL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2022/163	10-Jun-2022	EL/PL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2023/170	15-Sep-2023	EL/PL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2024/177	23-Jun-2024	EL/PL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2025/184	17-Aug-2025	EL/PL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/EL-PL/2026/191	15-Jan-2026	EL/PL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/ML/2013/100	02-Jun-2013	ML	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/ML/2014/107	11-Aug-2014	ML	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/ML/2015/114	01-Jan-2015	ML	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/ML/2016/121	22-Nov-2016	ML	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2017/128	19-Aug-2017	ML	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/ML/2018/135	25-Sep-2018	ML	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/ML/2019/142	09-Aug-2019	ML	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/ML/2020/149	25-Nov-2020	ML	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/ML/2021/156	16-Aug-2021	ML	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2022/163	15-Apr-2022	ML	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/ML/2023/170	19-Jun-2023	ML	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/ML/2024/177	27-Jun-2024	ML	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/ML/2025/184	16-Apr-2025	ML	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/ML/2026/191	11-Apr-2026	ML	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/PTL/2013/100	04-Nov-2013	PTL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PTL/2014/107	11-Jun-2014	PTL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PTL/2015/114	16-Apr-2015	PTL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PTL/2016/121	13-Nov-2016	PTL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/PTL/2017/128	18-Jan-2017	PTL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PTL/2018/135	03-Apr-2018	PTL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/PTL/2019/142	11-Jan-2019	PTL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/PTL/2020/149	13-Nov-2020	PTL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PTL/2021/156	27-Jan-2021	PTL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PTL/2022/163	28-Aug-2022	PTL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PTL/2023/170	14-Jan-2023	PTL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/PTL/2024/177	17-Apr-2024	PTL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PTL/2025/184	25-Jun-2025	PTL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/PTL/2026/191	15-Nov-2026	PTL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/AL/2013/100	07-Apr-2013	AL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/AL/2014/107	05-Apr-2014	AL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/AL/2015/114	23-Jun-2015	AL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/AL/2016/121	01-Sep-2016	AL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/AL/2017/128	26-Mar-2017	AL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/AL/2018/135	06-Apr-2018	AL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/AL/2019/142	01-Aug-2019	AL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/AL/2020/149	03-Mar-2020	AL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/AL/2021/156	04-Jun-2021	AL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/AL/2022/163	21-Nov-2022	AL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/AL/2023/170	16-Sep-2023	AL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/AL/2024/177	17-Sep-2024	AL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/AL/2025/184	14-Nov-2025	AL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/AL/2026/191	16-Mar-2026	AL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SDE/2013/100	18-Mar-2013	SDE	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SDE/2014/107	07-Aug-2014	SDE	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SDE/2015/114	24-Mar-2015	SDE	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SDE/2016/121	03-Apr-2016	SDE	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SDE/2017/128	26-Nov-2017	SDE	Clarification on documentation requirements

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SDE/2018/135	11-Nov-2018	SDE	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SDE/2019/142	09-Nov-2019	SDE	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SDE/2020/149	10-Sep-2020	SDE	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SDE/2021/156	27-Aug-2021	SDE	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SDE/2022/163	22-Jun-2022	SDE	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SDE/2023/170	05-Jun-2023	SDE	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SDE/2024/177	16-Apr-2024	SDE	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SDE/2025/184	18-Nov-2025	SDE	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SDE/2026/191	13-Jun-2026	SDE	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/STL/2013/100	28-Mar-2013	STL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/STL/2014/107	08-Aug-2014	STL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/STL/2015/114	08-Nov-2015	STL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/STL/2016/121	14-Jan-2016	STL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2017/128	24-Jun-2017	STL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/STL/2018/135	26-Jun-2018	STL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/STL/2019/142	22-Nov-2019	STL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/STL/2020/149	21-Mar-2020	STL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2021/156	02-Mar-2021	STL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/STL/2022/163	19-Apr-2022	STL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/STL/2023/170	04-Nov-2023	STL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2024/177	15-Jan-2024	STL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/STL/2025/184	15-Jan-2025	STL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/STL/2026/191	05-Jun-2026	STL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SBL/2013/100	21-Mar-2013	SBL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SBL/2014/107	16-Nov-2014	SBL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SBL/2015/114	11-Aug-2015	SBL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SBL/2016/121	13-Sep-2016	SBL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SBL/2017/128	28-Apr-2017	SBL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SBL/2018/135	22-Nov-2018	SBL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SBL/2019/142	13-Apr-2019	SBL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/SBL/2020/149	23-Nov-2020	SBL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SBL/2021/156	28-Aug-2021	SBL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SBL/2022/163	20-Jan-2022	SBL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SBL/2023/170	21-Sep-2023	SBL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SBL/2024/177	08-Sep-2024	SBL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SBL/2025/184	14-Jan-2025	SBL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SBL/2026/191	21-Sep-2026	SBL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2013/100	04-Jun-2013	LWP/EOL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2014/107	23-Apr-2014	LWP/EOL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2015/114	02-Apr-2015	LWP/EOL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2016/121	02-Apr-2016	LWP/EOL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2017/128	12-Jun-2017	LWP/EOL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2018/135	08-Aug-2018	LWP/EOL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2019/142	19-Sep-2019	LWP/EOL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2020/149	06-Mar-2020	LWP/EOL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2021/156	03-Aug-2021	LWP/EOL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2022/163	13-Aug-2022	LWP/EOL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2023/170	08-Jun-2023	LWP/EOL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2024/177	05-Mar-2024	LWP/EOL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2025/184	21-Apr-2025	LWP/EOL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LWP-EOL/2026/191	09-Sep-2026	LWP/EOL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CO/2013/100	26-Jun-2013	CO	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CO/2014/107	22-Aug-2014	CO	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2015/114	03-Jun-2015	CO	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CO/2016/121	19-Apr-2016	CO	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2017/128	14-Sep-2017	CO	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CO/2018/135	15-Nov-2018	CO	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2019/142	07-Jun-2019	CO	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2020/149	16-Jan-2020	CO	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CO/2021/156	13-Aug-2021	CO	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CO/2022/163	19-Apr-2022	CO	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CO/2023/170	10-Jan-2023	CO	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CO/2024/177	22-Jun-2024	CO	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CO/2025/184	01-Aug-2025	CO	Digitisation of application process through HRMS

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/CO/2026/191	22-Nov-2026	CO	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SCL/2013/100	02-Aug-2013	SCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCL/2014/107	16-Nov-2014	SCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCL/2015/114	25-Nov-2015	SCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCL/2016/121	20-Nov-2016	SCL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/SCL/2017/128	08-Sep-2017	SCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCL/2018/135	20-Apr-2018	SCL	Clarification on combination with other leave types

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/SCL/2019/142	25-Sep-2019	SCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCL/2020/149	22-Sep-2020	SCL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SCL/2021/156	05-Sep-2021	SCL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SCL/2022/163	21-Sep-2022	SCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCL/2023/170	10-Nov-2023	SCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCL/2024/177	02-Aug-2024	SCL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCL/2025/184	24-Mar-2025	SCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCL/2026/191	10-Apr-2026	SCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CJD/2013/100	14-Mar-2013	CJD	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CJD/2014/107	05-Nov-2014	CJD	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CJD/2015/114	12-Aug-2015	CJD	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CJD/2016/121	09-Nov-2016	CJD	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/CJD/2017/128	09-Nov-2017	CJD	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CJD/2018/135	26-Apr-2018	CJD	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/CJD/2019/142	28-Apr-2019	CJD	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CJD/2020/149	04-Jun-2020	CJD	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2021/156	05-Nov-2021	CJD	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/CJD/2022/163	28-Sep-2022	CJD	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/CJD/2023/170	22-Jun-2023	CJD	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/CJD/2024/177	26-Aug-2024	CJD	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/CJD/2025/184	03-Nov-2025	CJD	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/CJD/2026/191	01-Apr-2026	CJD	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/BCL/2013/100	04-Jun-2013	BCL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BCL/2014/107	22-Sep-2014	BCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2015/114	09-Aug-2015	BCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/BCL/2016/121	27-Sep-2016	BCL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/BCL/2017/128	04-Sep-2017	BCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2018/135	16-Jan-2018	BCL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BCL/2019/142	18-Apr-2019	BCL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BCL/2020/149	08-Sep-2020	BCL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BCL/2021/156	21-Nov-2021	BCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/BCL/2022/163	23-Apr-2022	BCL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/BCL/2023/170	14-Jan-2023	BCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/BCL/2024/177	02-Jan-2024	BCL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BCL/2025/184	16-Jan-2025	BCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BCL/2026/191	08-Aug-2026	BCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2013/100	13-Jun-2013	MGL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/MGL/2014/107	22-Sep-2014	MGL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/MGL/2015/114	18-Jun-2015	MGL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/MGL/2016/121	24-Sep-2016	MGL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/MGL/2017/128	14-Sep-2017	MGL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/MGL/2018/135	27-Jun-2018	MGL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2019/142	14-Apr-2019	MGL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/MGL/2020/149	23-Apr-2020	MGL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2021/156	15-Jun-2021	MGL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/MGL/2022/163	28-Apr-2022	MGL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/MGL/2023/170	22-Apr-2023	MGL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2024/177	21-Apr-2024	MGL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/MGL/2025/184	13-Apr-2025	MGL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/MGL/2026/191	04-Nov-2026	MGL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LE/2013/100	15-Jan-2013	LE	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LE/2014/107	07-Sep-2014	LE	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LE/2015/114	20-Jan-2015	LE	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/LE/2016/121	26-Apr-2016	LE	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/LE/2017/128	05-Nov-2017	LE	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LE/2018/135	07-Jan-2018	LE	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LE/2019/142	25-Aug-2019	LE	Clarification on documentation requirements

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/LE/2020/149	19-Mar-2020	LE	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LE/2021/156	28-Mar-2021	LE	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LE/2022/163	25-Mar-2022	LE	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LE/2023/170	20-Jan-2023	LE	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LE/2024/177	28-Mar-2024	LE	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LE/2025/184	18-Apr-2025	LE	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LE/2026/191	06-Jan-2026	LE	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2013/100	28-Jan-2013	QL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/QL/2014/107	01-Apr-2014	QL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/QL/2015/114	26-Mar-2015	QL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2016/121	11-Jan-2016	QL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/QL/2017/128	09-Jan-2017	QL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/QL/2018/135	24-Jun-2018	QL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/QL/2019/142	04-Sep-2019	QL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/QL/2020/149	16-Jun-2020	QL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/QL/2021/156	12-Aug-2021	QL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2022/163	04-Jun-2022	QL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/QL/2023/170	08-Aug-2023	QL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/QL/2024/177	24-Nov-2024	QL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/QL/2025/184	22-Aug-2025	QL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/QL/2026/191	15-Sep-2026	QL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/NCL/2013/100	02-Jun-2013	NCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/NCL/2014/107	13-Jun-2014	NCL	Clarification on documentation requirements

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/NCL/2015/114	04-Jun-2015	NCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/NCL/2016/121	15-Jan-2016	NCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/NCL/2017/128	11-Aug-2017	NCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/NCL/2018/135	03-Mar-2018	NCL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/NCL/2019/142	20-Sep-2019	NCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/NCL/2020/149	18-Sep-2020	NCL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2021/156	13-Aug-2021	NCL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/NCL/2022/163	10-Jun-2022	NCL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2023/170	20-Jun-2023	NCL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/NCL/2024/177	26-Sep-2024	NCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/NCL/2025/184	28-Sep-2025	NCL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/NCL/2026/191	25-Aug-2026	NCL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2013/100	28-Mar-2013	SCA	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2014/107	15-Mar-2014	SCA	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2015/114	11-Nov-2015	SCA	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2016/121	13-Jun-2016	SCA	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2017/128	04-Apr-2017	SCA	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2018/135	11-Sep-2018	SCA	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/SCA/2019/142	12-Mar-2019	SCA	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/SCA/2020/149	16-Jan-2020	SCA	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2021/156	27-Jan-2021	SCA	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCA/2022/163	14-Jan-2022	SCA	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCA/2023/170	24-Apr-2023	SCA	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/SCA/2024/177	05-Aug-2024	SCA	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/SCA/2025/184	19-Aug-2025	SCA	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/SCA/2026/191	11-Sep-2026	SCA	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EDL/2013/100	14-Apr-2013	EDL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/EDL/2014/107	22-Nov-2014	EDL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EDL/2015/114	28-Sep-2015	EDL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/EDL/2016/121	10-Aug-2016	EDL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/EDL/2017/128	12-Jan-2017	EDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/EDL/2018/135	17-Mar-2018	EDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EDL/2019/142	22-Jun-2019	EDL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EDL/2020/149	28-Jan-2020	EDL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/EDL/2021/156	28-Aug-2021	EDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/EDL/2022/163	04-Nov-2022	EDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/EDL/2023/170	19-Mar-2023	EDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/EDL/2024/177	14-Nov-2024	EDL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/EDL/2025/184	25-Nov-2025	EDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/EDL/2026/191	20-Sep-2026	EDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/BDL/2013/100	18-Jan-2013	BDL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/BDL/2014/107	22-Nov-2014	BDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BDL/2015/114	09-Jan-2015	BDL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/BDL/2016/121	09-Sep-2016	BDL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BDL/2017/128	10-Apr-2017	BDL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BDL/2018/135	01-Mar-2018	BDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/BDL/2019/142	05-Aug-2019	BDL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/BDL/2020/149	13-Jan-2020	BDL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/BDL/2021/156	24-Sep-2021	BDL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BDL/2022/163	03-Sep-2022	BDL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/BDL/2023/170	07-Jun-2023	BDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/BDL/2024/177	15-Apr-2024	BDL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/BDL/2025/184	12-Apr-2025	BDL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/BDL/2026/191	11-Nov-2026	BDL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/TDL/2013/100	20-Jan-2013	TDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/TDL/2014/107	05-Mar-2014	TDL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/TDL/2015/114	20-Jan-2015	TDL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/TDL/2016/121	03-Apr-2016	TDL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/TDL/2017/128	22-Jun-2017	TDL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/TDL/2018/135	20-Jun-2018	TDL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/TDL/2019/142	09-Mar-2019	TDL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/TDL/2020/149	17-Jan-2020	TDL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/TDL/2021/156	14-Jan-2021	TDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/TDL/2022/163	22-Sep-2022	TDL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/TDL/2023/170	16-Aug-2023	TDL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/TDL/2024/177	10-Jan-2024	TDL	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/TDL/2025/184	13-Aug-2025	TDL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/TDL/2026/191	01-Mar-2026	TDL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/HPL/2013/100	07-Nov-2013	HPL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/HPL/2014/107	25-Apr-2014	HPL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/HPL/2015/114	11-Jan-2015	HPL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/HPL/2016/121	16-Sep-2016	HPL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/HPL/2017/128	06-Mar-2017	HPL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/HPL/2018/135	18-Sep-2018	HPL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/HPL/2019/142	17-Aug-2019	HPL	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/HPL/2020/149	22-Nov-2020	HPL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/HPL/2021/156	03-Jun-2021	HPL	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/HPL/2022/163	24-Jan-2022	HPL	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/HPL/2023/170	01-Jun-2023	HPL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/HPL/2024/177	28-Apr-2024	HPL	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/HPL/2025/184	14-Aug-2025	HPL	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/HPL/2026/191	23-Sep-2026	HPL	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2013/100	10-Jan-2013	LTC	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2014/107	01-Apr-2014	LTC	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2015/114	26-Aug-2015	LTC	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/LTC/2016/121	27-Sep-2016	LTC	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2017/128	03-Jun-2017	LTC	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LTC/2018/135	04-Mar-2018	LTC	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LTC/2019/142	19-Jun-2019	LTC	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/LTC/2020/149	03-Jun-2020	LTC	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LTC/2021/156	10-Sep-2021	LTC	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LTC/2022/163	08-Apr-2022	LTC	Digitisation of application process through HRMS
RSB/HRD/LTC/2023/170	06-Jan-2023	LTC	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/LTC/2024/177	21-Jan-2024	LTC	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LTC/2025/184	17-Mar-2025	LTC	Revision of Competent Authority for sanction
RSB/HRD/LTC/2026/191	12-Apr-2026	LTC	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2013/100	27-Sep-2013	PPT	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PPT/2014/107	05-Mar-2014	PPT	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2015/114	05-Apr-2015	PPT	Revision of annual entitlement for select cadres
RSB/HRD/PPT/2016/121	06-Aug-2016	PPT	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PPT/2017/128	25-Nov-2017	PPT	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PPT/2018/135	03-Mar-2018	PPT	Extension of carry-forward ceiling

Circular No.	Date	Leave Type	Nature of Amendment
RSB/HRD/PPT/2019/142	21-Jun-2019	PPT	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2020/149	25-Aug-2020	PPT	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation
RSB/HRD/PPT/2021/156	19-Jun-2021	PPT	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2022/163	19-Sep-2022	PPT	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PPT/2023/170	20-Apr-2023	PPT	Extension of carry-forward ceiling
RSB/HRD/PPT/2024/177	21-Apr-2024	PPT	Clarification on documentation requirements
RSB/HRD/PPT/2025/184	15-Jan-2025	PPT	Clarification on combination with other leave types
RSB/HRD/PPT/2026/191	15-Sep-2026	PPT	Alignment with statutory amendments to applicable labour legislation